



A **ANNUAL**
R **REPORT**
2025/26

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DRAFT

VISION

A credible, inclusive, and future-ready bargaining council that promotes social dialogue, good governance, workforce well-being, and sustainable outcomes for public servants.

MISSION

To provide a stable and trusted platform for collective bargaining and dispute management in the public service by strengthening sustainable outcomes through meaningful social dialogue.

PSCBC CORE VALUES

- Inclusivity
- Integrity
- Fairness
- Excellence
- Collaboration

SECTION 1: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

FOREWORD BY THE GENERAL SECRETARY



Mr. Frikkie De Bruin

The 2025/2026 financial year took place within a dynamic and evolving public service labour relations environment. During this period, the Secretariat remained focused on ensuring continuity, stability, and the effective functioning of Council processes in support of its constitutional mandate.

The year required sustained attention to strengthening internal systems and governance arrangements that enable the Council to operate effectively. This included maintaining reliable administrative processes, supporting coordination across Council structures, and ensuring that institutional requirements were met in a consistent and disciplined manner.

Ongoing focus was placed on reinforcing the enabling environment within which Council decisions are implemented, ensuring that the institution continues to function in a structured, responsive, and coordinated manner.

I wish to extend my appreciation to the Chairperson, Vice Chairpersons, Employer and Labour delegations, the Executive Committee, Council members, and Secretariat staff for their continued professionalism, engagement, and commitment to the work of the Council.

The Council remains committed to strengthening its institutional capacity and supporting the effective execution of its mandate.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

It is my pleasure to present this Annual Report, highlighting the major activities undertaken by the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council during the 2025/2026 financial year in fulfilment of its constitutional mandate of promoting labour peace in the public service. The Council continues to prioritise effective collective bargaining, efficient dispute management, evidence-based decision-making, institutional sustainability, and meaningful social dialogue in support of a stable, ethical, and productive public service.

The Council continued to process a substantial volume of dispute resolution matters, with mixed movement across key areas of its mandate. Conciliations (including in limine processes), arbitrations, and applications reflected increases of 11%, 54%, and 8% respectively, while arbitration requests showed a slight decline compared to the previous reporting period. The Resident Panellist Unit remained central to efficient case administration and continued to deliver cost efficiencies relative to external commissioner models. Despite this, a significant proportion of conciliations remained unresolved, reflecting ongoing structural and relational complexities within the public service labour environment.

A significant milestone during the financial year was the successful conclusion and signing of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026, which approved an increase in the PSCBC levy contribution structure to strengthen the long-term sustainability of the Council's funding model. The Resolution represented an important strategic intervention to enhance institutional resilience, protect accumulated reserves, and ensure the Council remains financially positioned to deliver effectively on its constitutional and collective bargaining mandate.

The 2025/2026 financial year also marked a pivotal strategic transition for the Council through the commencement of a new five-year strategic planning cycle. From 2–6 March 2026, the Council, Executive Committee, and Secretariat convened at the Radisson Hotel OR Tambo for an extensive strategic planning session that culminated in the development of the PSCBC's renewed Vision, Mission, Values, and Strategic Objectives for the next five-year period.

The Council adopted a new strategic vision of becoming “a credible, inclusive, and future-ready bargaining council that promotes social dialogue, good governance, workforce well-being, and sustainable outcomes for public servants.” This renewed strategic direction places significant emphasis on workforce wellbeing, mental health, psychosocial support, institutional sustainability, digital transformation, ethical governance, and the future readiness of labour relations institutions within the public service.

The strategic planning process further identified five core strategic themes that will guide the work of the Council over the next five years:

- Collective Bargaining and Dispute Resolution;
- Good Governance and Public Service Professionalisation;
- Workforce Wellbeing and Transformation;
- Future of Work, Technology and Digital Transformation; and
- Sustainable Public Service Funding, Fiscal Framework and Wage Policy.

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research Unit continued to strengthen the Council's evidence-based decision-making capability through a portfolio of completed and ongoing research projects spanning Trade Union Membership trends, recruitment policy observer status, uniform standardisation, healthcare governance, dispute referral processes, skills development, training impact, and related institutional studies. The Unit also advanced the Council's knowledge-sharing and thought leadership role through active participation in national and international conferences and summits, contributing research papers on key themes within labour relations and public service transformation, thereby reinforcing the PSCBC's position as a recognised contributor to labour relations discourse.

The Council also made notable progress in advancing long-term institutional sustainability through infrastructure development initiatives. Significant regulatory milestones were achieved in relation to the PSCBC Office Building Development Project, including the approval of rezoning and consolidation rights by the City of Tshwane, resulting in the formal establishment of the consolidated development property, ERF948. These developments require the Council to transition into the next phase of project implementation during the forthcoming strategic cycle.

The Human Resources function continued to focus on organisational capability, staff retention, skills development, and employee wellness. The Council maintained a strong staff retention rate, with more than half of the staff complement now having over ten years of service within the institution. Investment in employee development remained a priority, with staff members successfully completing postgraduate qualifications, participating in National Qualifications Framework-aligned programmes, and attending various professional development initiatives.

Employee wellness and organisational culture also received increased strategic attention during the reporting period. Wellness initiatives, including Wellness Wednesdays, yoga sessions,

wellness walks, team-building interventions, and employee engagement activities, formed part of the Council's broader commitment to creating a supportive, inclusive, and resilient workplace environment aligned to its emerging workforce wellbeing strategy.

The Council further strengthened governance, operational efficiency, and digital capability through the automation of key human resource processes, enhancement of ICT-enabled systems, and the adoption and review of critical governance policies, including the Remote Work Policy and Delegation of Authority Framework.

Financial oversight remained robust throughout the reporting period. The Finance Committee continued to exercise strong governance over the financial affairs of the Council, while cost containment measures and prudent financial management ensured operational stability despite increasing strategic and operational demands. Independent auditors confirmed the accuracy and credibility of the Council's financial statements, reaffirming the sound governance environment maintained by the PSCBC.

As the Council concludes the current strategic cycle and prepares for the implementation of its new five-year strategy, the PSCBC remains committed to strengthening collective bargaining, promoting fair and sustainable labour relations, advancing workforce wellbeing, and ensuring that the institution remains credible, adaptive, and future-ready in an evolving public service environment

MESSAGE FROM THE CHAIRPERSON



Mr. Magate Phala

The 2025/2026 financial year has been a significant and deeply meaningful period for the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council. It was a year marked not only by important institutional developments and strategic progress, but also by transition, reflection, and continuity within the leadership of the Council.

Following the passing of our former Chairperson, the Council experienced a moment of collective loss that was felt across all parties and structures. As I assumed the role of Chairperson during this period, I did so with humility, appreciation for the responsibility entrusted to me, and a recognition of the important legacy and institutional culture that has been built within the PSCBC over many years.

My first year as Chairperson has been one of learning, listening, and engagement. It provided an opportunity to better understand the unique dynamics of the Council, the strength of its collective bargaining processes, and the value of the relationships that exist between organised labour, the Employer, Council structures, and the Secretariat. What became clear throughout the year is that the PSCBC remains a respected institution because of the commitment of its stakeholders to dialogue, accountability, and principled engagement, even during difficult discussions.

The reporting period also marked an important turning point for the future direction of the Council through the strategic planning process undertaken for the next five-year cycle. The engagements and deliberations during this process demonstrated a shared understanding that labour relations institutions must continue evolving in order to remain relevant, credible, and responsive to the changing realities of the public service and the broader world of work.

What stood out most throughout these engagements was the willingness of parties to think beyond immediate operational matters and engage meaningfully on the long-term direction of the Council and the broader public service labour relations environment. The discussions reflected a shared understanding that strong institutions require continuous adaptation, responsible leadership, and the ability to respond proactively to changing workplace realities.

The conclusion of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 reflected the maturity of engagement within the Council, where parties were able to reach agreement on a matter central to the Council's financial sustainability and continued effectiveness. It reaffirmed the value of trust-based engagement, shared responsibility, and disciplined negotiation in strengthening the collective bargaining system.

I also wish to acknowledge the continued work undertaken across the various units of the Council, including collective bargaining, dispute management, research, finance and governance, communications, human resources, and institutional development. The professionalism and dedication demonstrated by the Secretariat throughout the year contributed significantly to the continued functioning and credibility of the Council.

As we enter a new strategic cycle, I remain confident that the PSCBC is well positioned to continue serving as a credible platform for social dialogue and labour stability within the public service. While challenges within the labour relations environment will undoubtedly continue to evolve, the strength of the Council lies in its ability to bring parties together in pursuit of sustainable and balanced outcomes.

I extend my sincere appreciation to the Vice Chair representing Labour, the Vice Chair representing the Employer, organised labour representatives, the Employer delegation, all members of Council and the Executive Committee and the Secretariat for their support, guidance, and commitment throughout the year. I look forward to continuing this important work together in advancing a capable and effective public service.

MESSAGE FROM THE VICE CHAIR: EMPLOYER



Mr Mompoti Galorale

The 2025/2026 financial year has been both demanding and defining for the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council. As the Employer, we remain conscious that a stable and effective public service depends on mature labour relations, responsible leadership, and the ability of all parties to engage one another with honesty, discipline, and mutual respect. Despite the many pressures facing the public sector, the Council continued to demonstrate that constructive engagement remains possible when there is a shared commitment to the broader interests of public servants and the citizens they serve.

This reporting period was particularly significant because it allowed the Council to reflect critically on its future role within a rapidly changing environment. The strategic planning engagements held during the year were not simply administrative exercises, but meaningful deliberations about the future of collective bargaining, the sustainability of labour relations institutions, and the type of public service we wish to build over the next decade. The discussions challenged us to think differently about workforce wellbeing, technology, governance and the changing expectations placed on public institutions.

From an Employer perspective, one of the most encouraging developments has been the growing recognition that workforce wellbeing and organisational performance cannot be separated. Issues relating to mental health, psychosocial support, professionalisation, skills development, and workplace inclusivity are no longer peripheral matters, they are central to building a capable and productive public service. The Council's renewed strategic focus on these areas reflects an important shift towards more sustainable and human-centred labour relations.

The conclusion of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 was another important achievement during the year. Reaching consensus on matters relating to the Council's funding model demonstrated a collective appreciation for the importance of institutional sustainability and responsible

stewardship. Strong institutions remain essential for maintaining labour stability, supporting effective dispute resolution, and safeguarding the integrity of collective bargaining processes within the public service.

I am also encouraged by the Council's continued investment in research, institutional systems, skills development, and infrastructure planning. These initiatives reflect an institution that is preparing itself not only for present operational demands, but also for the future realities of work and governance in South Africa.

Labour relations will always involve robust engagement and at times difficult conversations. However, this year once again demonstrated that meaningful progress is possible when parties remain committed to dialogue, accountability, and principled engagement.

I wish to extend my sincere appreciation to the Chairperson, the Vice Chair representing Labour, all Council and Executive Committee members, organised labour representatives, the Employer delegation, and the Secretariat for their dedication and professionalism throughout the year. Their continued contribution ensures that the PSCBC remains a credible platform for engagement and a cornerstone of labour relations within the public service.

MESSAGE FROM THE VICE CHAIR: LABOUR



Mr David Phala

The 2025/2026 financial year has once again demonstrated the importance of unity, solidarity, and principled engagement within the labour movement and the broader public service labour relations environment. As Vice Chair representing Labour, I reflect on this period with a deep appreciation for the resilience of public servants and the continued commitment of organised labour to protecting the rights, dignity, and wellbeing of workers across the country.

This year's engagements took place against the backdrop of increasing social and economic pressures affecting workers and their families. Rising costs of living, evolving workplace demands, and the changing nature of work continue to place significant strain on employees within the public service. In this context, the work of the Council remains critically important in ensuring that workers continue to have a credible platform through which their voices, concerns, and aspirations can be represented and advanced.

One of the most important developments during the reporting period was the strategic planning process undertaken by the Council in preparation for the next five-year cycle. From a Labour perspective, these engagements created an important opportunity to reflect honestly on the future of collective bargaining and the evolving needs of public servants. The renewed strategic focus on transformation, worker support systems, inclusivity, and the future of work reflects a growing understanding that labour relations must continue evolving alongside the realities faced by workers on the ground.

For organised labour, the question of wellbeing is ultimately about the lived experience of workers. It is about whether employees feel supported in difficult working conditions, whether workplaces are safe and fair, whether workers have opportunities to develop and progress, and whether institutions respond with humanity when employees face personal, emotional, or workplace

challenges. These are matters that directly affect morale, productivity, dignity, and stability within the public service.

The reporting period also highlighted the importance of maintaining strong and sustainable labour relations institutions. The conclusion of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 demonstrated that despite differing interests and robust engagements, parties within the Council remain capable of reaching agreements that protect the long-term stability and effectiveness of the institution

I further wish to acknowledge the important work undertaken through the Council's research initiatives, dispute management processes, training interventions, and ongoing efforts to improve access, participation, and institutional responsiveness. These initiatives continue to strengthen the ability of the Council to respond meaningfully to the realities facing workers within the public service.

As organised labour, we remain committed to advancing fairness, equity, social justice, and transformation within the workplace. We will continue to engage firmly, but constructively, in pursuit of a public service that recognises the value and contribution of every worker.

I extend my sincere appreciation to the Chairperson, the Vice Chair representing the Employer, the Employer delegation, all organised labour representatives, members of Council and the Executive Committee, and the Secretariat for their continued commitment throughout the year. Through continued dialogue and collective responsibility, we remain capable of building a stronger, more inclusive, and worker-centred public service.

SECTION 2: COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

OVERVIEW

As a core operational pillar of the PSCBC, the Collective Bargaining Unit (the Unit) continued to provide the platforms necessary for the Council, Executive Committee, Task Teams, and Provincial Chambers to engage in critical public service dialogue.

During this period, the Unit facilitated negotiations leading to PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026. This agreement to increase levies is vital for sustaining the Council's core functions, including dispute resolution, dispute prevention, and general operations.

Additionally, the Unit was instrumental in the PSCBC's strategic objective review. To ensure an inclusive approach, the Unit conducted provincial strategic planning sessions to gather "shop floor" insights, which directly informed the 2026 PSCBC strategic planning session. This report summarises the Unit's primary activities during the period under review, highlighting both significant milestones and the obstacles faced in executing its mandate.

COUNCIL AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE ACTIVITIES

Between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026, the Council and Executive Committee saw a marked increase in activity. The finalisation of the multi-term salary agreement proved to be an important shift, allowing both bodies to turn from negotiations toward broader Council priorities and the oversight of signed agreements.

To capitalise on this momentum, the reporting period featured several strategic initiatives designed to enhance the overall functionality and effectiveness of both the Council and its Executive Committee.

COUNCIL

- **Salary Agreements Workshops:** Council completed salary agreement workshops across five provinces (*Mpumalanga, Eastern Cape, Northern Cape, Free State, and Western Cape*) to standardise implementation across the public service.
- **Early Retirement Programme Workshop:** A session was held on the incentivised early retirement and voluntary exit programmes. The workshop focused on clarifying the process and its impact, enabling stakeholders to provide accurate guidance to public servants regarding pension benefits.
- **SACSSP Online Registration Webinar:** Council participated in the South African Council for Social Service Professions (SACSSP) webinar to facilitate the transition to their new online system. This ensured that social service professionals are well-informed on registration and renewal procedures.
- **PSCBC & GEMS Strategic Engagement:** A high-level dialogue was convened to evaluate whether the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) continues to align with its founding principles as established by PSCBC Resolutions.
- **Pre-Strategic Planning Party Caucuses:** Two intensive, separate sessions were conducted for the Employer and Labour parties. These sessions focused on the Council-endorsed thematic areas to ensure comprehensive preparation for the 2026 planning session.
- **PSCBC Strategic Planning Session:** Council Parties gathered to reflect on past performance and chart a future course. The session emphasised good governance, robust dispute management, and the continued protection of collective bargaining rights.

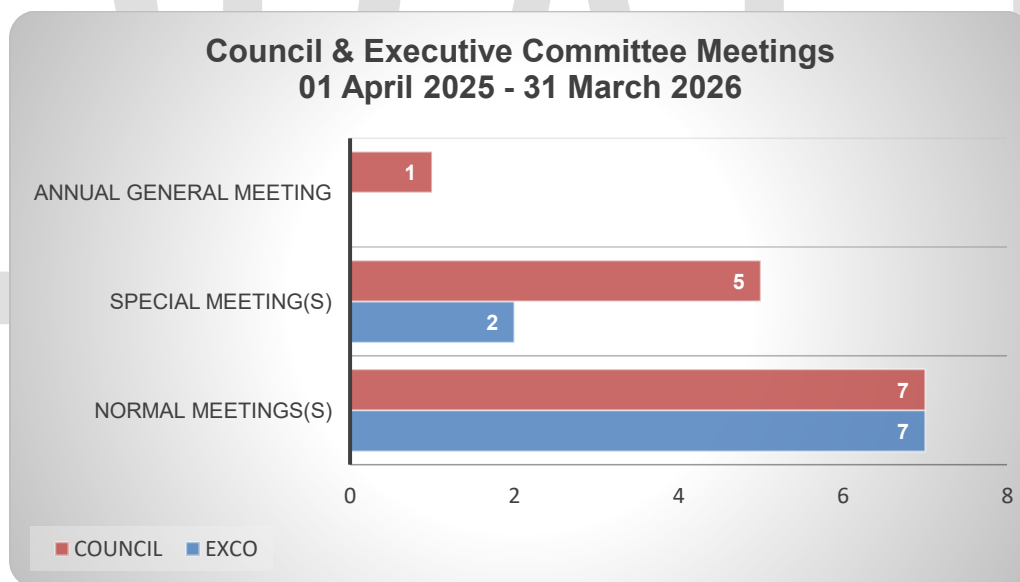
THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

- **Member Induction:** Following the Annual General Meeting, an induction session was held for newly appointed members. While this process was previously constrained by urgent Council priorities, there is a dedicated commitment to refining this programme. Moving forward, the Council intends to expand these sessions to other internal structures to further capacitate negotiators across the public service.

- **Policy Workshop:** The Executive Committee convened a policy workshop to evaluate and review organizational policies. This exercise ensured that all governing documents remain aligned with current legislation and best practices, effectively streamlining processes to better support the PSCBC’s core mandate.
- **Pre-Strategic Planning Session with PSCBC MANCO:** A joint session was held to deliberate on priority areas that will shape the Council’s strategic direction for the 2026–2031 period.

These strategic efforts collectively positioned both the Council and the Executive Committee to operate with significantly greater efficiency and effectiveness throughout the period under review.

The following table details additional activities conducted by the Council and the Executive Committee from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026:



RESOLUTIONS

2025/2026

Council concluded a single resolution in the reporting period:

Resolution	Purpose	Objective	Result
1 of 2026	Agreement on the Increase of Levies	To ensure that the levy fund can maintain the functions of collective bargaining, dispute resolutions, dispute prevention and the operations of the PSCBC	The agreement obtained an 88.37% majority status on 04 March 2026, and was signed by: The Employer, DENOSA, HOSPERSA, NAPTOSA, NEHAWU, PSA, SADTU and SAPU

COMMITTEES/ TASK TEAMS

To support the Council's collective bargaining efforts, the following committees met during the reporting period; a summary of their activities is provided below:

Committee	Establishment/ Legislative mandate	Key Focus Areas	Key Highlights	Status as at 31 March 2026
Working Committee on GEHS	Established in line with the PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015 and following the decision taken in October 2020 to bring GEHS matters back to Council.	To develop and implement a roadmap on the GEHS To approach the GEPF and PIC to conduct a feasibility study on a funding model for affordable	Decisions to involve principals at ministerial level to evaluate the current strategy on GEHS and provide guidance to take the process forward Decision to convene a	Processes were underway to convene the principals' workshop

		and accessible housing products for public servants	workshop to principals on state of the GEHS	
PSCBC GEMS joint Working Committee	Established in terms of Resolution 4 of 2017 to consider the performance of the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) on an ongoing basis.	To give effect to the transformation of GEMS allowing the board to reflect the demographics of the membership of the scheme. To improve the healthcare benefits of members and funding for those benefits should be prioritised from the savings incurred by the scheme	Council endorsement of the report and recommendations from the PSCBC GEMS strategic engagement Tension between Council and GEMS on the interpretation of consultation and the 9.8%/ 9.5% 2026 contribution increase	Council was in the process of appealing the 2026 GEMS contribution increases
Public Service Summit Declaration Task Team (PSSDTT)	Established by a decision of the Council to oversee the implementation of the PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022/Summit Declaration	To ensure the implementation of the four key objectives/ focus areas in the Summit Declaration: - Strengthen and defend collective bargaining, - Professionalisation of	Consideration of the close-out reports from the four Workstreams by the Task Team Task Team recommendations to Council on some of the areas in the key objectives Council endorsement of	Processes were underway to implement the recommendations and monitor the progress thereof

		the public service - The use of the 4th Industrial Revolution in the public service - Enhancement of the role of women, youth and people with disabilities	the recommendations	
Collective Bargaining Committee 1	Established by a decision of the Council to ensure the implementation of the PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025	- Comprehensive Danger Insurance - Child Care and Breast-feeding Facilities - Death Grant - Bursary Scheme	Draft reports on the comprehensive danger insurance, childcare and breastfeeding facilities and the bursary scheme	Reports are to be finalised, and recommendations are to be made to Council in the next reporting period
Collective Bargaining Committee 2	Established by a decision of the Council to ensure the implementation of the PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025	- Recruitment Policy - Uniform Policy - Review of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2023 (Disciplinary Code) - Incentive Policy Framework	Recommendations to Council on the Recruitment and Uniform Policies	Council to consider the recommendations in the next reporting period

PSCBC COORDINATING CHAMBERS

The PSCBC has a coordinating chamber in each province to oversee and manage matters related to provincial administration.

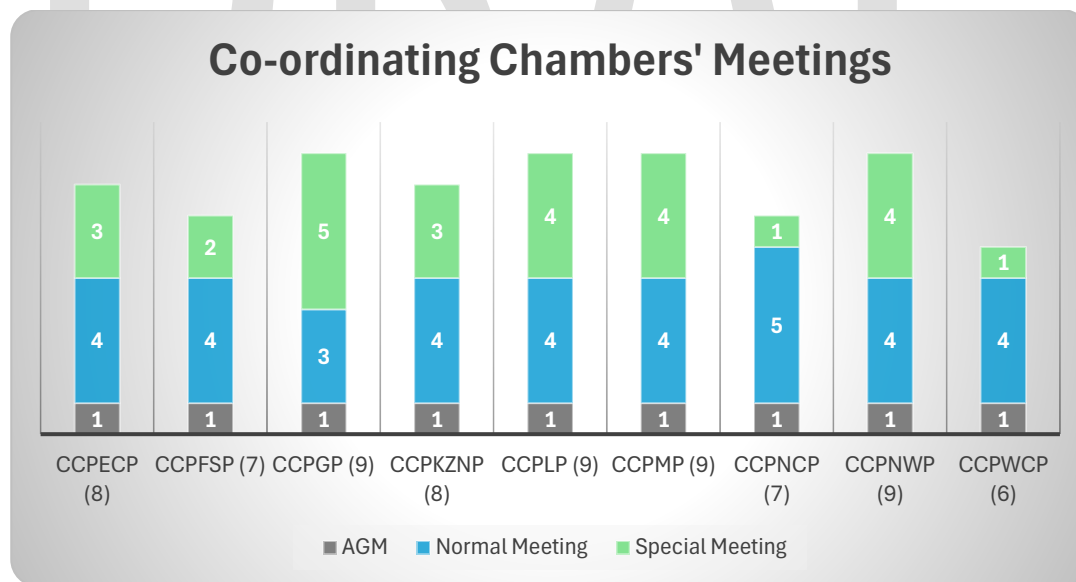
Chamber Performance Report

The following section details the performance and activity of these Chambers during the reporting period.

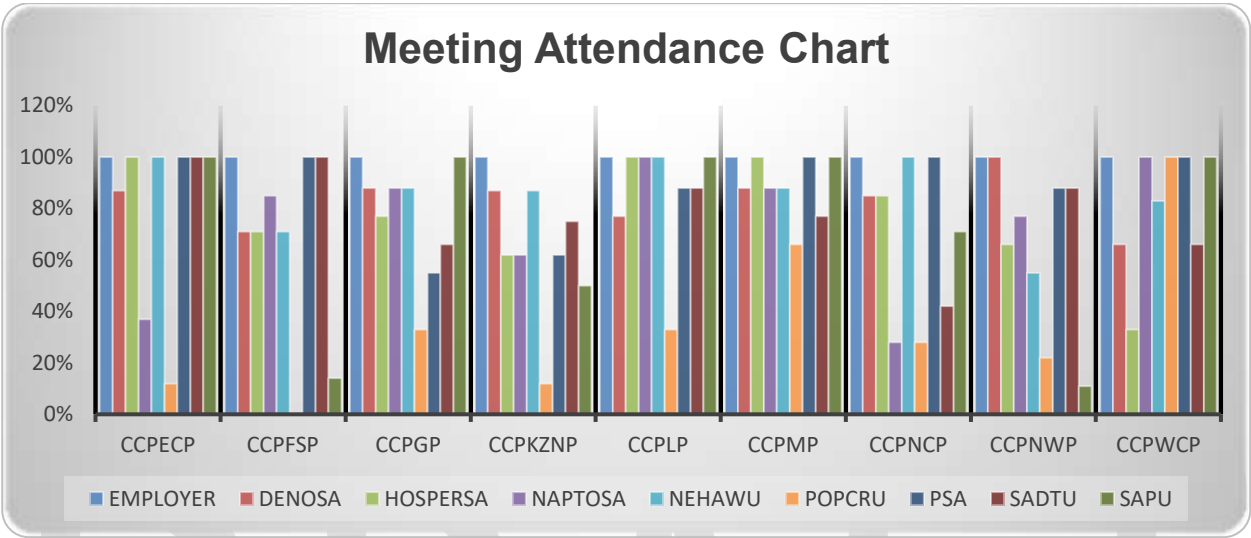
Meeting Compliance

Each Chamber is mandated to convene at least four times per reporting period, with additional sessions scheduled as required.

During the reporting period all Chambers met the minimum meeting requirements.



Meeting Attendance by Parties



CCPECP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Provincial Human Resource Status Report		All funded vacant posts in the province to be filled.	This is a standing matter on the agenda. The Employer to present updated reports for discussions
Occupational Health and Safety Report	May 2022	Buildings to be compliant with the OHS requirements	The Employer to present updated report for discussion in the next meeting
1991 Bisho Public Service Strike	June 2025	Employees who lost benefits due to strike should be compensated as previously agreed between Employer and Labour.	Parties agreed to allow the Parliamentary process to conclude on the matter. In the CCPECP: 13 March 2026, Parties agreed to retain the item on the agenda to monitor developments from Parliamentary process.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	June 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	PSCBC Committee still engaged with the Research processes. Parties agreed that the item be provisionally removed from the agenda whilst the Committee concludes its research.
Proposed way forward post the Chamber Strategic Planning Session	August 2025	The Employer requested that report presentation be done bi-annually	Parties agreed that they should adhere to the Council Constitution that provides that meetings should be convened on quarterly basis and reports should be presented accordingly
Non-Compliance with Policy development process in the Eastern Cape	October 2025	That the CCPECP formally calls upon the Eastern Cape Office of the Premier to investigate and	The Employer to provide feedback in the next meeting.

		address all reported cases of procedural non-compliance	In the CCPECP: 13 March 2026, the Employer requested that they be afforded an opportunity to submit progress report on/before 19 March 2026
Centralised Control of Union Affiliation Cancellations	October 2025	For the Office of the Premier and Heads of Department to direct and/or advise departments suspend all union cancellations pending review of current practices	Parties proposed that the Secretariat request the Trade Union Management Unit to provide progress in the centralisation of Union membership.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	October 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistics in the next meeting. GEHS to provide spreadsheet with PERSAL numbers to assist the Employer in identifying affected employees.
Establishment of Terms of Reference for Departmental Bargaining Forums	March 2026	For Parties to develop Terms of Reference for Departmental Bargaining Forums.	The Employer has noted the submission and will engage on the internal mandating process

CCPGP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Conditions of Buildings in Gauteng Province	June 2017 (Standing matter)	Buildings to be compliant with the OHS requirements	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion
Provincial PMDS Report on Pay Progression	June 2021 (Standing matter)	Pay Progression payment and other related activities to be implemented in line with PMDS policy	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion
Delays in E-Government Processes	June 2023	Benefits due to employees to be addressed expeditiously	The Employer to engage senior officials from E-Gov to come explain the process to the Chamber. Organised Labour to submit historical list of affected employees to assist with the process. In the Reconvened CCPGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed that the Council should be invited to intervene on the matter
Provincial Micro-Organising of Government (PMOG)	October 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the processes to be followed.	The Employer to present close-out report in the next meeting. In the CCPGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed that a close-out report was presented at the level of GPSSBC and the item be removed from the agenda.

Public Service Charter Pledge	November 2024	For Labour to note that the Employer would be rolling out the Public Service Charter Pledge as committed at national level.	The Employer to present close-out report in the next meeting. In the CCPGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed that the item should be provisionally withdrawn whilst the Employer conclude its internal processes
GPG Reasonable Accommodation Policy	February 2025	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy Framework	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/or before 11 March 2025. In the CCPGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed that the item have been conclude and should be removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	June 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	PSCBC Committee still engaged with the Research processes. In the CCPGP: 25 November 2025, Parties agreed that the item be provisionally removed from the agenda until the Committee finalise its research.
Discontinuation of GPG Staff Shuttle Service from Pretoria to Johannesburg	August 2025	Discontinuation of the GPG staff shuttle service be halted with immediate effect and proper negotiation with Organised Labour be initiated without any delays	In the CCPGP: 27 August 2025, Parties agreed that the Employer would present a progress report in the next Chamber meeting.

			In the CCPGP: 25 November 2025, the Employer reported that a circular advising that services would be withdrawn have been withdrawn. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Lifestyle Audits and the financial implication borne by members from the required information	August 2025	Consider the feasibility and fairness of requiring employees to personally bear these costs. Explore alternative solutions or expedited reimbursement mechanisms that would ensure compliance without undue financial strain on public servants	In the CCGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed to defer the item to the next Chamber meeting for the Employer to present a comprehensive report.
GPG Policy Framework on employee mobility	September 2025	To consult Organised Labour on the new Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs. In the CCPGP: 11 March 2026, Parties agreed that the items have been concluded and it should be removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	October 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who did not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistics in the next meeting. The Secretariat to present updated spreadsheet from the GEHS to assist Parties in locating affected employees.
CCPGP Chamber Training	March 2026	For training and development of Chamber members	The Chairperson to write to the General-Secretary requesting assistance.

CCPFSP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Review of PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2005 & Procedure Manual for Chambers of the PSCBC	July 2025	Parties to submit inputs	At the end of the reporting period, no submissions had been received from the Parties
Non-payment of GEMS/ GEPP/ SARS Contributions by the Department of Education	July 2025	The Department to clarify the reasons for the non-payment	A formal communication was provided to Labour. By the end of the reporting period the Department had managed to make the payments. The matter was concluded.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	July 2025	The departments to assist with the collation of the Recruitment and Uniform Policies applicable in the province to assist the research process at national level	The province complied with the request and submitted the relevant policies. The matter was concluded.
The monitoring of conflicting arbitration awards/ different rulings by different commissioners/ consistency of arbitration awards	September 2025	The PSCBC Resident Panellist to respond to questions that were raised at the AGM regarding arbitrations	A formal written response was issued by the Resident Panellist to the Chamber. The matter was concluded.
Slow Implementation of the GEHS	September 2025	For the Chamber to monitor the implementation of Clause 4.5 of Resolution 7 of 2015 (<i>Housing Allowance</i>)	A workshop to be scheduled in the next reporting period to ensure uniform understanding and implementation of the Resolution

Non-filling of Vacant Posts	September 2025	The employer to provide reports on the filling of vacant posts.	The Employer to continue providing updated reports to the Chamber
Termination of GEHS Subsidy – Department of Education	October 2025	The Department of Education to withdraw the circular issued terminating the subsidy pending consultation	The subsidy was reinstated. The matter was concluded.
Proposals made in the AGM and Strategic Planning Session for the CCPFSP: 11 & 12/09/2025	March 2026	Special Chamber meeting to be called to address the item. Some issues raised to be elevated to Chamber as agenda items together with action plan for implementation thereof.	Awaiting the convening of the special Chamber meeting.

CCPKZNP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Job Evaluation	August 2024	For the Employer to align all the processes of Job Evaluation across all Provincial Departments	The Employer to circulate the Job Evaluation Policy Framework; Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/or before 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to

			remove the item on the agenda.
Policy Framework on Adult Education and Training (AET) In the Workplace	August 2024	Encourage further learning within the Provincial departments	The Employer still finalising internal processes. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Policy and Procedure on the Implementation of Recognition of Prior Learning within the KwaZulu Natal Office of the Premier	August 2024	Recognise and assist employees that might not have formal qualifications but have requisite experience and need to further their studies so that they may be considered for upward career mobility	The Employer still finalising internal processes. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Provincial Policy on Mentorship and Coaching	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they

			were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Provincial Policy on Bursaries	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Provincial Policy Framework on Job Rotation	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised

			draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Provincial Policy on Succession Planning	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Draft Provincial Policy on Change Management	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025. In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Reviewed Provincial Human Resource Strategy	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Strategy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs by 10 January 2025.

			In the reconvened CCPKZNP Labour indicated that they were unable to submit written inputs timeously and therefore those inputs submitted during meeting discussion should find expression in the finalised draft. Parties agreed to remove the item on the agenda
Nomination of the Representative from Organised Labour to sit on the Provincial Job Evaluation Panel	November 2024	For Organised Labour to included and participate in the Job Evaluation processes.	The Employer to write to the Provincial Structures of the Trade Unions represented in the Chamber. Organised Labour nominated officials to serve in the Job Evaluation Panel. Parties agreed in the CCPKZNP: 18 June 2025 to remove the item from the agenda.
E-Learning Policy for the KZNPPSTA	April 2025	To consult Organised Labour on E-Learning Policy for the KZNPPSTA	The Employer proceeded to implement the policy as is after waiting for the consolidated inputs from Organised Labour and same was not forthcoming. In the CCPKZNP: 18 June 2025, Parties agreed to

			remove the item from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	June 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	Item remains on the agenda for monitoring purposes and receive reports from the PSCBC Committee as and when there were developments.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	October 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistics in the next meeting.
Provincial Policy Framework on adaptive working arrangements	October 2025	To consult Organised Labour on the Provincial Policy Framework.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/before 07 November 2025, failure to submit the Employer should proceed with the framework as presented.
Reviewed Provincial Framework on Organisational Design	October 2025	To consult Organised Labour on proposed reviews.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/before 07 November 2025, failure to submit the Employer should proceed with the framework as presented.

CCPLP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Progress Tracking in Shortage of Staff (Filling of Vacant Posts as Per Resolution 1 of 2018, Clause 8.2.3)	May 2016	For the Employer to continuously report statistics relating to the filling of vacant posts.	This is a standing matter on the agenda

Dilapidated Buildings causing health hazard and risk to safety in Limpopo workplaces.	August 2021	For the matter to receive urgent attention from the Employer as there were buildings with health and safety risks in the province.	For the Employer and/or Task Team to provide status report on OHS and safety of the government buildings across the Province.
Departments to establish OHS committees, train and recognise them and to ensure that they submit list of dilapidated buildings and their progress report on renovation, including any other safety risk and health hazard conditions report on a quarterly basis in chamber as well as measures taken to remedy such conditions.	February 2024	Departments to establish ohs committees, train and recognise them and to ensure that they submit list of dilapidated buildings and their progress report on renovation, including any other safety risk and health hazard conditions report on a quarterly basis in chamber as well as measures taken to remedy such conditions.	The Employer to provide status report
Implementation of new job evaluation and grading system in the public service	January 2025	For Parties to engage with the effectively in consultation regarding the implementation of the new job evaluation and grading system.	the Employer to provide status report
Review of provincial parking tariffs for implementation with effect from 1 April 2025	January 2025	To propose review and implementation of increased tariffs with effect from 1 April 2025.	Implementation of the agreed tariffs would be 01 October 2025; tariffs would remain at 10% for 2025/2026 and 2026/2027 financial years. In the Special CCPLP: 25 July 2025, Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Proposed amendment: rental management policy	January 2025	For Parties to consult on the proposed amendments to the policy	In the CCPLP: 23 May 2025, Organised Labour indicated that they were not able to submit any inputs on the policy, as result the Employer

			should proceed with the policy as presented. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Policy on remote work due to natural disasters (abnormal rainfall and flooding)	February 2025	That a policy on remote work due to natural disasters is developed and implemented and that the Disaster Management Team in the province is invited to form part of the consultation process.	In the Special CCPLP: 04 July 2025, Parties agreed that the item be provisionally withdrawn from the agenda.
Health and productivity management policy	February 2025	For Parties to consult on the policy	The Employer to provide status report
Policy and Procedure on Bereavement and Hospitalisation	February 2025	For Parties to consult on the Policy	The processes at the CCPLP have been concluded; however, the Employer to table those matters that were not transversal at the ELRC. The item remains on the agenda for reporting purposes.
Review of the policy on the performance management and development	July 2025	For Parties to consult proposed reviews on the Policy	In the CCPLP: 24 February 2026, Organised Labour accepted the policy as reviewed. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	July 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	Parties agreed that the item be provisionally withdrawn from the agenda until the Task Team has completed its processes.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement	November 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not	The Employer to present updated statistics in the next meeting.

for the establishment of government employees housing scheme		benefit and monitor the process thereof	
Uniform shut-down time in case of electricity outage/loadshedding and water supply cut at workplace of the Employer	November 2025	Provide clarity on why standardised and uniform approach is not implemented when there is power cuts and/or water outage in Province	The Employer to provide responses in the next Chamber meeting. In the CCPLP: 24 February 2026, the Employer proposed that they be afforded an opportunity to consult with their Principal on the proposed circular.
Provincial Policy Manual	December 2025	For Parties to consult proposed reviews on the Policies.	Organised Labour to submit proposed inputs in the next Chamber meeting. In the Special CCPLP: 25 March 2026, Parties agreed to convene a special virtual meeting to conclude on the policy manual.

CCPMP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
The Review of the Provincial Bursary Policy & Exceptional Decentralisation of Bursaries for the Department of Health	July 2017	For the Employer to pay tuition, accommodation, and transportation for beneficiaries of bursaries.	the Employer to present progress report during Chamber meetings
Establishment of District Offices for the Department of Health and the Department of Social Development in the Bohlabela Region	July 2017	For the Department of Health and the Department of Social Development to be established in the Bohlabela region.	Organised Labour to engage the Director-General and provide feedback to the Chamber.

Disposal of State Houses	July 2017	For the Department of Public Works to halt the process of auctioning state houses and for employees who resided in those houses to be given preference when auctioning.	Organised Labour to submit names of officials to serve in the Task Team. The Employer to convene a task team meeting on/before 04 December 2025
Status of Organograms of all Departments.	October 2018	For the Employer to provide a status of organograms of all departments in the provincial administration	the Employer to provide status update on the Organograms of all departments
Filling of Posts	October 2018	For the Employer to provide information on the vacancy rate and the number of abolished posts within provincial administration	The Employer to provide status updates on the filling of vacant funded posts
Provincial Incentive Policy	May 2023	For parties to consult on the review of the Provincial Incentive Policy	Concluded. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 27 February 2025 that if there were no inputs submitted, the Employer should proceed with implementation.
Declaration of the Mpumalanga provincial labour summit held on 17 - 18 November 2022 at nutting house lodge in Mbombela.	October 2022	To track progress on the implementation of the labour summit declaration.	In the Special CCPMP: 19 August 2025, the PSCBC Secretariat presented a progress report. Parties noted the report. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 06 March 2026 that the item be removed from the agenda.
Loadshedding	November 2023	For the Employer to outline a plan of action for employees during loadshedding.	The Employer to provide proposed budget allocation received from Provincial Treasury
Referral of danger allowance for all community development workers (CDW's)	November 2023	For Labour to note the referral of the danger allowance for all	Organised Labour to engage the Director-General and

		community development workers	provide feedback to the Chamber. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 06 March 2026 that the item be removed from the agenda
Employee Health and Wellness Policy Framework Mpumalanga Provincial Government	November 2023	For parties to consult on the policy	Concluded. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 27 February 2025 that if there were no inputs submitted, the Employer should proceed with implementation.
Policy Frameworks for Consultation at the Provincial Chamber	February 2024	For parties to consult on the Policy	Concluded. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 27 February 2025 that if there were no inputs submitted, the Employer should proceed with implementation.
Electronic Submission System	August 2024	For parties to consult on the system	The Employer to present progress report
Establishment, Abolition, and Designation of Mpumalanga Provincial Departments	October 2024	For Information sharing purposes	The Employer to provide progress reports during Chamber meetings
Terms of reference (TRO) for security threat and risk assessment (STRA)	October 2024	For Parties to consult	Concluded. Parties agreed in the CCPMP: 27 February 2025 that if there were no inputs submitted, the Employer should proceed with implementation.
Research and Innovation Bill	May 2025	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Bill	Organised Labour to submit inputs on/before 16 May 2025. In the CCPMP: 04 November 2025, Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.

EXCO Resolution to transfer the transversal human resource development function from the department of education to the Office of the Premier	May 2025	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the EXCO resolution to transfer transversal human Resource development function from Department of Education to the Office of the Premier.	The Item remains on the agenda for reporting purposes.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	July 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	Parties noted all the policies submitted during the special CCPMP: 22 July 2025. Parties agreed that the item be retained on the agenda for monitoring purposes.
Consultation on Decentralisation of shared internal Audit Function	August 2025	To consult Organised Labour on establishment of Internal Audit Function Units	The item remains on the agenda for monitoring purposes.
Withdrawal of circular 51 of 2025 at the Department of Education	November 2025	For the Employer to withdraw circular 51 of 2025, until proper consultation has been concluded.	The Employer to facilitate a bilateral between the Organised Labour and Department of Education on/before 14 November 2025. In CCPMP: 06 March 2026, Parties agreed that the circular was withdrawn and the item be removed from the agenda
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	November 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistics in the next meeting.
Electronic Recruitment Progress	March 2026	To consult Organised Labour on Electronic Policy development	The item remains on the agenda for monitoring purposes.

Policy Framework	March 2026	To consult Organised Labour on Policy reviews	The item remains on the agenda for monitoring purposes.
Provincial ICT Strategy	March 2026	To consult Organised Labour on the ICT Strategy	The item remains on the agenda for monitoring purposes.

CCPNCP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Clause 8.2.3 of Resolution No. 1 of 2018(PSCBC): Filling of Funded Vacant Posts	July 2018	For the Employer to provide reports on the filling of vacant funded posts	This is a standing matter on the agenda. The Employer to present updated report in the Chamber for discussion.
Workshopping of PSCBC Resolutions	August 2018	For the Employer to provide workshops to labour relations practitioners, shop stewards and human resources practitioners on the Resolutions.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on the Resolutions to be workshopped. The Employer to convene workshops on the Resolutions for uniform understanding and implementations
Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Terms of Reference.	July 2018	For parties to conclude a collective agreement on OHS.	Parties agreed in the CCPNCP: 01 August 2025 that the item was concluded and it was at the GPSSBC Sector Council
Current Approved Structures of each Department and Personnel Costs/Compliance by the Provincial Departments with the 2016 Directive	December 2019	For the Employer to provide Labour with the current approved structures of each department and personnel costs	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber, for discussion.

Which Services had been outsourced and the cost of such services	December 2019	The Employer to give a report on outsourced serviced and the cost of such services.	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber, for discussion.
The Amount spent on Labour Related Cases, such as Litigations financial year 2015/2016 to financial year 2023/2024, the Report must give yearly Breakdowns of such Amounts.	December 2019	For the Employer to provide the amount spent on labour related cases for the period January 2015 to June 2019	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber
Amounts indicated by the Auditor General to be Fruitless and Wasteful Expenditure for the Financial Year 2018/2019.	December 2019	For the Employer to provide amounts indicated by the Auditor General to be fruitless and wasteful.	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber, for discussion.
The Roll Out of The Provincial Organisational Design (OD) Strategy	September 2022	Parties to consult on the draft Provincial Organisational Design Strategy.	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber, for discussion.
Compliance with OHS Act in line with clause 10 of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2012	August 2023	Task the HODs to ensure that rented offices are renovated and put on the necessary level of hygiene or else look for complaint offices to rent	The Employer to present continuous reports to the Chamber
The organizational structure of DTSL (security function)	February 2025	For Parties to consult on the matter.	The Employer to present updated reports in the Chamber meetings for discussions.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	July 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	The Secretariat reported in the CCPNCP: 23 October 2025, that the Employer submitted Policies to the Council for onward handling. Parties agreed that the item be provisionally withdrawn from the agenda to afford the Council committee an opportunity to conclude on the matter.

Update report on the rationalisation of entities	October 2025	Item deferred	Item deferred
Remodelling of DRPW	October 2025	Item deferred	Item deferred
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	October 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistics in the meetings until all affected employees have been accounted for.
Arbitration of all unfair discrimination cases in the Northern Cape	October 2025	For the Employer to develop a uniform procedure in handling unfair discrimination cases in the Northern Cape Provincial government departments	The Employer advised that the matter was legislated at national level, as result they were unable to assist Organised Labour. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Departmental Uniform/PPE for support, e.g. cleaners, support staff and groundmen	October 2025	For the Employer to conduct an audit to verify that employees eligible to receive uniforms/ PPE were receiving same.	The Employer proposed that Parties await processes at national level to conclude on research on uniform policy. Organised Labour indicated that the committed six-month period that the committee ought to have concluded the processes have already lapsed; in any event there was nothing precluding the Employer to conduct the requested audit. The Employer indicated that their position remains the same that Parties afford national processes to conclude. The Item was removed from the agenda.

What is the status regarding the absorption of security personnel within public service	October 2025	For the Employer to provide status update on the security personnel within Public Service	Parties agreed to defer the matter for discussion to a special meeting on 13 April 2026
Outstanding payments to security personnel at NC Mental Hospital, Department of Agriculture (including allowances)	October 2025	Outstanding payments to be paid out to qualifying employees	Parties agreed to defer discussion on the matter to special meeting on 13 April 2026

CCPNWP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Provincial PMDS Report	June 2018 (Standing matter)	The Employer to report on pay progression payments and other related activities in line with the PMDS Policy	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Report on Resolution 1 of 2007	May 2016 (Standing matter)	All funded vacant posts in the province should be filled, expeditiously.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Provincial Remote Working Policy	July 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy	In the CCPNWP: 31 March 2025, Parties agreed that the Employer should proceed with the implementation of the Policy as is. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Early Retirement without penalisation	July 2025	For the Employer to share any information at its disposal about the processes.	In the CCPNWP: 14 July 2025, Parties agreed that the processes would be addressed appropriately at the national level where the process was already underway. In the

			CCPNWP: 20 March 2026, the item was reintroduced, the Employer made summary presentation, Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda, with the proviso that as and when new information was available the Employer would share same.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	July 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	The Secretariat reported in the CCPNWP: 11 August 2025, that the Employer submitted Policies to the Council for onward handling. Parties agreed that the item be provisionally withdrawn from the agenda to afford the Council committee an opportunity to conclude on the matter.
North West Provincial Government social media Policy	September 2025	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy	In the Special CCPNWP: 18 December 2025, the Employer indicated that it has full consulted on the policy, as result it would proceed with implementation. Organised Labour indicated that it rejected the Policy as it serves as a duplicate of Public Service Regulation. Item was removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	November 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	Parties agreed to establish a Task Team. The Task Team to present progress reports in the Chamber. Parties agreed to

			dissolve the Task Team and that the Employer would present progress report henceforth.
Reviewed North West Provincial Healthy Eating Policy	February 2026	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/before 20 March 2026 In the CCPNWP: 20 March, Organised Labour indicated that they did not have inputs on the policy and the Employer should proceed with the policy as presented.
Reviewed North West Provincial Policy on Employee Physical Activity, Recreation and Sport for Health Policy	February 2026	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/before 20 March 2026 In the CCPNWP: 20 March, Organised Labour indicated that they did not have inputs on the policy and the Employer should proceed with the policy as presented.
Provincial Mental Health in the Workplace Policy	February 2026	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/before 20 March 2026. In the CCPNWP: 20 March, Organised Labour indicated that they did not have inputs on the policy and the Employer should proceed with the policy as presented.

CCPWCP Agenda:

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Safety of Staff in all Provincial Government Departments	December 2018	To enquire whether such a policy was available, and do various departments manage their own parking bays	The Employer present updated report for discussion in the Chamber meetings
Conversions: Probationary Employees	July 2022	The Employer to provide progress report on probationary employees' conversions to permanent employees	The Employer present updated report for discussion in the Chamber meetings
Strategic Planning Session	December 2022	For parties to discuss the way forward in the Chamber from a strategic perspective	Parties agreed in the CCPWCP: 12 June 2025 that the item should be removed from the agenda.
Review of the personnel plan signed in 2019.	September 2024	For Parties to consult a draft reviewed Personnel Plan	The Employer present updated report for discussion in the Chamber meetings
AI Definition and Policy within the Western Cape Government	June 2025	For the Employer to provide clarity if there were any policy development on the use of AI in the workplace	Parties agreed on CCPWCP: 10 November 2025, that the item be provisionally removed from the agenda until it was refined.
Discrepancy in entry levels of general workers	June 2025	For the Employer provide clarity if there were any discrepancies in the entry salary level from various departments	Parties agreed that the item was finalised in the Consultative Forum meeting on 30 October 2025. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 OF 2025	June 2025	To standardise Recruitment and Uniform Policies across Public Service	Parties agreed that the item be provisionally withdrawn from the agenda to afford the Council committee an opportunity to conclude on the matter.

Interpretation of the PSCBC Resolutions 1 of 2003	September 2025	For General-Secretary to provide clarity on which one took precedence between the WCG Guide to People Managers on Progressive Discipline and Appeals and the Resolution	The Council advised that the item was already on the Council agenda for review. It proposed that Parties afford the committee to finalise on the processes. Parties agreed that the item be removed from the agenda.
Implementation of clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015-Framework agreement for the establishment of government employees housing scheme	November 2025	For the Chamber to develop mitigating factors that could assist employees who were not benefit and monitor the process thereof	The Employer to present updated statistical report in the Chamber meeting



CHAMBER INTERVENTIONS

Provincial Strategic Planning Sessions

With 2025 marking the end of the PSCBC's five-year strategic cycle, the Council initiated a new planning phase centered on provincial engagement. To ensure the next strategy is responsive to the needs of all structures, the Secretariat conducted facilitated workshops across all nine provinces.

These sessions served as a critical platform for identifying localized challenges, including operational inefficiencies, resource constraints, and policy implementation hurdles. Furthermore, the provinces shared innovative strategies and successful approaches tailored to their specific contexts. This collaborative process ensured that the 2026 PSCBC strategic plan is both relevant and grounded in the realities of provincial administrations.

Participants welcomed these long-overdue discussions, and commitments were made to move some of the inputs to provincial agendas for continued action.

Chamber Involvement in Processes at National Level

Over the past few years, there has been a strategic shift toward integrating provincial chambers into Council processes. A principal agreement is now in place to share Council reports with the chambers, ensuring that the parties in the provinces remain fully informed of developments at national level.

To strengthen this collaboration, chambers have been actively engaged in the following areas:

- *Implementation of Clause 4.5 of PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015 - Framework Agreement for the Establishment of a Government Employees Housing Scheme (GEHS)*

The GEHS Working Committee identified that a significant number of eligible public servants are currently not receiving their housing allowance. To address this, a concerted effort was launched to ensure all qualifying employees access this benefit.

The role of the chambers was to oversee the implementation of clause 4.5 at provincial level, track progress and report back to the Council to ensure eligible public servants receive this benefit.

- *Implementation of Clause 3.1.3 (Recruitment Policy) and Clause 3.1.5 (Uniform Policy) of PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025*

Chambers were requested to support the Collective Bargaining Committee (CBC) in collating and consolidating recruitment policies from various public service departments, and share challenges and best practice regarding the provision of uniforms by relevant departments in their respective provinces.

Through the dedicated support of the chambers, the CBC successfully concluded reports on both recruitment and uniform policies. The findings have since been presented to the Council for consideration.

CAPACITY BUILDING FOR PARTIES TO COUNCIL AND CHAMBERS

CHAMBERS

PSCBC Workshops on the 2025/2026 Wage Negotiations Agreements

During the previous reporting period, the PSCBC began conducting workshops on Resolutions 1 and 2 of 2025, both arising from the 2025/2026 wage negotiations. This initiative aimed to ensure consistent understanding and implementation of these resolutions. The program continued into the current reporting period, with additional workshops rolled out in the Mpumalanga, Eastern Cape, Northern Cape, Free State, and Western Cape provinces.

PSETA Training Initiatives

Through the Trade Union Membership Management section of the Unit, the PSCBC Chambers participated in several training initiatives through a partnership with the GPSSBC, PHSDSBC, and the PSETA. These included the following:

- *Non-pivotal Dispute Management and Negotiation Skills Training*
- *Apply Public Service Labour Legislation in Mediation (US ID 119954)*

COUNCIL

7TH ALLS Conference 25-26 February 2026, Gaborone Botswana

The African Labour Law Society (ALLS) is a professional association dedicated to the advancement of labour and employment law across the continent. Its primary objectives are to enhance legal expertise, facilitate knowledge sharing among members, and encourage cross-border jurisdictional learning. As an affiliate, the Council sent a delegation of 21 members to this year's conference, which was held on 25 and 26 February 2026, at the Grand Palm Conference Centre in Gaborone, Botswana.

Held under the theme "*Balancing Rights and Responsibilities in the Modern African Workplace*", the event provided invaluable insights and was highly regarded by delegates for its comprehensive and eye-opening perspective on evolving workplace dynamics.

MANAGEMENT OF TRADE UNION MEMBERSHIP

At the 2019 Council Strategic Planning Session, parties within the PSCBC agreed on the importance of centralising the administration of Trade Union Membership. This decision was motivated by a collective goal to promote standardisation, enhance data accuracy, and improve efficiency in membership management. To uphold neutrality and build stakeholder confidence, it was initially proposed that this function be entrusted to an independent third-party entity.

Following further engagements, it was resolved that the PSCBC would assume this role, given its institutional credibility and strategic positioning within the public service sector. To implement this resolution, the PSCBC established the Trade Union Membership (TUM) sub-unit within its Collective Bargaining Unit. This approach was endorsed by Council and reaffirmed at the recent PSCBC Strategic Planning Session held from 3-5 March 2026, which supported the continued strengthening of a centralised membership administration function.

During the reporting period, the Collective Bargaining Unit focused on establishing processes to support consultation with Labour and the appointed service provider in the development of the Trade Union Membership Management System.

Two workshops held on 26 September 2025 and 11 February 2026 facilitated consultation on the proposed centralised system. These engagements brought together Labour representatives, Trade Union Membership teams, trade unions ICT personnel, and the service provider to address challenges associated with decentralised membership processes, including data inconsistencies, duplication, and verification delays.

Key concerns raised by Labour included verification processes, administrative and financial implications, HR involvement, data integrity, and compliance with the Labour Relations Act and the Consumer Protection Act. The PSCBC clarified its administrative (non-financial) role, while the system design incorporates secure multi-channel verification, real-time PERSAL integration, audit trails, and automated reporting.

The workshops further agreed to the establishment of a Labour Task Team to co-design the implementation plan, define milestones, develop timelines, assess organisational readiness, and oversee stakeholder engagement and reporting. System approval remains subject to Council consideration pending completion of the Task Team process. These initiatives reflect PSCBC's commitment to improving transparency, accuracy, and efficiency in Trade Union Membership management.

The sub-unit also continued to engage with the broader trade union landscape through various sector platforms, strengthening stakeholder relations, collaboration, and trust.

KEY STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENTS:

During the reporting period the TUM sub-unit actively engaged with key public service unions and stakeholders through national conferences, congresses, and commemorative events. These engagements provided platforms for dialogue on sectoral challenges, strengthened collaboration with labour, and reinforced the PSCBC's commitment to improving working conditions, supporting collective bargaining, and promoting its strategic objectives across the public service.

Key stakeholder engagements during the period included:

DENOSA International Nurses' Day: 12 May 2025

The Democratic Nursing Organisation of South Africa (DENOSA) hosted an International Nurses' Day celebration on 12 May 2025 in Mpumalanga, at the Bushbuckridge Local Municipality, under the theme *"Caring for Nurses Strengthens Economies."* The TUM Sub-Unit participated and exhibited at the event, which recognised nurses' contributions and reflected on key sector challenges, including resource constraints, staff shortages, and working conditions.

Addressing the event, DENOSA General Secretary, Mr. Kwena Manamela, highlighted the ongoing shortage of nurses' uniforms currently under consideration at the bargaining council and encouraged unity in pursuing outstanding matters. The MEC for Health, Hon. Sasekani Mnzini acknowledged systemic challenges in the sector and emphasised the National Health Insurance (NHI) as a key intervention to improve healthcare outcomes.

The PSCBC delivered a message of support, reaffirming its commitment to improving working conditions and strengthening collective bargaining within the health sector.

NEHAWU International Nurses' Day: 21 May 2025

The National Education, Health and Allied Workers' Union (NEHAWU) hosted an International Nurses' Day celebration on 21 May 2025 in Mpumalanga under the theme *"Uplifting Austerity Measures to Free Nurses from the Bondage of Staff Shortages – Towards the Full Implementation of NHI."* The event brought together healthcare workers, government representatives, and nursing professionals to recognise nurses' contributions and reflect on sector challenges. The TUM Sub-Unit participated and exhibited at the event.

Delivering a keynote address, NEHAWU President, Cde. Mike Shingange, encouraged nurses to remain united, uphold professionalism, and contribute to broader social change. The MEC for Health, Hon. Sasekani Mnzini, emphasised the need to lift austerity measures affecting the healthcare system, particularly in preparation for the implementation of the National Health Insurance (NHI). She highlighted the importance of strengthening collaboration with the private sector, improving safety for nurses especially in rural areas and prioritising nurses' wellness through access to health and emotional support services.

Key discussions focused on staff shortages, training capacity constraints, and the need to strengthen healthcare delivery in preparation for NHI, while emphasising nurses' wellbeing, safety, and professional development.

The PSCBC delivered a message of support, acknowledging the challenges faced by nurses and reaffirming its commitment to improving working conditions and strengthening public service delivery.

NATU 107th Triennial National Conference: 03-05 September 2025

The TUM sub-unit attended and exhibited at the National Teachers' Union's (NATU) 107th Triennial National Conference held from 3-5 September 2025 in Boksburg under the theme *"Beyond the Classroom: Re-imagining Education Funding to Support Teachers and Transform Education."* The conference focused on strengthening education funding and support for educators.

The Minister of Public Service and Administration, Honourable Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi, highlighted systemic challenges affecting teachers and emphasised the importance of educator wellbeing and ethical leadership. The PSCBC General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, reaffirmed the importance of placing teachers at the centre of education reform and supporting collective bargaining.

The PSCBC congratulated the newly elected NATU leadership and reaffirmed its commitment to continued collaboration.

PEU Elective Congress: 01-03 October 2025

From 01 to 03 October 2025, the TUM Sub-Unit participated in and exhibited at the Professional Educators' Union (PEU) Elective Congress held at the Kopanong Conference Centre in Benoni, under the theme *"Strengthening Servant Leadership in Pursuit of Membership Growth Towards Driving Quality Education for All."*

The PSCBC delivered a message of support, emphasising unity, membership growth, improved working conditions for educators, and collaboration in advancing quality education.

The congress further featured an address by the Minister of Basic Education, Hon. Siviwe Gwarube, who highlighted the critical role of teachers and ongoing efforts to strengthen teacher development and professional training within the sector.

POPCRU Central Executive Committee Conference: 07-10 October 2025

The TUM sub-unit attended and exhibited at the Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union (POPCRU) Central Executive Committee Conference held from 7-10 October 2025 at Birchwood Conference Centre under the theme “Building a Sustainable Organisation in Defence of Collective Bargaining.” The PSCBC was represented by the Chairperson of Council, Mr Magate Phala, and the Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining, Ms Valencia Kola.

The conference highlighted the importance of unity within civil rights unions and the need to address key challenges affecting the sector, including police safety, and strengthening collaborative structures. POPCRU also announced its newly elected National Office Bearers, with the PSCBC extending congratulations to the newly elected leadership.

NAPTOSA 8th National Congress: 04-05 November 2025

The TUM sub-unit actively participated in National Professional Teachers' Organisation of South Africa (NAPTOSA's) 8th National Congress held on 4-5 November 2025 at Emperors Palace Convention Centre in Johannesburg under the theme “Believing, Planning, Caring and Fighting.” The congress served as a platform to engage on key issues affecting the education sector, including educator wellbeing, school safety, and learner support.

Discussions emphasised the importance of strengthening collaboration and continuously supporting educators as the backbone of the education system to ensure a conducive teaching and learning environment.

The PSCBC General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, delivered a virtual message of support highlighting the significance of the congress in shaping organisational direction and labour relations.

The PSCBC also noted and welcomed the appointment of NAPTOSA leadership and extended congratulations to the newly elected office bearers.

POPCRU North West Wellness Day: 27 February 2026

On 27 February 2026, the Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union (POPCRU) North West hosted its first Annual Wellness Day at the Potchefstroom Correctional Centre. The initiative aimed to promote employee wellness, unity, and resilience within the correctional services environment, with a focus on health awareness and financial literacy.

TUM subunit attended and engaged with participants through an exhibition stand, facilitating discussions on mental health awareness and psychosocial support in the workplace.

The event reflected POPCRU's commitment to enhancing employee wellbeing and workplace morale, with the PSCBC supporting the initiative as part of efforts to promote a productive and resilient public service workforce.

PSETA Training:

The TUM sub-unit also provided administrative support in the coordination and implementation of training interventions through PSETA, delivered in collaboration with the GPSSBC to further capacitate the public service in line with Public Service Summit Resolution 1 of 2022, which emphasises strengthening skills development and labour relations capacity.

Training interventions delivered included:

- Non-pivotal Dispute Management and Negotiation Skills training
- Manage the Development and Performance of Human Capital in the Public Sector (US ID 119336)
- Apply Public Service Labour Legislation in Mediation (US ID 119954), delivered in collaboration with GPSSBC and PHSDSBC

The initiatives undertaken during the reporting period demonstrate the Unit's continued commitment to strengthening labour relations, enhancing stakeholder engagement, improving membership systems, and supporting capacity development within the public service.

THE YEAR AHEAD:

The current reporting period was exceptionally active, and we anticipate a similar pace in the coming year. Early in the new cycle, the Council will adopt the report from the 2026 Strategic Planning Sessions, alongside an operational plan to achieve the agreed objectives. Core focus remains on the full implementation of existing resolutions, navigating complex medical aid challenges, and executing the new five-year strategic plan.

Following the 2026 Strategic Planning Session, the Council will prioritize modernization and good governance. The Unit is committed to exploring how technology and the Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR) can optimise public service delivery and streamline collective bargaining processes. Additionally, we will continue to finalize outstanding matters carried over from the 2022 Collective Bargaining Summit.

Through the Public Service Summit Declaration Task Team, work will continue toward the professionalisation of the public service. A key priority is enhancing the integration of women, youth, and persons with disabilities into both Council processes and the broader public service.

To support these efforts, the Council intends to expand member induction and negotiator training to internal structures and provincial chambers to strengthen overall bargaining capacity.

Collective Bargaining Committees are expected to finalize recommendations for the Council on several critical matters, including:

- Comprehensive danger insurance and a new bursary scheme.
- Childcare and breastfeeding facility provisions.
- Reviews of the Disciplinary Code and the Resolution Establishing Chambers.
- Picketing Rules and the Incentive Policy Framework.

A high-level workshop is scheduled to evaluate the current GEHS strategy and develop a roadmap for affordable housing. Simultaneously, the Council will address the ongoing dispute regarding the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS). Engagement will be intensified to "re-anchor" GEMS to its founding principles of providing affordable and accessible healthcare for public servants.

The Council will advance the centralisation of Trade Union Membership administration. In collaboration with Labour and the designated service provider, The Unit, through TUM will support the development of the Trade Union Membership Management System, focusing on

system readiness, data integrity, and compliance. Furthermore, the Unit will strengthen collaboration through active participation in union and sector platforms, and support ongoing skills development initiatives via PSETA, in alignment with Public Service Summit Resolution 1 of 2022.

Despite the complexity of these processes, the Unit remains resilient. We are committed to providing the Council with efficient, transparent platforms that foster strong stakeholder relations and fulfill the PSCBC's strategic objectives.

DRAFT

SECTION 3: DISPUTE MANAGEMENT

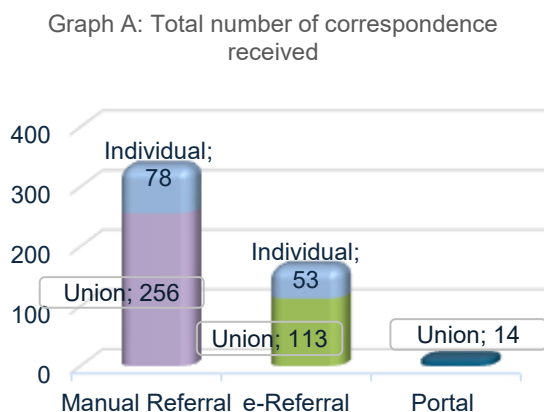
Background

The Council is accredited to perform dispute resolution functions in terms of section 127 of the Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995 as amended. The functions performed by the Council include resolving and preventing disputes and maintaining labour peace.

The annual report reflects on the referrals received by the Council from 1 April to 31 March 2026 (2025/26), compared with those from the previous reporting period (2024/25), the processes conducted/scheduled, and enforcement complaints received during the current period.

Statistics

New Referrals and complaints by platform



**Manual referrals remain the dominant submission method, largely driven by unions*

A total of 329 referrals, 31 complaints, 154 arbitrations (514 correspondences) were referred using three platforms namely:

- Manual Referral Form (334)
 - Unions contributed **256**; 152 referrals, 97 arbitration requests and 7 complaints.
 - Individual employees contributed 78; 70 referrals, 5 arbitration requests and 3 complaints
- e-Referral Form (166)
 - Unions contributed **113**; 60 referrals, 42 arbitration requests and 11 complaints.
 - Individual employees contributed 53; 39 referrals, 4 arbitration requests and 10 complaints
- PSCBC Portal (14)
 - Unions contributed **8** referrals & **6** arbitrations requests from SAPU (11) and PSA (3).

Number of cases received and screened

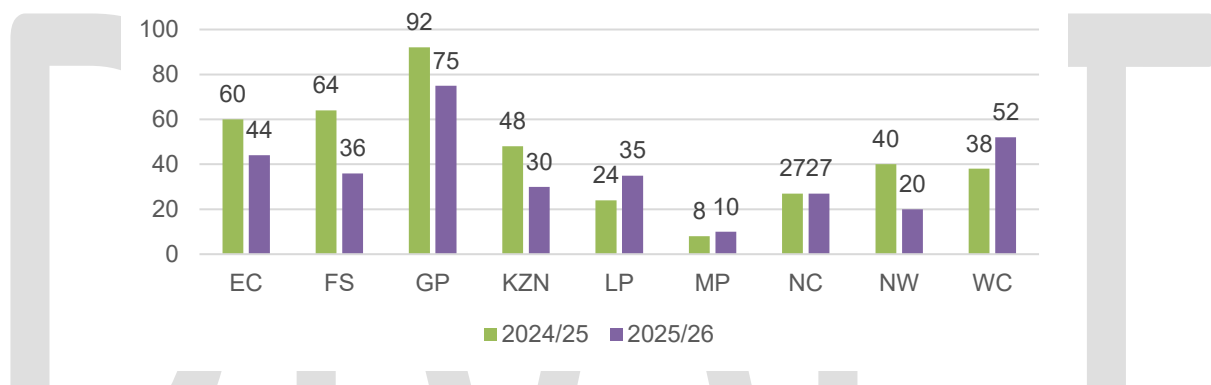
Graph B: Total number of referrals screened



From 1 April to 31 March 2026, **329** referrals were captured and screened compared to **401** in the same previous reporting period, resulting in an 18% decrease in the referral rate.

A breakdown of the referrals screened by provinces

Graph C: A breakdown by provinces of the total screened referrals



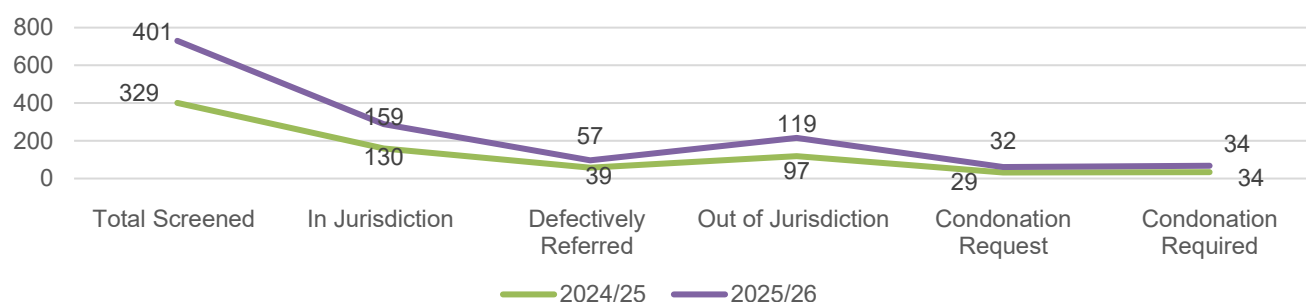
- The overall referral rate has declined, except in the Limpopo and Western Cape provinces, which have seen a slight increase in referrals.
- Gauteng Province received the highest number of referrals, accounting for 23% of the referral rate, compared to 23% in the previous reporting period.
- The Western Cape is the second-highest referring province, representing 16% of the referral rate, compared to 9% in the previous reporting period.

A breakdown of the referrals screened in/out of jurisdiction¹ and defective²

¹ Disputes relating to unfair labour practice, unfair dismissals, unilateral change to terms and conditions of employment, sector resolutions, no nature of the dispute or resolution indicated.

² Defective referrals are those with incomplete information, no date of the dispute, no proof of services, etc.

Graph D: A breakdown of referrals screened - (screening outcomes)



Screening outcomes – 2024/25

401 – total screened

- 159 – in jurisdiction (40%)
- 57 – defectively referred (14%)
- 119 – out of jurisdiction (30%)
- 32 – pending condonation application (8%)
- 34 – required condonation (8%)

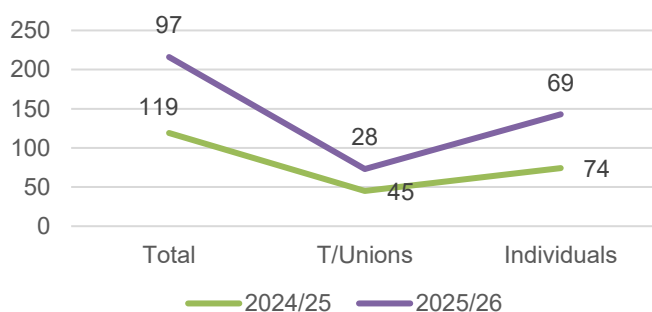
Screening outcomes – 2025/26

329 – total screened

- 130 – in jurisdiction (40%)
- 39 – defectively referred (12%)
- 97 – out of jurisdiction (29%)
- 29 – pending condonation application (9%)
- 34 – required condonation (10%)

Referrals screened out of jurisdiction by trade unions/individuals

Graph E: Out of jurisdiction referrals by trade unions / individuals



Out of jurisdiction referrals – trade unions

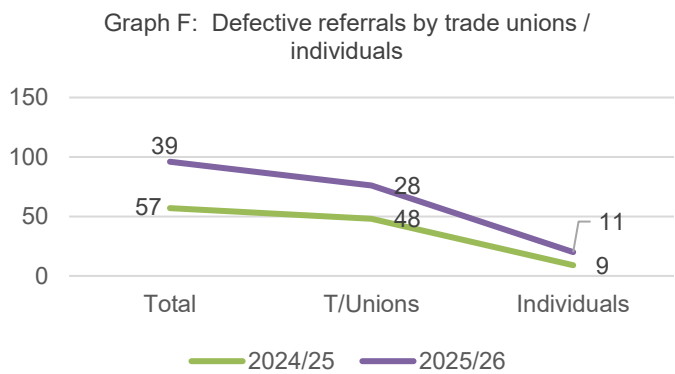
- During the reporting period, 29% of the referrals screened out of jurisdiction are from the trade union parties, compared to 38% in the previous reporting period.

Out of jurisdiction referrals – individual employees

- 71% of the out of jurisdiction referrals are received from individual employees. In the previous reporting period, this figure was 62%.

* The stats indicate a decline where trade unions are concerned and an increase in the individual employees.

Referrals screened defective by trade unions/individuals



Defective referrals – trade unions

- During the reporting period, 72% of referrals that are screened and found to be defectively referred came from trade union parties, compared to 84% in the previous reporting period.

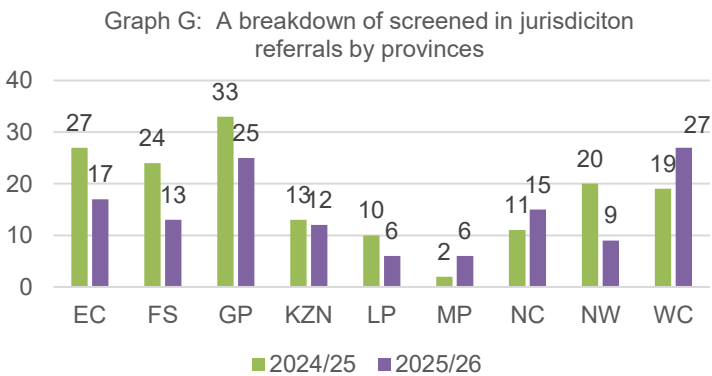
Defective referrals – individual employees

- In the current reporting period, 28% of referrals screened as defective are filed by individual employees, compared to 16% in the previous reporting period.

* The stats indicate a slight decline where trade unions are concerned, as opposed to an incline where individuals are concerned.

Referrals screened in jurisdiction

In jurisdiction referrals by provinces



2025/26

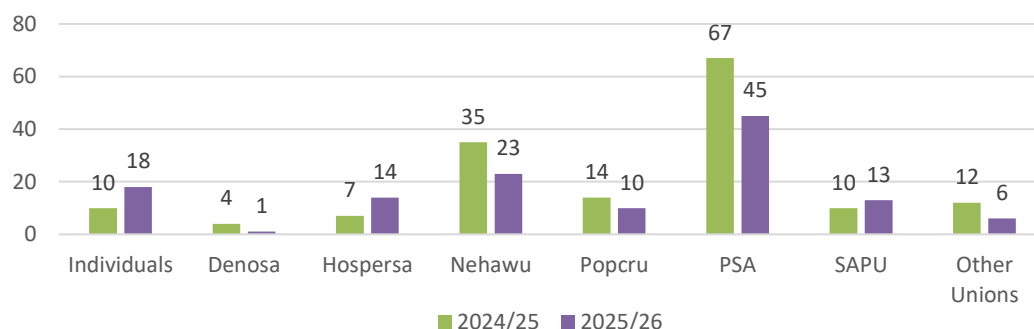
- A total of 130 referrals were screened in jurisdiction.
- The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals are received from the Western Cape, Gauteng and Eastern Cape provinces.

2024/25

- A total of 159 referrals were screened in jurisdiction.
- The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals were received from the Gauteng, Eastern Cape and Free State provinces.

In jurisdiction referrals by trade unions/individuals

Graph H: A breakdown of referrals screened in jurisdiction by trade unions / individuals



2025/26

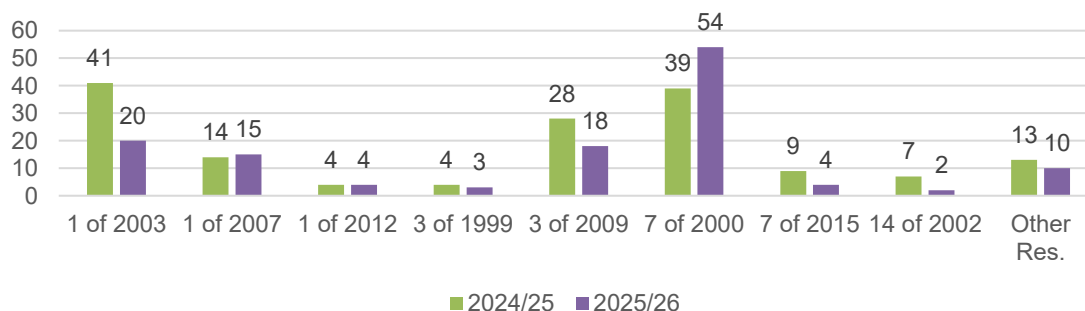
- In this period, referrals from PSA account for 35% of the total referrals in the jurisdiction, while referrals by Nehawu are at 18%.

2024/25

- During this period, referrals from PSA represented 42% of the total referrals, with Nehawu contributed 22%, making it the second highest source of referrals received in jurisdiction.

In jurisdiction referrals by the nature of the dispute/issue

Graph I: In jurisdiction referrals by issue/nature of the dispute



The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the cases referred-

- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 2003³ account for 15% and 26% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 2000⁴ account for 42% and 25% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 3 of 2009⁵ account for 14% and 18% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes referred in terms of Resolution 14 of 2002⁶ has been significantly reduced from 5% in the previous reporting period to 2% in compliance with clauses F8 & F11 of Resolution 14 of 2002.

³ Disciplinary procedure in the Public Service.

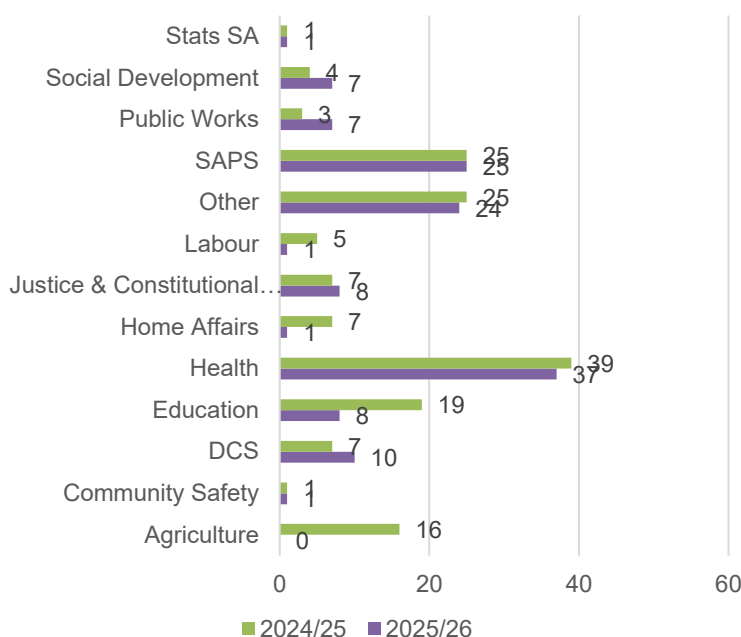
⁴ Improvement in the conditions of service of the Public Service employees – leave provisions.

⁵ Revised salary structure for employees on salary levels 1-12 not covered by OSD.

⁶ Grievance Rules for the Public Service.

In jurisdiction referrals within the departments

Graph J: In jurisdiction referrals received within departments



2025/26

- The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals are recorded within the departments of Health and South African Police Services.

2024/25

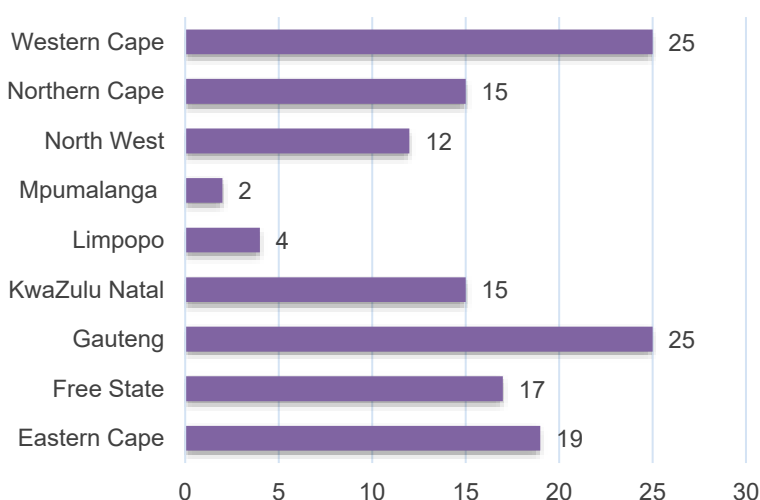
- The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals were recorded within the departments of Health and South African Police Services.

Arbitration requests received

- A total of **154** new arbitration requests were received from 1 April to 31 March 2026, whereas 165 new arbitration requests were received for the previous reporting period.
- Of the 154 requests, **134** were properly submitted, while **20** were not.

Breakdown of arbitration requests received by province

Graph K: Arbitration Request per Province



- The Gauteng, Western Cape and Eastern provinces received the most requests for arbitration, while Mpumalanga and Limpopo received the least.

Processes conducted/scheduled

Graph L: A breakdown of the processes conducted



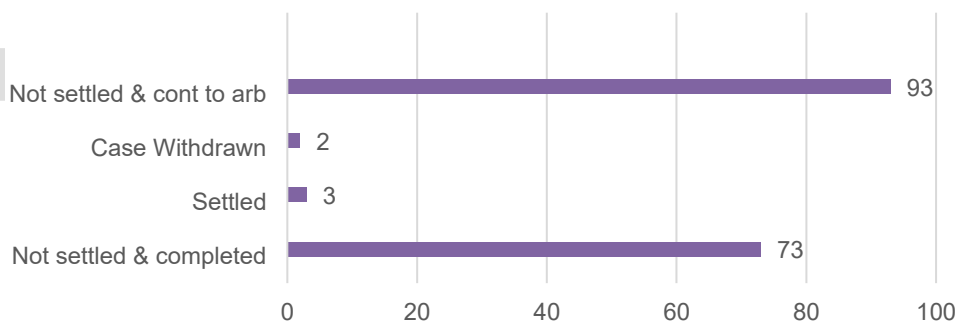
- A total of **469** processes were scheduled/conducted in comparison to **442** in the previous reporting period, resulting in a slight 6% increase. In addition, **6** Compliance Arbitrations were conducted.
- The following processes were conducted/scheduled:- **6** rescissions in terms of Section 144 of the LRA; **41** in limine hearings (preliminary hearings on specific legal points held before the merits of a case are heard); **171** conciliations and **245** arbitrations.

Conducted processes outcomes

Conciliation outcomes

- At the conciliation phase, 97% of conciliations are unresolved. Of the 97% that remained unresolved, 54% have been referred to arbitration.
- The settlement and withdrawal rate at the conciliation level were both at a 1% each.

Graph M: A breakdown of conciliation outcomes



Arbitration outcomes

The Council conducted 245 arbitration processes. The outcomes from these processes are as follows: 51 awards were rendered, 86 cases were postponed (49 postponed by ruling & 37 by party request), 16 disputes were withdrawn, and 12 settlements were reached.

- 7% of the disputes were withdrawn at the arbitration level.
- There is a 35% rate of postponements. Various reasons contributed to the postponements by both parties and panellists, including:
 - Limited or poor connectivity on virtual platforms.

- Agreements made between the parties, with little to no reasons provided.
- Parties attempting to reach a settlement.
- Postponements pending further discussions between the parties.

Additionally, the pre-arbitration process outlined in the Dispute Resolution Procedure⁷ is rarely utilized by the parties with a usage rate of less than 1%.

Graph N: A breakdown of arbitration outcomes

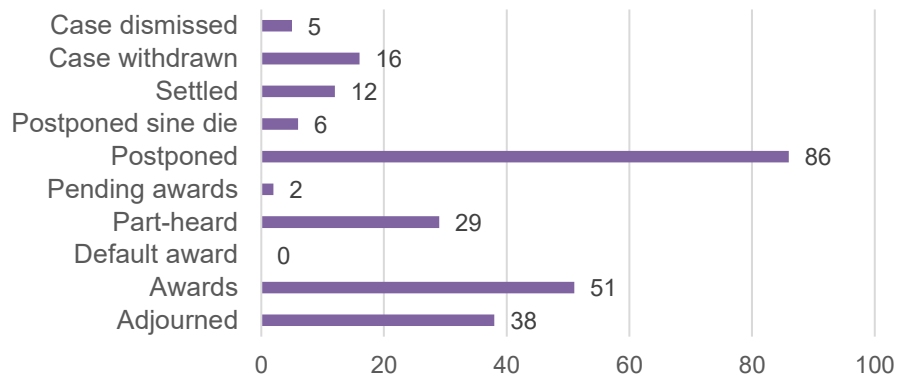


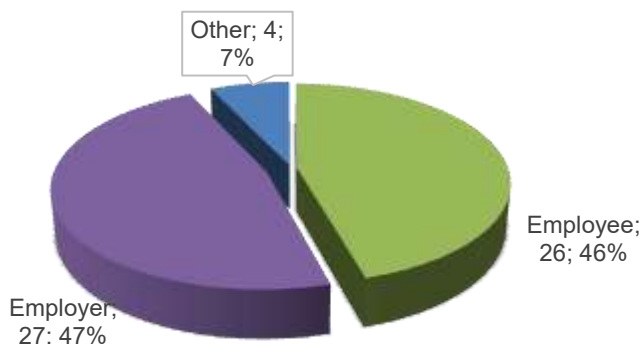
Table A: A breakdown of arbitration outcomes by provinces

OUTCOMES	EC	FS	GP	KZN	LP	MP	NC	NW	WC	Total
Adjourned	5	12	6	2	1	0	2	5	5	38
Awards	6	6	11	5	1	0	8	9	5	51
Default award	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Part heard	5	3	8	3	0	2	3	0	5	29
Pending awards	0	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	2
Postponed	14	23	17	8	4	1	2	8	9	86
Postponed sine die	1	0	2	1	1	0	0	0	1	6
Settled	5	2	0	1	0	0	1	1	2	12
Case Withdrawn	2	2	5	1	3	0	1	2	0	16
Case Dismissed	0	1	1	1	0	0	0	2	0	5
Total	38	49	50	24	10	3	17	27	27	245

⁷ Clause 5.4 of the PSCBC DR Procedure.

Arbitration awards in favour of employee, employer and other

Graph O: Awards rendered in favour of



- From 1 April to 31 March 2026, a total of **57** arbitration awards were issued, regardless of when the arbitrations were heard and finalized.
- **26** awards were ruled in favour of the union/employee party, accounting for 46% of the awards issued.
- **27** awards were ruled in favour of the employer party, representing 47% of the awards issued
- **4** awards were neither in favour of the union/employee party nor the employer party, making up 7% of the awards rendered.

A highlighted breakdown of the awards rendered by issue

- **7** awards were issued concerning Resolution 3 of 2009 – revised salary structure of employees not covered by the OSD on level 1 to 12 – grade progression; 6 awards were in favour of the employer party, and 1 award was in favour of the employee party.
- **22** awards were issued in relation to Resolution 7 of 2000 – improvement in the conditions of service – leave provisions; 14 awards were in favour of the employee party and 8 awards were found in favour of the employer party.
- **2** awards were issued in relation to Resolution 07 of 2015 – housing allowance, and the 1 award was found in favour of the employee party, and 1 was found in favour of the employer party.
- **8** awards were issued in relation to Resolution 1 of 2003 – disciplinary procedure; 3 awards were found in favour of the employee party, 4 awards were found in favour of the employer party, and 1 award was found neither in favour of the employee nor in favour of the employer but “other”.
- **2** awards were issued in relation to Resolution 03 of 1999 – remunerative allowances and benefits; 1 award was found in favour of the employee party and 1 award was found neither in favour of the employee nor in favour of the employer but “other”.

Outcomes of *in limine* processes

A total of 41 *in limine* processes were conducted during this reporting period, with 13 ruled in the jurisdiction and continued as arbitrations, 1 was pending an outcome and 27 were ruled out of jurisdiction and remain closed.

Outcomes of rescission processes

A total of 6 rescission applications were made under Section 144 of the LRA; 3 applications were not properly referred as they did not fall under the scope of S144, while 3 applications were not rescinded.

Enforcement complaints

Following the conclusion of Resolution 03 of 2023, the enforcement of Collective Agreements in the public service, a total of **24 enforcement complaints** were received during this reporting period.

Since the signing of the resolution, **31 enforcement complaints** have been received in total. Of these, **9** were screened to be **outside of jurisdiction**, **7** are currently **under investigation** pending resolution, **6** were **finalised** and closed, **12** were found **non-compliant**, **1** was **compliant** and **6** were scheduled for **compliance arbitrations**.

From the enforcement complaints lodged, **6** were scheduled and conducted as compliance arbitrations, with the outcomes reflected in Table B below.

Table B: Compliance Arbitrations in the period 2025/26

Case Number	Outcome	PSCBC Resolution/Issue	Province	Complaint By
PSCBC-E01-25/26	Compliance Award Rendered (in favour of EE + cost order)	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	EC	Applicant party
PSCBC-E02-25/26	Compliance Award Rendered (in favour of "other")	Res 03 of 2009 (Revised salary structure)	KZN	Applicant party
PSCBC-E13-24/25	Postponed and rescheduled	Res 07 of 2015 (housing allowance)	EC	Applicant party
PSCBC-E23-24/25	Compliance Award Rendered (in favour of EE + cost order)	Res 01 of 2007 (Improved salary & conditions)	KZN	Applicant party
PSCBC-E34-24/25	Postponed and rescheduled	Res 01 of 2007 (Improved salary & conditions)	EC	Applicant party
PSCBC-34-24/25	Compliance Award Rendered (in favour of EE + cost order)	Res 01 of 2007 (Improved salary & conditions)	EC	Applicant party

Cases on review

A total of four (4) cases have been taken on the review process at the Labour Court. From the total cases, all four (4) of the review processes were initiated by the applicant party in this reporting period.

Table C: Matters taken to the Labour Court for review in the period 2025/26

Case Number	Outcome	LC Number	PSCBC Resolution/Issue	Reviewed By
PSCBC192-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	2025-035520	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Applicant party
PSCBC185-25/26	Pending Labour Court Appeal	2025-233444	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Applicant party
PSCBC102-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	2025-234560	Res 07 of 2000 (leave provisions)	Applicant party
PSCBC169-25/26	Pending Labour Court Appeal	2026-047238	Res 03 of 2009 (grade progression)	Applicant party

**for noting: The Labour Court on 29 January 2026 heard the consolidated case JR1595/23, JR1544/23, JR160/24, JR1879/23, JR2129/23 on Res 1 of 2003 which was referred in 2023. The judgement was handed down on 05 March 2026.

Council has taken a further step to review the Collective agreement and has subsequent to that appealed the decision by the Labour Court.

Way forward

- Efforts continue to be underway to educate and train parties to council parties on the use and benefits of the portal. While the parties are gradually gaining confidence in the introduced online platforms, interaction numbers on the portal remain relatively low.
- The Council is aware of the high rate of referrals that fall outside its jurisdiction, primarily due to a lack of understanding regarding the roles of the PSCBC and the sector councils. To address this issue, the PSCBC and GPSSBC have rolled out a

training programme to educate parties, amongst other things, on the sectoral jurisdictions.

- Another challenge relating to jurisdiction is the miscategorization of disputes in the industry. Initiatives focusing on educating employees of the different councils and CCMA on the categorization of disputes are crucial, as this will expedite dispute processing.
- It is important to note that referrals from individual employees remain high, with an increasing number of employees opting for self or legal representation rather than trade union representation. Council has, however, noted the significant difference between referrals received from individual employees and those that fall within its jurisdiction.
- The settlement rate remains low, despite the CCMA efficiency requirement to achieve a 40-49% settlement rate. The CCMA has been made aware of this challenge within the public sector environment and has accordingly amended its accreditation policy to focus on two statutory requirements: finalising conciliations within 30 days and issuing no late awards. The Council has been excelling in meeting these requirements.
- The Council continues to urge the parties to ensure they comply with argument submission deadlines to ensure no awards are rendered late, as failure to meet this requirement could affect the Council's accreditation.

Date of the Report: May 2026

SECTION 4: RESIDENT PANELLIST

Background

Dispute resolution and prevention are core functions to attaining labour peace. The Resident Panellist Unit provides essential support to the Council towards achieving its strategic objectives.

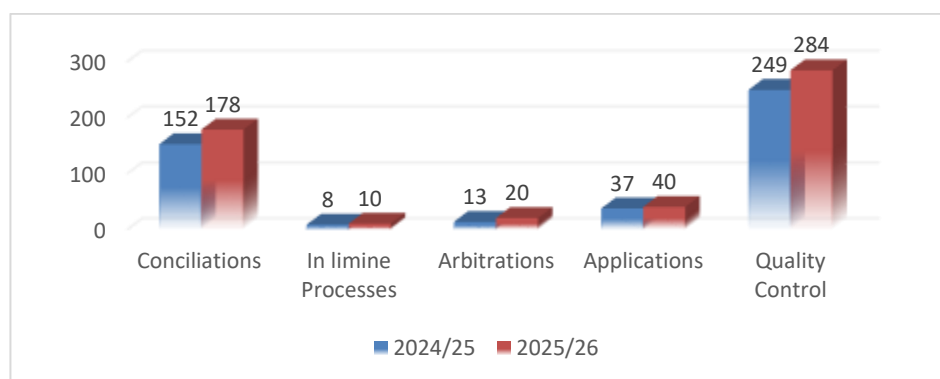
This report reflects on the processes conducted by the Resident Panellists from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 with a comparison of the processes conducted in the previous reporting period.

It should be noted that the cases referred to in this report and the subsequent statistics are solely based on the cases that sat before the Resident Panellists, meaning that if a case was withdrawn before the hearing date it would not form part of this report. Therefore, the number of conciliations and arbitrations conducted in this report and the number of conciliations and arbitrations conducted in the Dispute Resolution Unit's report will not always be similar.

1. Overview of processes conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit

The graph below provides a high-level summary of the total number of key processes conducted during the current reporting period compared to the previous period.

Graph One: Overview of Processes conducted



Notable shifts include:

- Conciliations & *in limine* processes have increased by 18%.
- Arbitrations have increased by 54%.

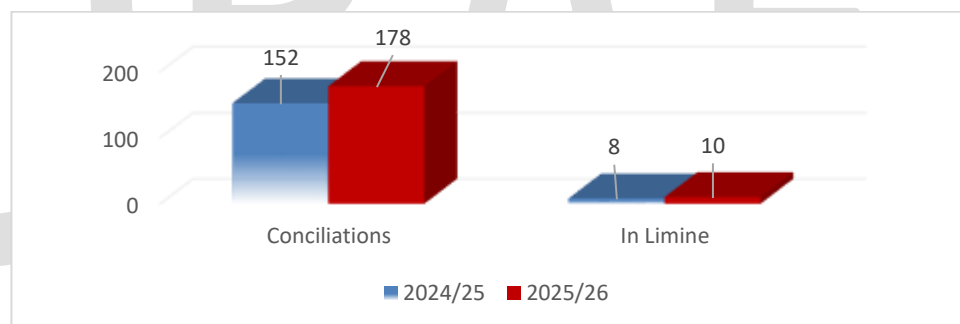
- Applications saw an 8% increase, suggesting an upward trend in procedural requests.
- Quality Control (Awards and Rulings) showed a 14% increase.

This serves as a summary of overall activity and trends. The sections that follow will provide a detailed breakdown of each process area, including outcomes, regional patterns, and department-specific insights.

2. Number of Conciliations and *In Limine* Processes Conducted

A total number of 178 conciliations - of which 10 were *in limine* processes - were set down and conducted from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 in comparison to 160 conciliations – of which 8 were *in limine* processes - conducted in the previous reporting period (01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025), resulting in a 18% increase in the conciliations and *in limine* processes conducted.

Graph Two: Comparison of the number of conciliations & *in limine* processes conducted



There were 10 *in limine* processes - where jurisdictional points were raised during the hearing - conducted between 01 April 2025 and 31 March 2026. This represents a 25% increase compared to the 8 *in limine* processes recorded during the previous reporting period (01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025).

3. Nature of Dispute

In both the reporting periods, all the conciliations that were conducted were interpretation and/or application disputes.

4. Cases Attended by Representatives of Unions

There is an overall decrease in attendance by Unions at the conciliations conducted from 89% to 83%, with significant attendance decreases from NUPSAW (42% decrease from the previous reporting period) and HOSPERSA (26% decrease from the previous reporting period). However, there was a slight attendance increase from SAPU (13% increase from the previous reporting period)

Table A: A breakdown of attendance of representatives of the Applicant

Applicant	Current Reporting Period				Previous Reporting Period			
	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage
INDIVIDUAL	16	13	2	81%	9	8	1	89%
DENOSA	4	4	0	100%	3	3	0	100%
HOSPERSA	19	14	5	74%	8	8	0	100%
NAPTOSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NUPSAW	12	7	5	58%	4	4	0	100%
NEHAWU	36	31	5	86%	34	33	1	97%
POPCRU	14	12	2	86%	14	12	2	86%
PSA	57	48	9	84%	69	58	11	84%
SADTU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	20	19	1	95%	11	9	2	82%
SOLIDARITY	-	-	-	-	4	4	0	100%
SAOU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
SAEPU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	178	148	30	83%	160	143	17	89%

5. Cases Attended by Representatives of Unions per Province

There were significant decreases in attendance in North West (45%), Limpopo (23%), and KwaZulu-Natal (21%). However, there were significant increases in attendance in Mpumalanga (33%) and Eastern Cape (17%).

Table B: Number of conciliations attended by representatives of the Applicant per province

Trade Union	Current Reporting Period				Previous Reporting Period			
	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage
Eastern Cape								
DENOSA	1	1	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
HOSPERSA	9	8	1	89%	1	1	0	100%
NAPTOSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NEHAWU	3	3	0	100%	5	5	0	100%

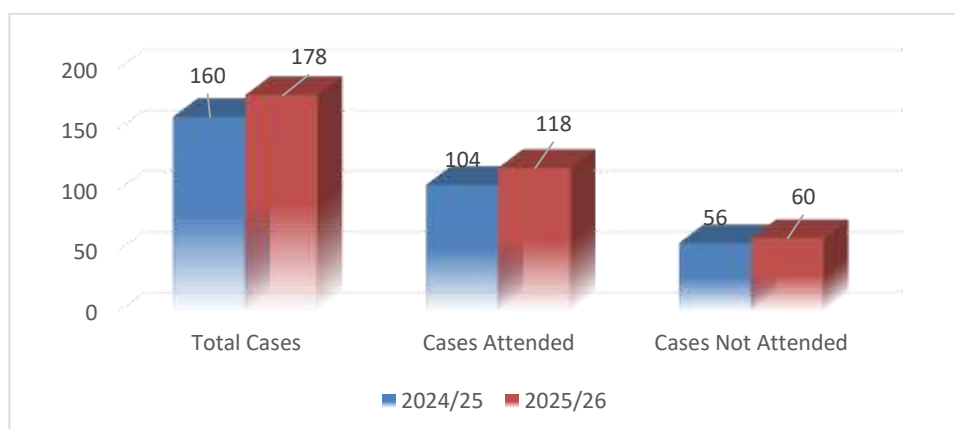
PSA	5	5	0	100%	15	10	5	67%
SAPU	4	4	0	100%	3	2	1	67%
TOTAL	22	21	1	95%	27	21	6	78%
Free State								
INDIVIDUAL	1	1	0	100%	1	0	1	0%
HOSPERSA	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
NEHAWU	12	10	2	83%	4	4	0	100%
NUPSAW	-	-	-	-	2	2	0	100%
POPCRU	1	1	0	100%	3	2	1	67%
PSA	7	6	1	86%	10	9	1	90%
SAEPU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	1	1	0	100%	4	3	1	75%
SOLIDARITY	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	23	20	3	87%	26	22	4	85%
Gauteng								
INDIVIDUAL	6	6	0	100%	-	-	-	-
DENOSA	2	2	0	100%	-	-	-	-
HOSPERSA	2	2	0	100%	3	3	0	100%
NEHAWU	8	8	0	100%	7	7	0	100%
NUPSAW	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
POPCRU	2	2	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
PSA	13	12	1	92%	15	13	2	87%
SADTU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	3	3	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
SOLIDARITY	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	37	36	1	97%	31	29	2	94%
KwaZulu-Natal								
HOSPERSA	2	2	0	100%	3	3	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	-	-	-	-	3	3	0	100%
NEHAWU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NUPSAW	9	5	4	56%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	2	2	0	100%	1	0	1	0%
PSA	4	4	0	100%	6	6	0	100%
SAPU	1	0	1	0%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	18	13	5	72%	14	13	1	93%
Limpopo								
HOSPERSA	1	0	1	0%	1	1	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	1	1	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
NEHAWU	-	-	-	-	1	0	1	0%
PSA	4	3	1	75%	5	5	0	100%
SAPU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	6	4	2	67%	10	9	1	90%
Mpumalanga								
INDIVIDUAL	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
PSA	5	4	1	80%	1	0	1	0%
SAPU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	6	5	1	83%	2	1	1	50%
North West								
DENOSA	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-

HOSPERSA	4	1	3	25%	-	-	-	-
NEHAWU	2	2	0	100%	7	7	0	100%
NUPSAW	1	0	1	0%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	1	0	1	0%	1	1	0	100%
PSA	7	4	3	57%	10	9	1	90%
SAOU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	16	8	8	50%	19	18	1	95%
Northern Cape								
INDIVIDUAL	1	0	1	0%	2	2	0	100%
NEHAWU	3	2	1	67%	-	-	-	-
NUPSAW	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	4	3	1	75%	2	2	0	100%
PSA	9	7	2	78%	6	5	1	83%
SOLIDARITY	-	-	-	-	2	2	0	100%
TOTAL	18	13	5	72%	12	11	1	92%
Western Cape								
DENOSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	7	5	2	71%	-	-	-	-
NEHAWU	8	6	2	75%	9	9	0	100%
NUPSAW	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
POPCRU	4	4	0	100%	5	5	0	100%
PSA	3	3	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	10	10	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
TOTAL	32	28	4	88%	19	19	0	100%

6. Cases Attended by Representatives of Departments

There is an overall increase in attendance of the conciliations conducted from 65% to 66%, the table below shows the comparison between the two reporting periods.

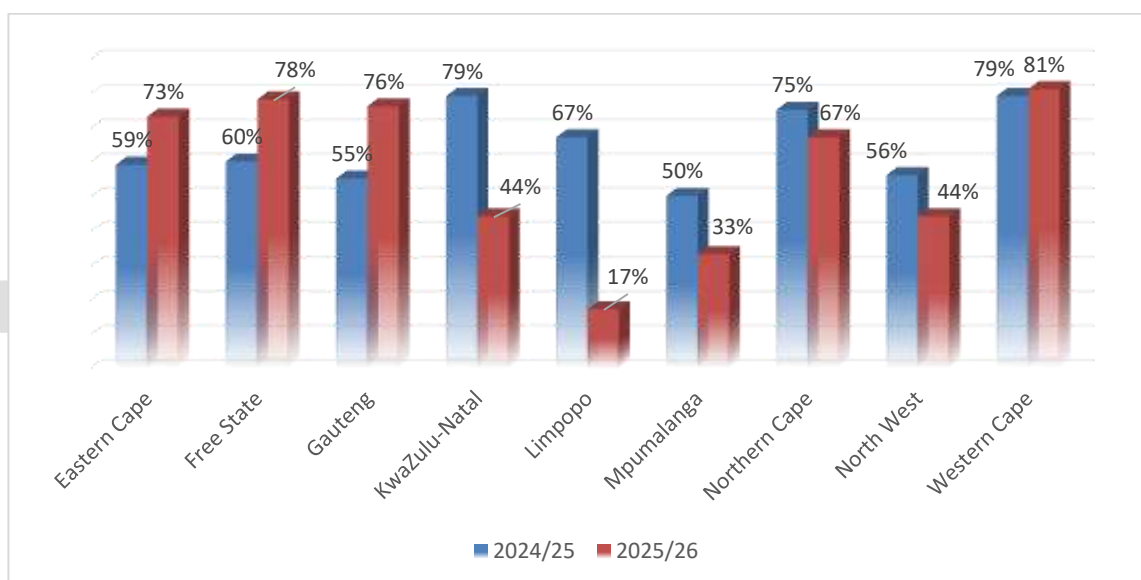
Graph Three: A breakdown of attendance of representatives of Departments



7. Cases Attended by Representatives of Departments per Province

There were significant increases in attendance in Gauteng (21%), Free State (18%) and Eastern Cape (14%). However, there were significant decreases in attendance in Limpopo (50%), KwaZulu-Natal (35%) and Mpumalanga (17%).

Graph Four: Percentage of conciliations attended by departments per province

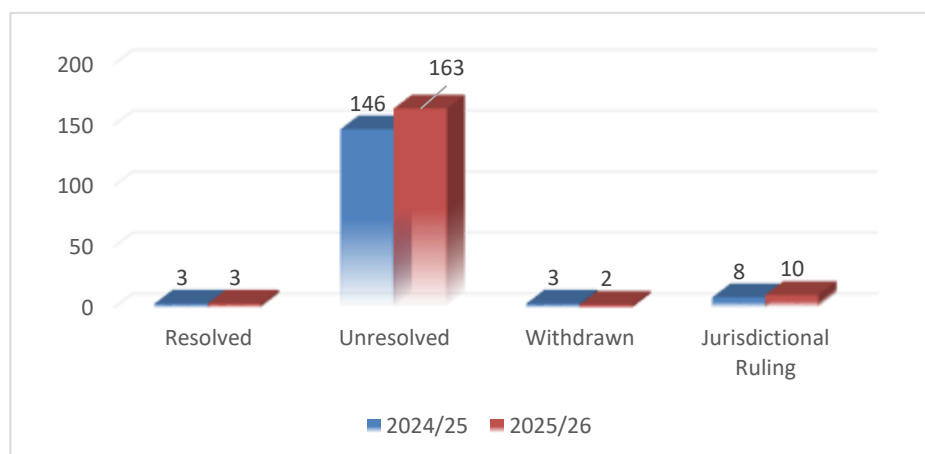


8. Outcomes of the Conciliations Conducted

There has been no change in the number of matters that have been resolved at conciliation. Unfortunately, there is still mistrust between parties. In some cases, there are settlements between parties, but the Applicant will opt to receive a certificate stating that the matter remains unresolved. This affords the Applicant the opportunity to refer the matter to arbitration in the event of the Respondent not complying with the proposed settlement.

There has been a decrease of 33% in the number of matters that have been withdrawn at conciliation. There has also been an increase of 25% in jurisdictional rulings (*in limine* processes) that have been made at conciliation, this is due to an increase in parties raising jurisdictional issues at conciliation. There has been an increase of 11 % in matters that remain unresolved.

Graph Five: Outcomes of the conciliations conducted



9. Key PSCBC Resolutions Driving Conciliation Outcomes

The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the conciliations conducted but remained unresolved: -

- Disputes relating to Resolution 01 of 2003 (Disciplinary Code and Procedures) - 41% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 37 cases to 22 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 2000 (Improvement in the conditions of service) - 94% increase from the previous reporting period (from 37 cases to 72 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 2007 (Improvement of salaries and other conditions of service) - 31% increase from the previous reporting period (from 13 cases to 17 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 3 of 2009 (Revised salary structure) - 11% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 28 cases to 25 cases).

The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the conciliations conducted that have been resolved: -

- Disputes relating to Resolution 01 of 2003 (Disciplinary Code and Procedures) – two cases.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 07 of 2000 (Improvement in the conditions of service) – one case

10. Cost Savings in Conducting Conciliations & *In Limine* processes

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting conciliations and *in limine* processes from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 totaling R 11 386.71 in comparison to R 9 690.82 in the same

period in the previous year which accounts for a 17% increase in the costs due to the increase in the number of cases conducted.

The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the conciliations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings that have been made because the conciliations were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table C: A breakdown of the cost savings in conducting conciliations

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
2025/26 – 178	R 1 850.00	R 329 300.00	R 10 781.03	R 318 518.97
2024/25 – 152	R 1 850.00	R 281 200.00	R 9 206.28	R 271 993.72

* Estimated cost: Number of cases x cost per case.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

Table D: A breakdown of the cost savings in conducting *in limine* processes

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	DOCUMENT FEE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
2025/26 – 10	(10 x 1 850) R 18 500.00	(10 x 500) R 5 000.00	R 23 500.00	R 605.68	R 22 894.32
2024/25 – 8	(8 x 500) R 14 800.00	(8 x 500) R 4 000.00	R 18 800.00	R 484.54	R 18 315.46

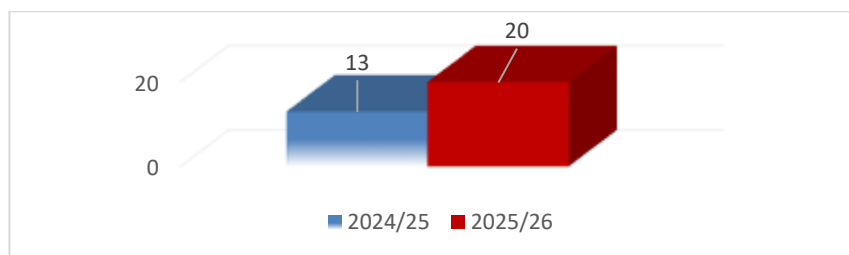
* Estimated cost: Cost per case + document fee.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

11. Number of Arbitrations Conducted

A total number of 20 arbitrations were conducted from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 in comparison to 13 arbitrations conducted in the previous reporting period (01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025), resulting in an 54% increase in the arbitrations conducted.

Graph Six: Comparison of the number of arbitrations conducted



The following are the outcomes for the arbitrations conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit:

- Adjournments – has increased from 1 case to 8 cases between the two reporting periods.
- Postponements – 10% increase from the previous reporting period.
- Jurisdictional Rulings – 100% increase from the previous reporting period.
- Withdrawals – 100% decrease from the previous reporting period.

12. Cost Savings in Conducting Arbitrations

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting arbitrations from 01 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 totaling R 9 690.82 in comparison to R 6 299.03 in the same period in the previous year which accounts for a 54% increase in the costs due to the increase in the number of cases conducted

The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the arbitrations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings that have been made because the arbitrations were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table E: A breakdown of the cost savings in conducting arbitrations

NUMBER OF CASES	DOCUMENT FEE	DAILY FEE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
Adjournment Ruling – 8	(8 x 500.00) R 12 000.00	(8 x 3 500.00) R 28 000.00	R 40 000.00	R 3 876.33	R 36 123.67
Jurisdictional Ruling – 1	(1 x 1 500.00) R 1 500.00	(1 x 3 500.00) R 3 500.00	R 5 000.00	R 484.54	R 4 515.46
Postponement – 8	(8 x 1 500.00) R 12 000.00	(8 x 3 500.00) R 28 000.00	R 40 000.00	R 3 876.33	R 36 123.67
Settled - 1	–	(1 x 3 500.00) R 3 500.00	R 3 500.00	R 484.54	R 3 015.46

Withdrawals –	–	(2 x 3 500.00) R 7 000.00	R 7 000.00	R 969.08	R 6 030.92
2					
			R 95 500.00	R 9 690.82	R 85 809.18

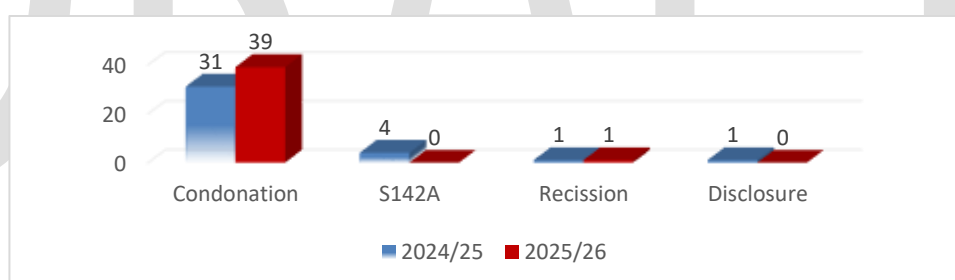
* Estimated cost: (Number of cases x document fee) + (number of cases x daily fee)

^ Actual cost: Number of cases x estimated hours the Panellist would have spent / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries of Resident Panellists during reporting period.

13. Applications

The Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with dealing with some of the applications received by the Council. These applications include condonation applications, S142A applications and rescission applications, to name a few. During the current reporting period a total of 40 applications were received in comparison to the 37 received in the previous reporting period – an increase of 8%.

Graph Seven: Number of applications dealt with by the Resident Panelist Unit



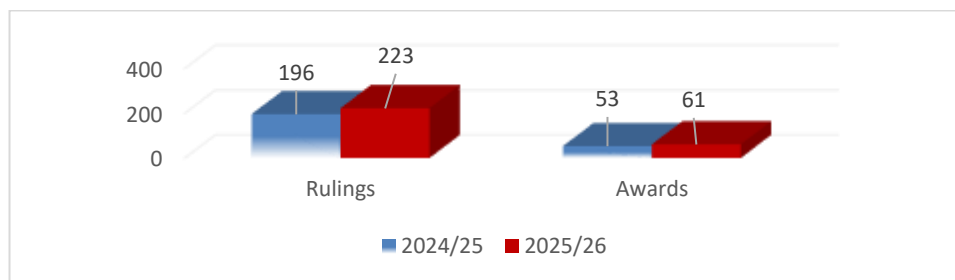
Compared to the previous reporting period the number of condonation applications has increased by 26%. S142A applications have decreased by 100%. Disclosure of documents applications has decreased by 100% and Rescission applications have stayed unchanged.

There has been an increase of 14% in the number of applications granted (from 21 applications to 24) and no change in the number of applications refused (16 applications). These increases are due to the increase in the number of applications dealt with by the Resident Panellist Unit.

14. Quality Control

All the awards and rulings that are issued by the Council's panel of commissioners go through a strict quality assurance process as part of said process the Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with perusing awards and rulings. Below is a breakdown of the outcomes of the perusal process.

Graph Eight: Number of Rulings and Awards Perused



There has been an increase in the number of awards that have been perused by the Resident Panellist Unit during the quality checking process – a 15% increase. The change is due to an increase in awards that have been submitted by our external commissioners.

The increase in the number of awards perused has led to an increase of 11% in the number of awards that have been qualified (found that the award was in order). The number of awards that had to be updated (an external panellist was requested to make changes) has increased by 100% (from 1 to 2) between the two reporting periods.

There has been an increase in the number of rulings that have been perused by the Resident Panellist Unit during the quality checking process – a 11% increase from the previous reporting period to the current reporting period. This is due to an increase in the number of rulings that have been submitted by our external commissioners.

The increase in the number of rulings perused has led to an increase of 15% (from 194 to 223) in the number of rulings that have been qualified (found that the award was in order). The number of rulings that had to be updated (an external panellist was requested to make changes) has decreased by 100% (from 2 to 0) between the two reporting periods.

SECTION 5: STRATEGIC MONITORING, EVALUATION AND RESEARCH

INTRODUCTION

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research (SMER) Unit is a technical support function within the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC). Its primary mandate is to enable the Council and its constituent units to fulfil their strategic objectives through rigorous research, credible monitoring and evaluation, and the generation of evidence-based insights that inform collective bargaining and labour relations in the South African public service.

As a centre of expertise and knowledge within the PSCBC, the SMER Unit provides evidence based current data and statistics to support sound decision-making in council processes including but not limited to collective bargaining, and dispute management, in alignment with the needs of public servants, their representative trade unions and employer

This Annual Report presents a comprehensive account of the SMER Unit's deliverables , and contributions during the 2025/2026 reporting period. It reflects the Unit's commitment to excellence in research, monitoring and evaluation, active participation in national and international knowledge-sharing platforms, and its ongoing efforts to build robust evidence base for the advancement of labour relations in the South African public service.

UNIT'S STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research Unit is guided by the following strategic objective, which is directly aligned with the broader mandate of the PSCBC:

To promote effective and efficient coordination of labour relations

In pursuit of this overarching objective, the SMER Unit fulfils its mandate through the following key functions:

- a) Conducting research to inform collective bargaining, policy development, and strategic planning within the PSCBC and its stakeholder community.
- b) Monitoring the implementation of PSCBC collective agreements to assess compliance and identify areas requiring attention or intervention.
- c) Tracking and monitoring legislative amendments and new Bills that may affect the PSCBC's collective agreements and negotiating environment.
- d) Disseminating research findings and contributing to labour industry knowledge through conferences, publications, and collaborative platforms.

ANNUAL DELIVERABLES

During the 2025/2026 reporting period, the SMER Unit successfully delivered against its work programme across three key functional areas, as detailed below.

Research

The research function as one of the key functions of the SMER Unit's contribution to the PSCBC's strategic objectives completed a significant number of research projects within scope and time. During the reporting period, the Unit produced thirteen (13) substantive research outputs covering Trade Union Membership trends, healthcare governance, skills development, dispute management, training impact assessment, and legislative compliance. Each research project was designed to provide actionable intelligence that supports evidence-based decision-making within the Council and the broader public service labour relations environment.

Trade Union Research

Analysis of Trade Union Dual Membership Trends (Annual)

This analysis is conducted on an annual basis to determine the extent to which public servants are simultaneously affiliated to more than one trade union. The study provided critical data to inform the Council's understanding of membership patterns and their implications for representativeness, organisational rights, and collective bargaining dynamics within the public service.

Analysis of Trade Union Membership Trends (Quarterly)

The Trade Union Membership trends were produced on a quarterly basis, this analysis measured the numerical strength of each Trade Union admitted at the PSCBC. The report tracks both growth and declining membership trends across all recognised Trade Unions, providing the Council with current data to support decision-making on representativeness thresholds and related matters.

Agency Shop Agreement Report – Strategic Analysis of Trade Union Recruitment Opportunities

This strategic report quantifies the pool of non-unionised public servants across all provincial and national government departments. The report is designed to assist trade unions in identifying and leveraging recruitment opportunities within the public service, thereby supporting the expansion of organised labour representation in the public service.

Research on Recruitment Policies in the Public Service – Trade Union Observer Status

The research was informed by PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025, this research was commissioned to evaluate the extent to which government departments and their internal policies permit trade union representatives to observe the recruitment process. The study assessed the current state of practice across departments and examined whether observer status should be standardised throughout the public service, with a view to providing recommendations to the Council.

Research on Uniform Policies in the Public Service

The research was informed by PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025, this research was undertaken in response to the recognised absence of standardisation in the provision of uniforms to public servants whose occupational duties require the wearing of uniform. The study examined existing practices across departments and identified best practice frameworks to inform the development of a standardised approach to uniform provision in the public service.

Healthcare Governance Research

Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) Review Report

This research was conducted to evaluate whether the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) conforms to its founding funding principles of providing affordable, equitable, and quality healthcare to public servants. The review assessed GEMS with the aim of identifying areas of compliance, gaps, and opportunities for improvement in the scheme's administration and service delivery. The study informed council on the way forward in ensuring GEMS remained relevant to its members.

GEMS Customer Perceptions Survey

The GEMS Customer Perceptions Survey was conducted to obtain empirical data on the perceptions of GEMS members regarding the scheme and its product offerings. The findings provide GEMS and the PSCBC with direct member feedback on service satisfaction, affordability, and overall value, thereby informing strategic interventions to improve the member experience and strengthen trust in the scheme.

Research projects in Progress

Breast feed and child care facilities research

The research project was initiated based on the Resolution 2 of 2025. Research was conducted across government departments at national and provincial level. The research determined how the DPSA policy and directives were implemented and operationalised. The project was not completed in 2025 but extended into the 2026 financial year.

Comprehensive danger insurance.

The research project continued from the previous research conducted externally to conducted more in-depth analysis on six focus areas the council identified needed to be researched further. Resolution 2 of 2025 added that a further study be conducted on death grant and assessment of COIDA. The project has not been completed and extend into 2026 financial year.

Bursary scheme Research

The research project was initiated based on the Resolution 2 of 2025. The research on the development of a bursary scheme model for children of public service employees has been conducted but not completed and various stakeholders including the DHET have been engaged. The project will be completed in the financial year 2026.

Skills Development Research

CCPMP Skills Audit – Mpumalanga Chamber

The Mpumalanga Chamber (CCPMP) Skills Audit was conducted to determine the specific skills gaps and capacity-building needs of the Mpumalanga Chamber. The findings of the audit informed the development of targeted training and development interventions to equip the Chamber with the competencies required to fulfil its mandate effectively.

PSETA Training Initiatives Learner Withdrawal Survey

The PSCBC and the GPSSBC, in collaboration with the Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA), jointly facilitate skills development training for public servants. In response to a recurring challenge of participant withdrawals during training programmes, the SMER Unit conducted a survey to determine the underlying causes of withdrawal and identify the support mechanisms required to reduce withdrawal rates and improve programme completion.

Dispute Management Research

Evaluating the Dispute Referral Process

This research was undertaken in response to a persistent challenge of incorrect dispute referrals, whereby disputes that should have been directed to the PSCBC were instead referred to sectoral councils, and vice versa. The study investigated the root causes of these referral errors and identified practical solutions to improve the accuracy and efficiency of the dispute referral process, thereby reducing delays and ensuring that disputes are adjudicated by the appropriate forum.

Training Impact and Programme Evaluation

Public Administration Leadership Training Programme – Longitudinal Study

The longitudinal study comprised two evaluations conducted in phases, conducted at six months and twelve months following the conclusion of the training programme. The purpose of the study was to assess the sustained impact of the Public Administration Leadership Training Programme on participants' professional practice, and to determine whether the competencies acquired during training were being meaningfully applied in their day-to-day work responsibilities.

Impact Evaluation Report – Labour Dispute Training Programme

The SMER Unit conducted a comprehensive impact assessment of the Labour Dispute Training Programme, which was jointly delivered by the PSCBC and the GPSSBC in collaboration with PSETA. The evaluation was designed to determine the extent to which the programme had influenced the daily activities and professional competencies of participants, and to provide evidence-based recommendations for the refinement of future training interventions.

PSCBC Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Evaluation

The Unit conducted an impact evaluation of the PSCBC's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives. The evaluation assessed the tangible impact of these initiatives on their beneficiaries and examined the degree to which the Council's CSR activities are aligned with the genuine needs of the communities and individuals they serve. The findings inform the strategic direction of the PSCBC's social investment agenda.

Labour Relations Industry Knowledge Sharing

A key function of the SMER Unit is the active participation in, and contribution to, Labour relations industry knowledge-sharing platforms at both domestic and international levels. During the 2025/2026 reporting period, the Unit made significant contributions to five (5) prominent conferences and summits, producing a total of eight (8) papers on matters of strategic relevance to labour relations, gender equity, healthcare, and the evolving world of work. These engagements serve to position the PSCBC as a thought leader in public service labour relations and to advance knowledge exchange with peer institutions globally.

International Labour and Employment Relations Association (ILERA) Europa Conference

The PSCBC participated in the ILERA Europa Conference and presented two (2) papers, as follows:

- *The Influence of Gender Equity on Employment Relations and Social Policies in the South African Public Service.*

- *30 Years of Democracy and Gender Equity in the South African Public Service.*

These presentations contributed to international discourse on the intersection of gender equity, employment relations, and social policy, and showcased the progress and remaining challenges in South Africa's public service transformation.

South African Public Administration and Management (SAPAAM) Summit

The PSCBC contributed two (2) papers to the SAPAAM Summit, as follows:

- *The Impact of Labour Relations for Socio-Economic Transformation in South Africa.*
- *30 Years of Labour Relations in South Africa (1995 to 2025).*

These papers provided a substantive retrospective on the evolution of labour relations in South Africa over the past three decades, with particular emphasis on the contribution of collective bargaining to socio-economic transformation.

Labour Law and Compliance Summit

The PSCBC presented the following paper at the Labour Law and Compliance Summit:

- *30 Years of Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995 – Reflecting on Progress, Strengthening Partnerships and Shaping the Future of Work.*

This presentation marked the significant milestone of three decades since the enactment of the Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995, offering a reflective analysis of the gains achieved, the challenges that persist, and the strategic opportunities for further strengthening the legislative framework governing labour relations in South Africa.

GEMS Symposium 2025

The PSCBC made a contribution to the 2025 GEMS Symposium by presenting the following paper:

- *What Matters Most to Members.*

Drawing on the findings of the GEMS Customer Perceptions Survey, this presentation provided GEMS and its stakeholders with member-centred insights on priorities, concerns, and expectations, thereby supporting the scheme's strategic planning and service improvement agenda.

Trade Union Conference on Gender-Based Violence (GBV)

The PSCBC contributed to the Trade Union Conference on Gender-Based Violence by presenting the following paper:

- *Towards a Gender-Based Violence and Sexual Harassment Free Public Service.*

This contribution underscored the PSCBC's commitment to advancing safe and dignified workplaces in the public service and positioned the Council as an active stakeholder in the national effort to eradicate gender-based violence and sexual harassment in employment settings.

Literature Contributions

The SMER Unit also made contributions to knowledge production through literary and publications during the reporting period. These contributions serve to extend the reach and impact of the PSCBC's intellectual output beyond conferences and to contribute to the knowledge on public service labour relations.

PSCBC Commemorative Book: 'From Struggle to Structure – One Agreement at a Time'

In commemoration of the 30th anniversary of the Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995, the PSCBC authored and published a commemorative book titled 'From Struggle to Structure – One Agreement at a Time'. This publication records the journey of labour relations in South Africa, with a particular focus on the gains and milestones achieved through collective bargaining in the public service over the past three decades. The book serves as both a historical record and a testament to the enduring importance of social dialogue and negotiated governance in the public service.

ILERA Book Publication: 'World of Work: An African Perspective' (2026)

The PSCBC has made a substantive contribution to the forthcoming ILERA book publication titled 'World of Work: An African Perspective', scheduled for publication in 2026. The Unit's contribution encompassed both editorial review and chapter review, reflecting the PSCBC's recognised expertise in the field of public service labour relations from an African perspective. This participation positions the PSCBC as an active contributor to global academic discourse on the world of work.

MONITORING AND OVERSIGHT FUNCTIONS

In addition to its research and knowledge-sharing activities, the SMER Unit carries responsibility for two critical oversight functions that ensure the relevance and efficacy of the PSCBC's regulatory and collective bargaining framework:

Monitoring the Implementation of PSCBC Collective Agreements

The SMER Unit is responsible for systematically monitoring the implementation of collective agreements concluded at the PSCBC. This function involves tracking compliance and identifying implementation gaps or challenges.

Monitoring the Annual Performance Plan Targets

Through monthly reporting, the PSCBC monthly reporting assist in tracking the achievement of set targets to inform the Office of the GS and the PSCBC on the implementation of the strategic interventions quarterly.

Tracking Legislative and Regulatory Developments

The Unit actively monitors the introduction and progression of new legislative amendment Bills that may have implications for the PSCBC's collective agreements and bargaining mandate. This proactive tracking enables the Council to anticipate legislative changes, assess their potential impact, and engage timeously in legislative processes to protect the interests of public servants and their representative trade unions.

CONCLUSION

The 2025/2026 reporting period has been a year of significant productivity and strategic impact for the Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research Unit. The Unit delivered a comprehensive research programme that inform collective bargaining, policy development, and programme improvement across the PSCBC's mandate. The Unit's active participation in five major conferences and summits, both domestically and internationally, has further entrenched the PSCBC's reputation as a leading voice in public service labour relations.

The publication of the commemorative book marking thirty years of the Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995, as well as the Unit's contribution to the forthcoming ILERA publication, demonstrates the PSCBC's commitment to advancing knowledge production and contributing to the global body of literature on the world of work.

The SMER Unit remains steadfast in its commitment to providing rigorous, timely, and relevant analytical support to the Council. Looking ahead, the Unit will continue to strengthen its research agenda, deepen its monitoring and evaluation capabilities, and expand its contributions to industry knowledge, in service of the PSCBC's overarching goal of promoting effective and efficient coordination of labour relations in the South African public service.

SECTION 6: CORPORATE SERVICES

Overview

The Constitution of the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council provides for the functions and powers of the Council in relation to the finances, which are as follows:

- Establish and administer a fund to be utilized for resolving disputes, collective bargaining and general administration of the Council.
- Raise, borrow, lend, levy and invest funds in support of the Council's mandate.

Financial Committee

The Financial Committee has been established as a sub-Committee of the Council. The role of the Finance Committee is to scrutinise the financial activities of the Council and to make recommendations to the Executive Committee on these activities.

The Duties of the Financial Committee listed below are found in the Finance Policy and Procedure Manual

- Meet on a quarterly basis;
- Formulate financial policies and procedures;
- Recommend practical ways of implementing these policies;
- Review budgets and recommend to the Council;
- Review financial statements and ensure that financial policies and procedures are adhered to;
- Discuss the audited financial statements and management report with the auditors;
- Consider and recommend the acquisition of capital expenditure items within the budget;
- Discuss and manage the expenditure of special projects; and
- Cash flow management (including treasury functions).

Meetings

The Financial Committee held the following meetings during 2025/2026 period:

YE2026	14 MAY 2025	12 JUNE 2025	23 OCTOBER 2025	25 MARCH 2026
Mr M. Phala (Chairperson)	-	-	✓	✓
Mr M. Galorale (Vice-Chairperson Employer)	✓	✓	-	-
Mr A. Zungu (Vice-Chairperson Labour)	-	✓	-	-
Mr. D. Phala (Vice Chairperson Labour)	-	-	✓	-
Mr P. Sekutu (NEHAWU)	✓	✓	-	-
Mr. J. Mashego (PSA)	-	-	✓	✓
Ms L. Motshwane (SADTU)	✓	✓	-	✓
Ms. L. Hulana-Katz (DENOSA)	-	✓	✓	✓
Mr H. Brynard (DPSA)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Mr A. Mnene (DPSA)	✓	✓	✓	-
Ms F. Mokoena (National Treasury)	✓	-	✓	✓

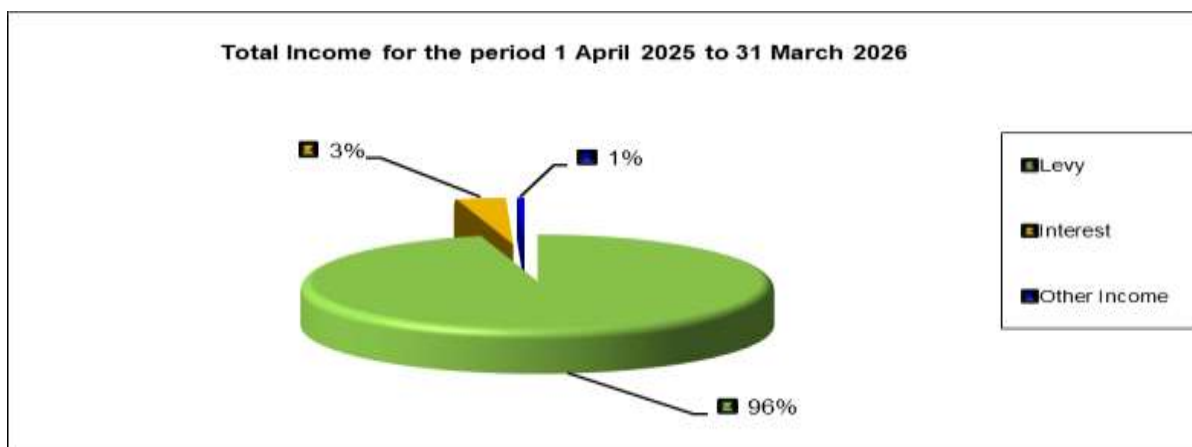
Financial analysis

Total Income – Levy Account

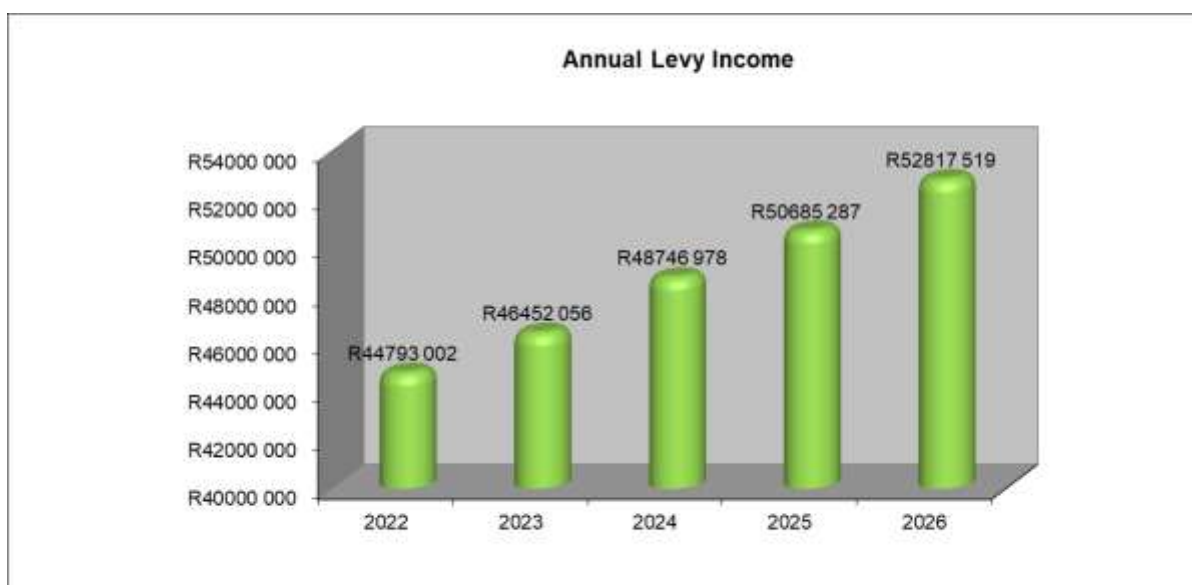
The overall income for the Council during the 2025/2026 financial year was R 55 038 258.27. The income base remained stable and predictable, with income primarily derived from levies. Total income for the period is categorised as follows:

- 96% was generated out of the levies from the public service as per Resolution 2 of 2013,
- 3% was generated from interest earned on levies and accumulated reserves,
- 1% was generated from other income sources.

Below income composition highlights the Council's reliance on levy income as its primary funding source. Levies received of R 52 817 519.26 slightly exceeded the projected income of R 52 057 497. Other income total of R 286 554.45 exceeded the projected amount of R100 350.00 due to proceeds received from motor vehicle insurance payout during the reporting period. Interest income was lower than budget due to investment withdrawals utilised to supplement the Council's monthly operational funding requirements.



The graph below illustrates the annual adjustments to the PSCBC levy over the period under review. These adjustments were implemented in line with National Treasury's projected year-on-year Consumer Price Index (CPI), as provided for in Resolution 2 of 2013.



During the period cycle the Council approved R2.00 (R1.00 per Party) levy increase, Resolution 1 of 2026, with effect from December 2025. A timing difference on the levy income recognized in the current financial year, as the adjustment was implemented by National Treasury subsequent to the current financial year, back dated to December 2025.

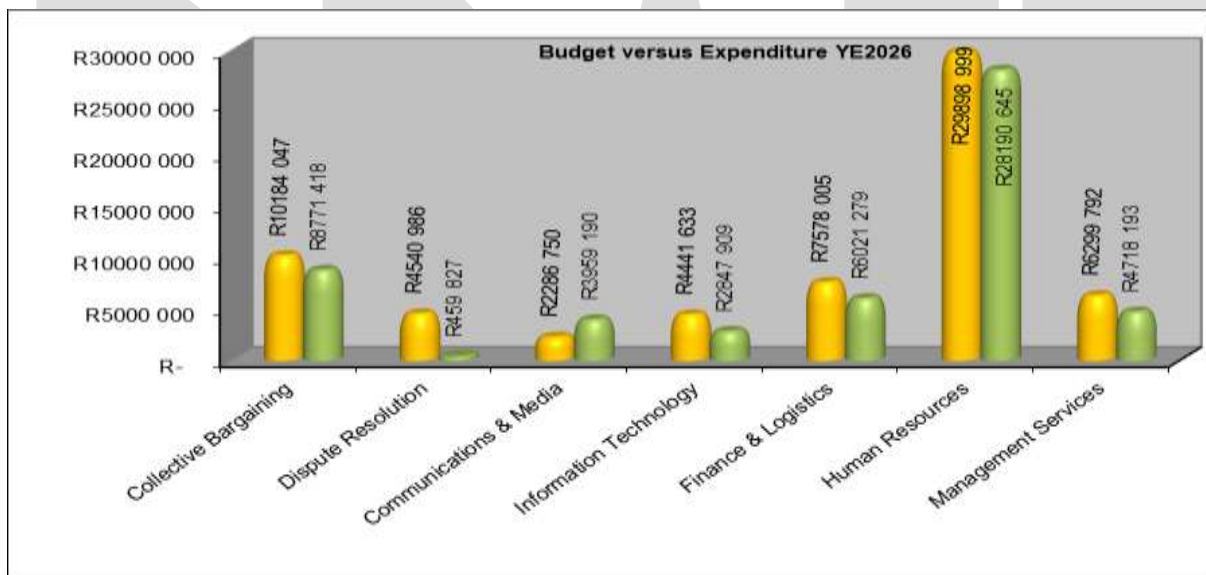
Total Expenditure – Levy Account

The overall expenditure for the Council during the 2025/2026 financial year amounts to R 54 968 461 which was lower than the projected expenditure of R 65 230 212.00.

Actual expenses across departments remained below approved budget allocations, with the exception of the Communications Unit. Included within the Communications Unit expenditure were various Council approved key stakeholder engagement and strategic initiatives, including:

- Annual General Meeting materials;
- Provincial Chamber Annual General Meetings;
- Strategic Planning materials.
- GENES Women's Leadership,
- NEHAWU, DENOSA, NATU, PEU, POPCRU, and NAPTOSA congresses and commemorative events;
- National Teachers' Day and SAPS Mothers' Day events;
- PSETA Skills Training Programme Graduation Ceremonies; and
- Mandela Day Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives;

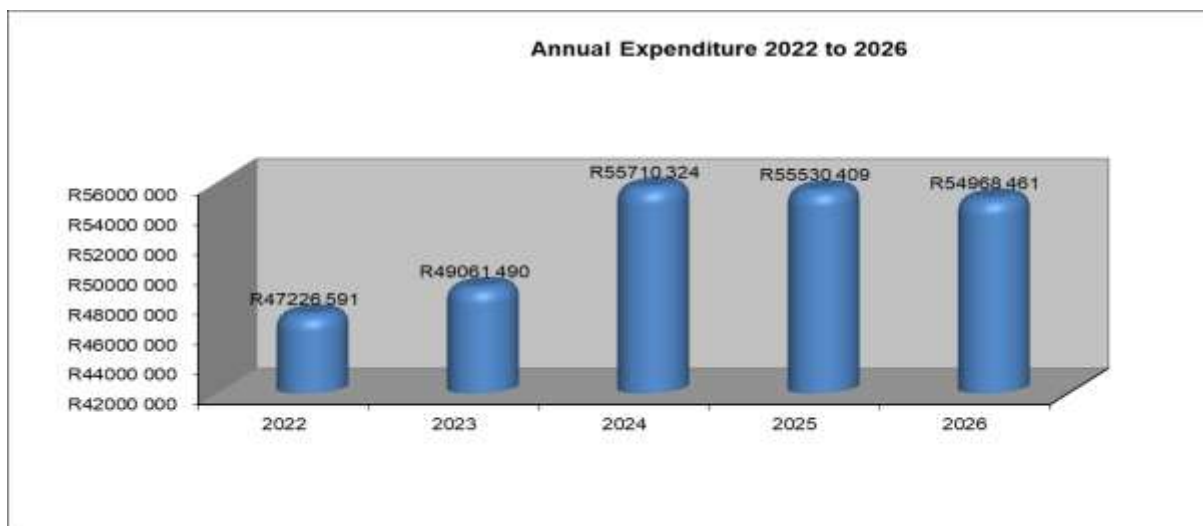
Human Resources expenditure remained below budget primarily due to vacant positions. Corporate Services budget was understated by the non-inclusion of depreciation amount of R 1 706 408.00, which is a non-cash item.



The annual expenditure graph below reflects the Council's trends over the past five years. A steady upward trajectory in expenditure is evident across the period, largely driven by inflationary pressures, strategic programme implementation, and operational growth requirements.

Although expenditure growth remained aligned to approved budgets and annual levy adjustments, the existing funding model did not generate sufficient income to fully fund all approved strategic projects without reliance on withdrawals from accumulated reserves.

Consequently, cost containment measures continued to be implemented during the reporting period, contributing to lower overall expenditure compared to the prior year.



Key Financial Indicators:

The graph below presents a summary of key financial indicators extracted from the Council's audited annual financial statements over the five-year cycle.

The analysis reflects relative stability in total assets, indicating that the Council maintained a sound financial position and asset base throughout the five year period. Notwithstanding this stability, the Council recorded operating deficits and negative cash flows from operations during the latter part of the five-year cycle, resulting in a gradual decline in accumulated reserves.

These trends do not reflect weaknesses in financial governance, budgetary control, or cost containment measures, but rather depicts the reliance on accumulated reserves to fund operational shortfalls and the implementation of Council strategic programmes.

Accordingly, the financial indicators provides a clear evidence base supporting the Council's strategic review of the existing levy funding model, and the successful conclusion and signing of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 by the Parties to the Council.

5 Year Financial Performance						
Key Financial Indicators	FY 2026 Actual	FY 2025 Actual	FY 2024 Actual	FY 2023 Actual	FY 2022 Actual	Accumulated Reserves
Levy Income	52 817 519	50 685 287	48 746 978	46 452 056	44 793 002	2023
Investment and Other income	2 220 739	2 782 735	2 715 789	2 195 629	2 738 993	R56.7 Million
Operating Expenses	(54 968 461)	(55 572 800)	(55 710 324)	(49 025 634)	(47 226 591)	2024
Net Surplus/(Deficit)	69 798	(2 104 778)	(4 247 557)	(377 949)	305 404	R52.4 Million
Accumulated Surplus Reserves	50 432 150	50 362 352	52 467 130	56 714 687	57 092 637	2025
Total Assets	54 851 245	53 919 644	56 334 082	60 383 722	62 075 651	R50.3 Million
Total Liabilities	4 419 096	3 557 292	3 866 952	3 669 035	4 983 014	2026
						R50.4 Million

Strategic Funding Sustainability – PSCBC Levy Resolution 1 of 2026

During the 2025/2026 financial year, the Parties to the Council concluded and signed PSCBC Levy Resolution 1 of 2026, approving an increase in the PSCBC levy contribution structure in support of the Council's long-term financial sustainability objectives.

The approved adjustment increased the levy contribution by R2.00 per employee (R1.00 per Party), with implementation effective from December 2025. Although the implementation on the PERSAL and PERSOL systems and the receipt of the backdated levy income occurred in April 2026, subsequent to the reporting financial year end of 31 March 2026, the conclusion of the Resolution represents a significant strategic milestone for the Council.

Accordingly, the adoption of Resolution 1 of 2026 strengthens the long-term sustainability of the PSCBC funding model, enhances cash flow resilience, protects institutional reserves, and positions the Council to continue delivering on its constitutional and collective bargaining mandate effectively.

Agency Shop Fee Account – Disbursements to Admitted Trade Unions

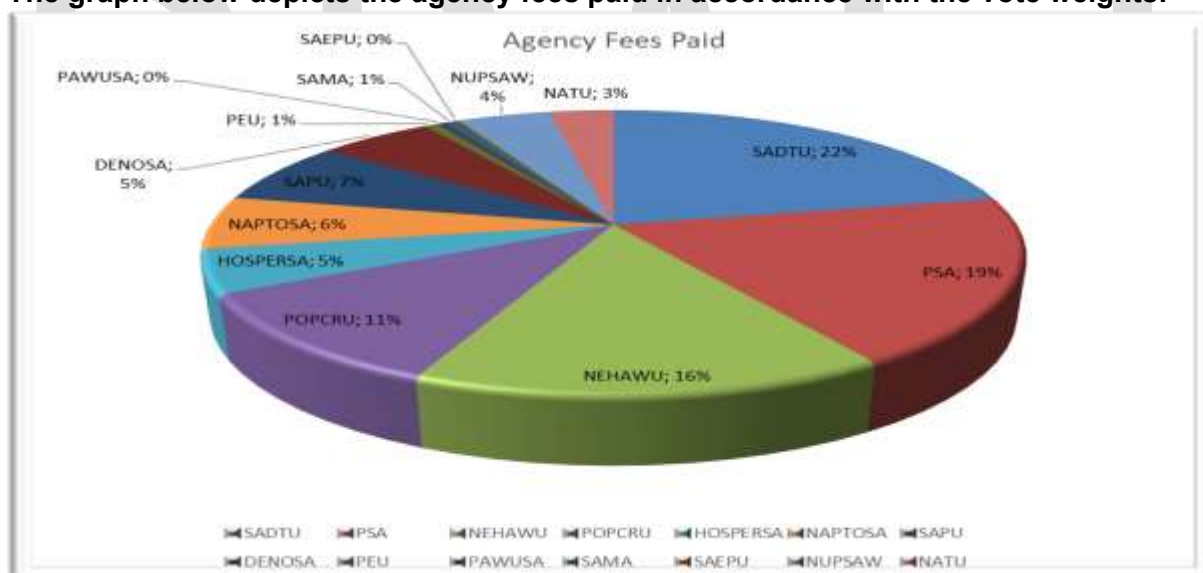
The graph below illustrates the annual distribution of agency shop fees to admitted trade unions in accordance with PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2011.

An amount of R219 318 024.94 was received for the 2026 financial year for distributions to the unions. The following legislation and collective agreements regulate the payment of agency fees.

- Provisions of section 25 of the Labour Relations Act (66 of 1995) as amended.
- Agency Shop Agreement- PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2005
- Agency Fee Agreement- PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2010
- Agency Fee Agreement PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2011



The graph below depicts the agency fees paid in accordance with the vote weights:



PSCBC Agency Fee Administration Income

The PSCBC currently receives an annual administration fee of R7 200 for the administration of agency shop fees, in terms of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 1998. This fee covers the receipt of agency fees in trust, monthly distribution to the admitted trade unions, investigation and reconciliation of shortfall variances, quarterly reporting to trade unions, and compliance oversight.

Source of Income	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Agency Fee Admin	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 200.00	R7 400.00

Compliance: Agency Fee Accounts

The PSCBC requires Trade Unions to submit audited financial statements of the separate agency fee accounts by June of each year. Those Unions which do not meet the deadline are entitled to request an extension until the end of September. Should Unions not submit such statements, agency fee payments are withheld until such statements are submitted to the Council.

The Trade Unions audited financial statements are submitted to the Council's auditors. Council auditors report on the usage of funds, to ensure compliance with Section 25 (3) (d) of the Labour Relations Act and PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2005.

PROCUREMENT, LOGISTICS AND FACILITIES

Overview

The Procurement, Logistics and Facilities function continued to support the strategic and operational objectives of the Council through effective supply chain governance, facilities management, and logistical support services. During the reporting period, significant focus was placed on advancing the PSCBC Office Building Development Project and related infrastructure initiatives aimed at strengthening the Council's long-term institutional sustainability.

Programme: PSCBC Office Building Development – Die Hoewes Ext 213

During the 2020–2026 strategic cycle, the Procurement, Logistics and Facilities function continued to play a central role in advancing the Council's long-term infrastructure investment strategy through the development of a new PSCBC office building on vacant land measuring approximately 10 992 square metres, originally acquired in January 2016 for future office development.

The acquisition and development of the vacant land formed part of the PSCBC's long-term vision to expand employment capacity, strengthen institutional capability, and enhance its ability to fulfil its mandate to the public sector. The proposed office development further includes the establishment of in-house conferencing facilities, aimed at reducing long-term conferencing costs and providing shared infrastructure for Sector Councils.

A significant portion of the strategic cycle was dedicated to navigating complex municipal town planning processes, including the consolidation of the twenty residential erven into a single

development property and the rezoning of land from residential to commercial use, which were critical prerequisites for project commencement.

Progress Over the Past Five Year Cycle

2021/2022 Financial Year – Project Initiation and Professional Team Establishment

During the 2021/2022 financial year, the Council initiated formal development processes for the new PSCBC office building under the Die Hoewes Ext 213 development project.

An advertisement was placed in national print media inviting Built Environment professionals to register on the PSCBC supplier database. This step ensured transparency, competitiveness, and compliance with procurement governance requirements.

The PSCBC Executive Committee approved the appointment of a Construction Project Manager to serve as a subject matter expert responsible for overseeing project implementation in line with Council directives. The appointment was conducted in accordance with industry standards prescribed by the South African Council for the Project and Construction Management Profession and relevant Government Gazette guidelines. The Project Manager operates under the direction and governance oversight of the PSCBC Executive Committee.

Following a comprehensive bid evaluation process, professional service providers were appointed in key disciplines:

- Architectural Services: Consultium Architects and Urban Designers (Pty) Ltd
- Quantity Surveying: Morei Matji and Associates CC
- Civil and Structural Engineering: MSBR Consulting (Pty) Ltd

A total of 104 applications were received from industry professionals, demonstrating strong market interest and ensuring a competitive and transparent appointment process.

2022/2023 Financial Year – Expansion of Professional Services and Municipal Challenges

During the 2022/2023 period, the PSCBC expanded the professional project team through the appointment of additional specialist consultants:

- Electrical Engineering: HAMSA Consulting Engineers (Pty) Ltd
- Mechanical Engineering: IX Engineers (Pty) Ltd
- Wet Services Engineering: IX Engineers (Pty) Ltd

During this phase, the Council encountered significant municipal planning challenges related to the rezoning of the development land from residential to commercial use. The rezoning process was identified as potentially lengthy and complex, with estimated approval timelines of eight to twelve months.

Further complications arose when the City of Tshwane identified that ERF566 constituted a servitude owned by the Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association. To address this issue, Special Powers of Attorney were executed, enabling the PSCBC to secure rights over ERF566.

2023/2024 Financial Year – Statutory Submissions and Technical Approvals

During the 2023/2024 financial year, the Council, through its appointed town planners, submitted comprehensive statutory documentation to the City of Tshwane in support of rezoning and consolidation applications. These included:

- Engineering services reports covering roads, stormwater, water, sanitation, and electricity;
- A detailed Site Development Plan (SDP);
- Consent documentation from the Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association; and
- Title deeds for ERF882 and ERF566.

This phase marked significant technical progress in meeting regulatory requirements.

2024/2025 Financial Year – Municipal Processing and Regulatory Dependencies

During the 2024/2025 financial year, the City of Tshwane advised that the consolidation application would remain pending until the rezoning application had been approved. As a result, project timelines were influenced by external regulatory dependencies beyond the Council's direct control.

Despite these delays, the PSCBC continued to engage with municipal authorities and service providers to ensure regulatory compliance and maintain project momentum.

2025/2026 Financial Year – Rezoning and Consolidation Milestones Achieved

During the final year of the strategic cycle, the Council achieved significant project milestones:

- The City of Tshwane approved the rezoning of ERF882 and ERF566,
- The consolidation of the two erven was subsequently approved,
- The properties were formally consolidated into a single development property, ERF948.

These approvals represent a major strategic breakthrough and effectively remove key regulatory barriers that had constrained project progression during earlier phases of the cycle.

Reflection and Positioning for the next Financial Year

Over the past five year financial period, the Council successfully established governance and planning foundation for the office development project. Key achievements included the appointed multidisciplinary professional teams, navigated complex municipal planning and regulatory requirements, and secured critical statutory approvals.

While construction has not yet commenced due to regulatory planning complexities inherent to large scale infrastructure development, the Council now enters the next financial year with:

- Approved rezoning and consolidation rights;
- A consolidated development property (ERF948);
- Established professional and project governance structures; and
- Completion and approval of Phase 1 (Inception), Phase 2 (Concept and Viability) and Phase 3 (Design Development).

The focus for the upcoming period will shift from regulatory compliance and planning towards project funding submission, project execution, contractor appointment, and construction commencement.



Programme: Security Guardhouse Construction – PSCBC/GPSSBC Body Corporate

The turnkey construction solution for the construction of the PSCBC/GPSSBC Body Corporate guardhouse was approved in 2021.

The detailed turnkey solution scope included planning, design, council approval of building plans, obtaining an occupation certificate, supervision, and construction of the PSCBC/GPSSBC Body Corporate guardhouse. Consultium Architect and Designers (Pty) Ltd was appointed as the service provider.

The guardhouse was to be constructed on Erf 566 and Erf 882. The City of Tshwane advised that Erf 566 belongs to the Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association and that permission to construct the guardhouse on Erf 566 had to be obtained from the Association.

The Villa iL Roseto Homeowners Association granted PSCBC permission to construct the guardhouse on Erf 566 in September 2025.

Construction of the guardhouse and its canopy roof was completed in December 2025. PSCBC is currently awaiting the certificate of occupancy from the service provider.

HUMAN RESOURCES

Overview

As outlined in the prior year report, the Council committed to the automation of work processes. In addition, Human Resource policies were reviewed, consulted on with staff, and subsequently adopted by the Council. Training and development initiatives were further strengthened through improved provision and increased uptake of training programmes by staff members.

Staff Retention

During the period under review, the PSCBC celebrated a 10-year service milestone for six (06) staff members. These milestones are in addition to the more than fifteen (15) staff members who already have over ten years of service within the Council. This achievement not only reflects positively on the individuals concerned, but also strengthens the collective institutional knowledge and organisational continuity within the PSCBC. As a result, approximately 55% of the PSCBC staff complement now comprises employees with more than a decade of service to the Council, demonstrating a strong culture of staff retention and organisational commitment.

Appointments

During the period under review, the following appointments were made in a phased approach and in line with the operational requirements of the Council. Furthermore, in support of the operationalization of the Trade Unions Management Sub-unit, Mr. Tseke Mphahlele was promoted to the position of Senior Officer: Trade Unions.

The Council remains committed to filling vacancies in a phased and sustainable manner, subject to operational requirements and organisational priorities. Accordingly, during the period under review, the Council successfully filled six (06) vacancies to ensure the effective implementation and achievement of its strategic objectives.

Name	Position	From
Tseke Mphahlele	Senior Officer: Trade Unions	01 September 2025
Amukelani Chabalala	Administrator: Monitoring, Evaluation and Research	01 October 2025
Shriya Budram	Officer: Trade Unions	01 December 2025
Clifford Ntshetjeng	Administrator: Collective Bargaining	01 December 2025
Mmapula Sekoboane	Administrator: Trade Union Management	01 December 2025
Lindokuhle Ngwenya	Administrator: Communitations	01 January 2025

During the period under review, the Council continued to demonstrate its commitment to creating opportunities for young graduates to enter the labour market and acquire meaningful workplace experience. In this regard, the PSCBC participated in a Work Integrated Learning (WIL) programme through the placement of a learner from the Tshwane University of Technology. Furthermore, the Council provided a work placement opportunity for Mr. Thoriso Foromo through a placement agreement with Tshilidzi Trading and Training Services as the funder of the programme.

Name	Work Integrated Learning Programme	Duration
Viwe Makapela	WIL: Diploma: Information Technology	04 August 2025 – 30 June 2026
Thoriso Foromo	Host Employer: Diploma in Marketing	14 October 2025 – 30 March 2026

Terminations

The Council continued to provide a valuable stepping stone for employees seeking to grow professionally and explore opportunities in other industries and working environments. During the period under review, the Council bid farewell to the colleagues listed below, following the receipt of their resignations.

Name	Reason	Termination date
Melusi Dube	Resignation	31 August 2025
Mbulaheni Netshifhefhe	Resignation	31 January 2026

Retirement

During the period under review, the Council bid farewell to Ms. Jemina Kutumela, who elected to take early retirement after eighteen (18) years of dedicated service to the Council. Ms. Kutumela joined the Council on 01 June 2007 as a Cleaner. Through her hard work, commitment, and willingness to learn, she was appointed in an acting capacity as Receptionist in September 2010 and was subsequently promoted to the permanent position of Receptionist on 01 December 2013, a role she occupied with distinction until her retirement.

Name	Reason	Service Record
Jemina Kutumela	Retirement	01 June 2007 – 28 February 2026

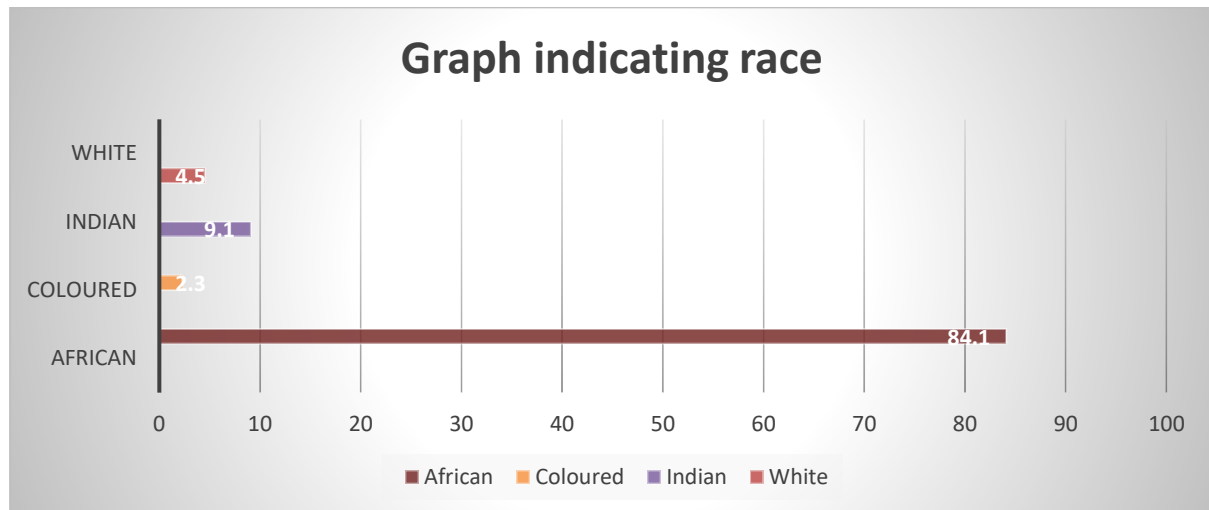
Vacant Positions

As a result of the implementation of the adopted organisational structure, as well as resignations received during the period under review, the positions listed below remained vacant as at 31 March 2026. Despite these vacancies, the Council maintained an occupancy rate of 73%, with more than 35 of the 48 approved positions filled. In addition, two (02) more vacancies were approved for appointment in March 2026, which will increase the occupancy rate to 77%. This reflects a 7% improvement from the 70% occupancy rate reported during the 2024/2025 financial year. These figures exclude interns and contractual staff members.

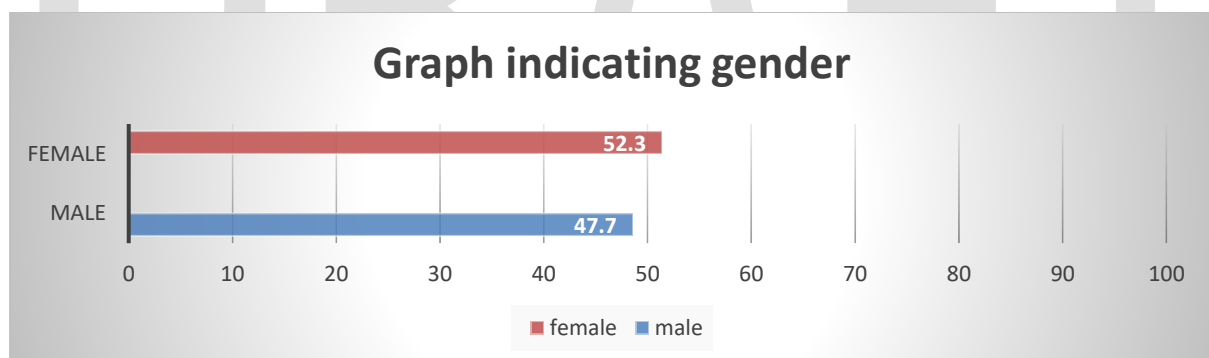
Representative Profile

For the period under review, the PSCBC maintained an overall staff complement of forty-four (44) employees. The demographic profile of the staff complement, in terms of race and gender representation, is reflected below.

Race



Gender



Skills Development

The Council has continued to prioritise the training and development of staff through the provision of and exposure to various training programmes, bursaries, and National Qualifications Framework (NQF)-aligned programmes.

During the period under review, the Council celebrated the successful completion of qualifications by the staff members listed below, who were funded through Council bursaries.

Qualifications Completed.	Employee(s)
Diploma in Public Administration and Management, University of South Africa (UNISA)	Deogracia Mathabe
Master of Arts in Strategic Communication, University of Johannesburg (UJ)	Mmathapelo Mongwe
Postgraduate Diploma in Labour Law, University of Johannesburg (UJ)	Tsumbedzo Tshinavha
Postgraduate Diploma in Labour Law, University of the Western Cape (UWC)	Priyanka Kisten

The table below reflects all active bursaries within the Council during the period under review.

Bursaries Awarded	Employee(s)
Master of Arts in English Studies, University of Limpopo (UL)	Tseke Mphahlele
Doctor of Business Leadership, University of South Africa (UNISA)	Oomang Parag
Postgraduate Diploma in Public Management, University of Pretoria (UP)	Sonny Motlanthe

The table below reflects all NQF aligned programmes facilitated during the period under review.

NQF Aligned Programmes	Number of Employees trained
General Manager: Public Service (NQF level 6 learnership ending September 2026)	03
Introduction to Palliative Care (NQF level 6)	01
Skills Programme in Cyber Security (NQF level 5)	01
Effective Minute Taking and Report Writing Skills (NQF level 4)	08
Facilitate learning using a variety of given methodologies (NQF level 5)	09
Conduct Outcomes-Based Assessments (NQF level 5)	09
Conduct Moderation of Outcomes-Based Assessments (NQF level 6)	09

The table below reflects all non-NQF aligned programmes facilitated during the period under review.

Non-NQF Aligned Programmes	Number of Employees trained
Advanced Project Management – Driving Organisational Success	01
GovTech Conference	02
Monitoring, Evaluation and Research Conference	01
VW Safety Driving Course	08
Labour Guide Course in Management and Leadership Skills	03
Basic Registry, Records and Archives Management	01
IFRS Accounting Standards with AI	01
Skills Programme in Public Service Dispute Management and Negotiation Skills	19
Skills Programme in Medical and Community Chaplaincy	01
SAGE Annual Tax Webinar	03
Writing For Government – Basis Writing Skills (NSG)	02
Writing For Government – Advanced Writing Skills (NSG)	02

Automation of HR Processes

To support remote work and ensure continuity, the Council successfully implemented automation of key Human Resource processes, including:

- Electronic leave management systems.
- Automated daily productivity, performance management workflows.
- Secure document management platforms; and
- Enhanced ICT-enabled connectivity.

These innovations resulted in:

- Reduced paper-based administration.
- Improved audit trails and compliance oversight.
- Faster turnaround times; and
- Strengthened organisational resilience.

Policy Review and Compliance

The Council maintained full statutory and regulatory compliance during the reporting cycle. In response to emerging risks and organisational changes, several policies were adopted or reviewed, including:

- Adopted Remote Work Policy
- Adopted Delegation of Authority and
- Reviewed HR, Leave, Disciplinary, Performance Management and Incentive Policies

The Council remained compliant with the requirements of:

- The Department of Employment and Labour;
- SARS; and
- PSETA (Workplace Skills Plan (WSP) and the Annual Training Report (ATR)

Furthermore, the strategic partnership with the PSETA has remained strong and constructive, enabling Council staff members and Public Servants with continuous access to various training and development interventions.

Employee Wellness

For the year under review, Council continued to maintain employee wellness interventions introduced in the 2024/2025 financial year. These include wellness boards, facilitated through the Office of the General Secretary, and updated on a monthly basis. The boards feature various motivational and inspirational content that staff can engage with to re-energise and re-orient themselves. They also include simple, interactive games designed to be mentally refreshing and easy to follow.

Through the ICT Unit, Wellness Wednesdays continued to be implemented. These activities comprise two main components, yoga sessions facilitated by the passionate yogi, Mr. Oomang Parag, and wellness walks that allow staff members to take refreshing walks around the surrounding area, promoting physical well-being and informal interaction. Staff members also participated in the 2025 702 Walk the Talk event, with a shared objective of completing a 6.7-kilometre walk as a team, reinforcing the spirit of inclusivity and “leaving no one behind.” The team met at UNISA and proceeded to the starting point at the Voortrekker Monument. The walk concluded at the Union Buildings grounds, where the General Secretary delivered an address to staff.

In addition, staff members attended the year-end function and team-building event. Activities were facilitated by the General Secretary, supported by the Human Resources team. The

programme included a staff gift exchange, a portrait painting exercise, which encouraged staff to step outside their comfort zones and engage in creative expression accessible to all skill levels. Staff participated in a wine blending exercise, which served as both a learning opportunity and an enjoyable, interactive experience. A human Morabaraba activity, which promoted teamwork, collaboration, and adaptive leadership skills.

The Year Ahead

The forthcoming financial year will focus on the continued implementation of strategic targets relating to the automation of work processes and organisational efficiency improvements.

Key priorities for the upcoming period include:

- Implementation of the cloud-based payroll system;
- Continued enhancement of policy and governance frameworks;
- Infrastructure development implementation planning;
- Strengthening institutional sustainability following the implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026; and
- Continued investment in staff development and organisational capability.

The implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 is expected to significantly strengthen the Council's income base and improve long-term financial sustainability, thereby positioning the Council to better support its strategic priorities, infrastructure development initiatives, operational requirements, and future institutional growth.

SECTION 7: INFORMATION COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY

Overview

The Communications Section remains a critical enabler in advancing the strategic mandate of the Council, providing integrated communication support to ensure the effective achievement of organisational goals and objectives. The Section plays a pivotal role in facilitating clear, consistent, and impactful communication, ensuring that high-quality information is disseminated to both internal and external stakeholders.

The strategic objective of the Communications Section is to position and promote the Council's brand both nationally and internationally through the utilisation of diverse and integrated communication platforms and technologies. This includes a coordinated approach to brand communication, marketing, media relations, advertising, digital and social media, resource centre management, events coordination, stakeholder engagement, and the development of strategic partnerships. These key focus areas were actively implemented and strengthened during the 2025/26 financial year.

The Section operates within a structured framework of approved policies and procedures, which serve as a guiding roadmap for daily operations and the execution of its business plan. This ensures that all communication initiatives and stakeholder engagements are conducted in a coherent, consistent, and professional manner, thereby safeguarding and enhancing the image and reputation of the Council.

This section of the report provides an overview of the key activities, initiatives, and achievements undertaken by the Communications Section during the 2025/26 financial year. It includes a structured presentation of performance indicators, planned targets, actual achievements, and deviations. The report is presented sequentially, commencing with the website, followed by social media, events, and corporate social responsibility initiatives. It further incorporates an update on Information and Communication Technology (ICT), and concludes with a summary and the way forward for the Section.

Performance Tables

The tables presented below provide a structured overview of the performance of the Communications and Information and Communication Technology (ICT) functions for the 2025/26 financial year. The tables are designed to reflect alignment between planned objectives and actual performance, while also highlighting any variances.

Each table is organised into four key components:

- **Performance Indicator:** This outlines the specific objective or output that the Communications or ICT Section aimed to achieve during the financial year. These indicators are aligned with the Section's operational plan and strategic priorities of the Council.
- **Planned Target Achievement (2025/26):** This column reflects the predetermined targets set at the beginning of the financial year. These targets serve as benchmarks against which performance is measured.
- **Actual Achievement (2025/26):** This provides a detailed account of what was achieved during the reporting period. It includes both quantitative outputs (such as number of events, newsletters, or system performance levels) and qualitative outcomes (such as stakeholder engagement and system reliability).
- **Deviation from Planned Target to Actual Achievement (2025/26):** This column highlights any variances between planned targets and actual performance. Where applicable, reasons for deviations are provided, including operational constraints or areas where performance exceeded expectations.

The Communications performance table reflects achievements across key areas such as stakeholder engagement through events, internal communication, digital and social media growth, stakeholder partnerships, governance and policy development, and media relations. Notably, the Section exceeded its social media growth target and successfully delivered all planned events, while minor deviations were recorded in internal communication outputs.

The ICT performance table outlines the Section's success in maintaining a stable, secure, and reliable technological environment. Key achievements include continuous server monitoring, successful data backup processes, development of business continuity and disaster recovery plans, and the implementation of IT and AI policies. While system protection targets were largely achieved, minor deviations were noted in email filtering effectiveness, which continue to be addressed through ongoing monitoring and user awareness initiatives.

Overall, the tables demonstrate a high level of performance, with most targets achieved or exceeded, reflecting the effectiveness of both the Communications and ICT Sections in supporting the Council's strategic objectives during the 2025/26 financial year.

Performance Analysis Narrative: Communications and Information Technology

Communications:

The performance results for the 2025/26 financial year reflect a strong and consistent achievement of the Communications and IT Section's planned targets, with most performance indicators either fully achieved or exceeded. The Section demonstrated its ability to effectively implement its operational plan while contributing meaningfully to the Council's strategic objectives.

In relation to stakeholder engagement, the Section successfully delivered all 23 planned events during the financial year, achieving a 100% completion rate. These events were strategically distributed across internal, labour, and employer stakeholders, ensuring balanced representation and inclusive participation. The successful execution of these events underscores the Section's capacity to coordinate high-impact engagements and maintain strong relationships across all stakeholder groupings.

Internal communication initiatives were largely effective, with all four planned editions of the PSCBC newsletter successfully published. In addition, 216 news highlights were distributed against a target of 220, reflecting a high level of consistency in internal communication. The minor shortfall was attributed to operational constraints and did not significantly impact the overall effectiveness of information dissemination within the organisation.

The digital communication strategy yielded exceptional results during the reporting period. While a 10% growth in social media performance was initially targeted, the Section exceeded expectations by achieving over 30% growth. This significant increase in digital reach and engagement demonstrates the effectiveness of the content strategy, as well as the successful implementation of weekly social media plans. The improvement highlights the growing importance of digital platforms in enhancing the Council's visibility and stakeholder interaction.

Stakeholder partnerships, particularly through the National Association of Bargaining Councils (NABC), were effectively maintained and strengthened. The Section facilitated two training webinars, two executive committee meetings, and actively participated in stakeholder events, while also maintaining consistent digital engagement. These efforts contributed to sustained collaboration and knowledge-sharing within the sector.

In terms of governance and policy development, all planned targets were achieved. Key deliverables included the development and review of the Social Media Policy and the Corporate Identity Manual, which provide a structured framework for communication practices and ensure brand consistency across all platforms.

Media relations were also strengthened during the financial year, despite not being initially planned as a formal target. The Section proactively issued four media releases addressing critical issues, including the GEMS medical aid increase and misinformation regarding retirement age. In addition, four radio interviews were conducted across prominent platforms, enhancing public awareness and reinforcing the Council's position as a credible source of information.

Information Technology

From an IT perspective, the Section maintained a stable, secure, and reliable technological environment throughout the financial year. All critical infrastructure targets were achieved, including continuous server monitoring and successful daily data backups. The development of the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan, as well as the drafting of IT and draft AI policy, represent significant progress in strengthening the Council's governance and risk management framework.

Furthermore, the IT unit ensured full protection of all systems, achieving 100% endpoint security across workstations and servers. While email content filtering achieved a high success rate of 98%, minor vulnerabilities remain, with some phishing emails bypassing existing controls. This has been mitigated through continuous monitoring and enhanced user awareness initiatives.

The information contained below provides a high-level overview of the ICT operations for the reporting period. In the interest of maintaining the security and integrity of the Council's systems, certain technical and operational details have been limited, as the disclosure of sensitive information may introduce potential security vulnerabilities. The summary therefore focuses on key activities, performance outcomes, and strategic initiatives undertaken by the ICT Unit.



Network

The ICT Unit continues to proactively monitor, manage, and maintain the Council's network infrastructure to ensure high availability, optimal performance, and appropriate protection against evolving risks. Through continuous oversight and preventative maintenance, the Unit has ensured that the network environment remains stable, reliable, and capable of supporting the organisation's operational requirements.

The Council's network is designed to support both wired and wireless connectivity, enabling flexibility, mobility, and seamless access for users across the organisation. This approach ensures that staff and stakeholders can efficiently access systems and services while maintaining acceptable standards of performance and reliability. The network architecture incorporates core infrastructure components that are configured to support connectivity, manage traffic, and maintain overall system integrity.

During the 2025/26 financial year, the network and server environment remained stable, with no recorded downtime. This reflects the effectiveness of the ICT Unit's monitoring processes and infrastructure management practices. However, minor and intermittent disruptions were experienced in relation to internet connectivity, primarily attributable to external service dependencies.

To enhance resilience and continuity, the ICT Unit is in the process of implementing additional connectivity measures. This initiative is aimed at improving reliability, reducing dependency on a single service provider, and ensuring sustained availability of network services.

Overall, the ICT Unit remains committed to continuously improving network performance, strengthening security measures, and ensuring reliable connectivity to support the Council's strategic objectives and operational efficiency.

Endpoint Security

As part of its ongoing commitment to strengthening cybersecurity, the PSCBC continues to utilise Antivirus software as its primary endpoint protection solution. This platform provides advanced, real-time threat detection and response capabilities, ensuring that all organisational devices are protected against a wide range of cyber threats, including viruses, malware, ransomware, and other malicious activities.

The software is centrally managed through a unified security dashboard, enabling the ICT Unit to monitor, manage, and respond to security incidents across all endpoints within the organisation. This centralised approach enhances visibility, ensures consistent enforcement of security policies, and allows for the rapid deployment of updates and threat mitigation measures.

During the 2025/26 financial year, the endpoint environment remained secure and stable, with all devices maintaining a high level of protection. Key security controls such as tamper protection, policy enforcement, exclusions management, and data telemetry achieved optimal performance levels, reflecting strong compliance with cybersecurity best practices. The firewall component also maintained a high performance level, contributing to the overall security posture of the organisation.

Daily health check summaries were conducted to continuously assess the status and effectiveness of endpoint security controls. These checks enabled proactive identification and resolution of potential risks, ensuring that the environment consistently operates within acceptable security thresholds. While the overall health status remained strong, minor areas requiring attention, such as configuration optimisation and authorised contact settings, were identified and are being addressed to further enhance system performance and compliance.

Overall, the software has played a critical role in maintaining the security, integrity, and resilience of the PSCBC's IT environment. The continuous monitoring, coupled with proactive management and regular health assessments, ensures that the organisation remains well-protected against evolving cyber threats and aligned with modern cybersecurity standards.

Backup and disaster recovery

Ensuring the resilience, availability, and continuity of the Council's critical systems and data remained a key priority for the IT Unit during the 2025/26 financial year. The Unit maintained a robust backup and recovery framework designed to safeguard organisational data against risks such as system failures, cyber incidents, human error, and other unforeseen disruptions.

The Council utilises a comprehensive backup solution, which includes daily cloud-based backups of all hosted servers. This solution is securely managed and monitored by an appointed service provider, ensuring adherence to established service standards and continuous data protection. Key features of the backup environment include automated daily backups, secure offsite storage, ransomware protection, and advanced encryption protocols to safeguard sensitive information. In addition, user workstations are backed up through cloud storage solutions, ensuring that critical user data is continuously protected and recoverable.

To ensure the reliability and effectiveness of the backup process, the IT Unit actively monitors backup activities through automated alerts and reporting mechanisms. This enables timely identification and resolution of any backup failures, ensuring that data remains consistently protected and readily recoverable when required.

In alignment with best practices in ICT governance and risk management, the IT Unit developed a comprehensive Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan (BCDR). The plan provides a

structured framework for responding to and recovering from disruptive incidents, with clearly defined processes, roles, and responsibilities. It outlines a phased recovery approach, beginning with immediate response and containment, followed by the restoration of critical systems, data, and services in a controlled and prioritised manner.

The plan further incorporates key elements such as risk assessment, identification of critical systems, communication protocols, and post-recovery evaluation processes. Regular testing, including quarterly disaster recovery drills and annual audits of backup systems, has been incorporated to ensure ongoing effectiveness and readiness of the recovery framework.

Overall, the implementation of these measures has strengthened the Council's ability to respond to potential disruptions, minimise downtime, and maintain continuity of operations. The finalisation and continued refinement of the BCDR Plan will further enhance the Council's IT resilience, ensuring that systems and services can be restored efficiently and effectively in the event of a disaster.

Overall

Overall, the performance reflected in the tables demonstrates a high level of operational efficiency, strategic alignment, and continuous improvement. The Communications and IT Section has not only met its planned objectives but, in key areas such as digital engagement, significantly exceeded expectations, positioning the Council for sustained growth and enhanced service delivery in future reporting periods.



INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY			
Communications			
Performance Indicator	Planned Achievement 2025/26	Target Actual Achievement 2025/26	Deviation from Planned Target to Actual Achievement 2025/26
Enhance stakeholder engagement through events Management	23 Events planned in the financial	Achieved Strong stakeholder engagement maintained across all sectors, with balanced representation of internal and external partners 23 Events achieved in the financial Year In the overall achieved number 8 were internal events, inclusive of CSR events 10 were from	None

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		labour parties supported events 5 were employer supported events	
Strengthen Internal communication through issuing of Newsletters & News highlights	4 Issues of the PSCBC Newsletter and 220 News highlights are planned as part of internal communication	Partially Achieved We successfully issued 4 newsletters in the reported financial year and distributed 216 News highlights in the financial year with a Shortfall of 4 newshighlights	There was a High consistency in internal communication; minor gap due to operational constraints
Grow digital presence and visibility through Social Media Management	A planned 10% social media growth Produce 51 weekly social media statistics and plans	Achieved We have successfully reached and surpassed the planned 10% social media performance growth and submitted 51 planned social media post	We have exceeded the planned targets by exceeding 30% social media performance growth instead of 10% Significant improvement in digital reach and engagement, indicating effective content strategy
Strengthen stakeholder partnerships: National Association of Bargaining Councils	NABC Partnership Management with Ongoing stakeholder engagement through training and	Achieved We hosted 2 training webinars and 2 executive committee meetings in the financial year and attended 1 stakeholder event	None

	communication plan enhancement	We have also kept the social media account active through posting	
Improve governance and policy framework	1 planned policy reviews & 1 framework	Achieved Social media policy, Corporate Identity Manual,	None
Media Relations	None	Achieved In this financial year the unit released 4 Media release on the following: • 3 releases addressing the GEMS medical aid increase • 1 release addressing the Fake news on retirement age • 4 Radio Interviews were conducted on 702, Power Fm and Radio 786	None
IT			
Performance Indicator	Planned Target Achievement 2025/26	Actual Achievement 2025/26	Deviation from Planned Target to Actual Achievement 2025/26
Functional ICT Infrastructure	Ensure that ICT servers are monitored.	Achieved ICT successfully monitored the Council's servers throughout the financial year.	None

	Ensure that all critical servers are backed up.	Achieved ICT unit successfully monitored the backup reports to ensure that backups were successful daily.	None
	Draft Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan	Achieved Business Continuity and Disaster recovery plan was drafted and submitted for review.	None
	Draft and review IT and AI policy.	Achieved IT and AI policies were drafted and submitted for review.	None
Ensure that all ICT Systems are protected and maintained.	Ensure end-point protection and email content filtering and submit reports.	Achieved ICT maintained 100% protection of all workstations and servers within the council, providing comprehensive protection against viruses, malware, ransomware, and other security threats. Reports were submitted. Email content filtering target achieved at 98%	While most phishing emails are successfully filtered, some are still able to bypass existing controls. Continuous monitoring & user awareness were conducted.



Website

The website remains a central pillar of the Council's communication strategy and serves as a primary platform for enhancing visibility, transparency, and stakeholder engagement both nationally and internationally. As a 24/7 accessible digital platform, it provides stakeholders with timely, reliable, and comprehensive information, unrestricted by geographical or time constraints.

During the 2025/26 financial year, the utilisation of the website increased significantly. This growth can be attributed to sustained efforts in maintaining up-to-date content, improving accessibility, and ensuring that the website remains a trusted and authoritative source of information for stakeholders. The continued reliance by users underscores the website's role as the official repository of Council information.

An integrated communication approach was maintained throughout the reporting period, ensuring alignment and synergy across all communication platforms. Content published on the website was strategically aligned with social media channels, with key information shared across platforms to maximise reach and engagement. Particular emphasis was placed on directing traffic to the website, reinforcing its position as the central hub within the Council's communication ecosystem.

To provide a comprehensive understanding of website performance, a range of web analytics has been utilised. The data presented in the tables and graphs below illustrates key metrics, including page views, visitors, and new visitors. These indicators provide insight into user behaviour, reach, and engagement levels.

For reporting purposes:

- **Unique visitors** refer to individual users who accessed the website at least once during the reporting period, with each user counted only once regardless of multiple visits.
- **Visitors** represent the total number of users who accessed the website.
- **Page views** refer to the total number of pages viewed, including repeated views and interactions with linked content within the website.

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These metrics collectively provide a reliable measure of the website’s performance and its effectiveness in disseminating information to stakeholders.

Summary of Page Views

The graph below illustrates the total number of page views recorded on the website during the 2025/2026 financial year, reflecting overall user engagement with the Council’s online content.



Graph 1: Website Page Views

Summary of Visitors

The graph below presents the total number of visitors to the website during the 2025/2026 financial year, indicating the reach and accessibility of the platform.



Graph 2: Website Visitors

Summary of New Visitors

The graph below illustrates the number of new visitors to the website during the 2025/2026 financial year, highlighting the Council's ability to attract new users and expand its digital audience.



Graph 3: New Visitors

Social media

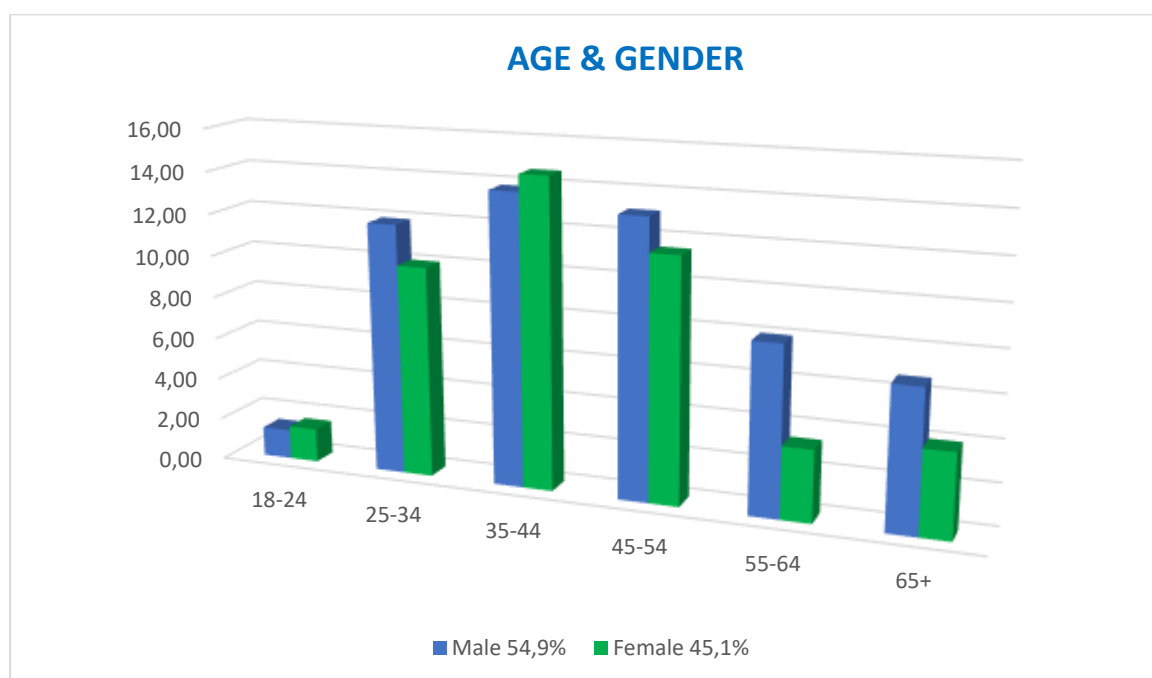
Social media is a powerful, efficient and effective communication tool that is used to disseminate information to a multitude of people, and in the 2025/26 financial year, it was used strategically to promote, educate and maintain brand visibility. Its power and influence were evident during this financial year as it played an indispensable role to solicit discussions on our social media pages, especially on Facebook and X. A weekly social media plan was carefully crafted, scheduled and implemented on a weekly basis, which is the reason why we have seen an exponential growth on all our social media platforms.

The plan includes topical posters/ messages on various issues affecting stakeholder, commemorative and PSCBC events. The posts generated huge interest, implored discussions from followers, and gave them a platform to air their views and concerns. Their opinions gave us an opportunity to evaluate and tactically institute posts according to feedback received.

We are pleased to report that in this financial year, we added three social media platforms (Instagram, LinkedIn and YouTube), which brings the social media pages to five. While Facebook was used predominantly in this financial year, we have also seen growth in engagements on X.

Social Media Demographics

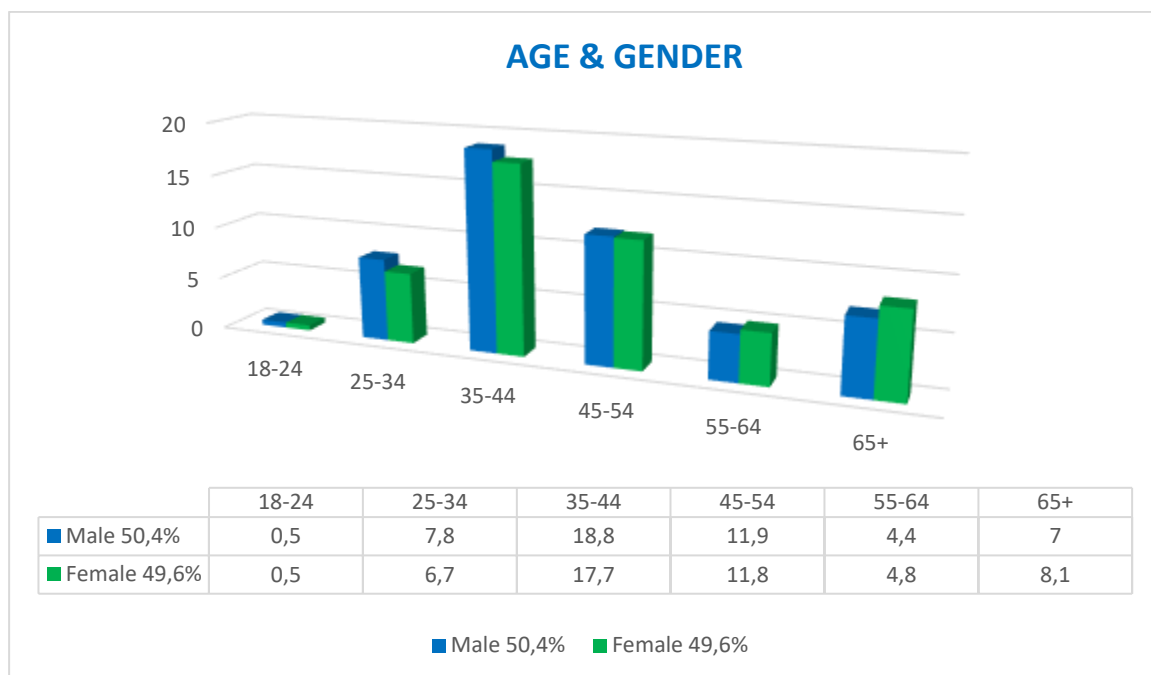
The graphs below indicate the age and gender of people who follow the PSCBC on Instagram and Facebook for the 2025/2026 financial year. The numbers are indicated in percentages.



Graph 4: Instagram Gender statistics

The above graph indicates the age and gender groups that follow the PSCBC on Instagram. The number of males and females, as well as the age groups, is represented in percentages.

In the age group 18yrs to 24yrs, the males are 1.4% and the females are 1.6%. 25yrs to 34yrs, males are 11.8% and females are 10%. 35yrs to 44yrs, males are 14% and females are 14.5%. 45yrs to 54yrs, males are 13.1% and females are 11.5%. 55yrs to 64yrs, males are 8% and females are 3.4%. 65yrs +, Males are 6.7% and females are 4%.



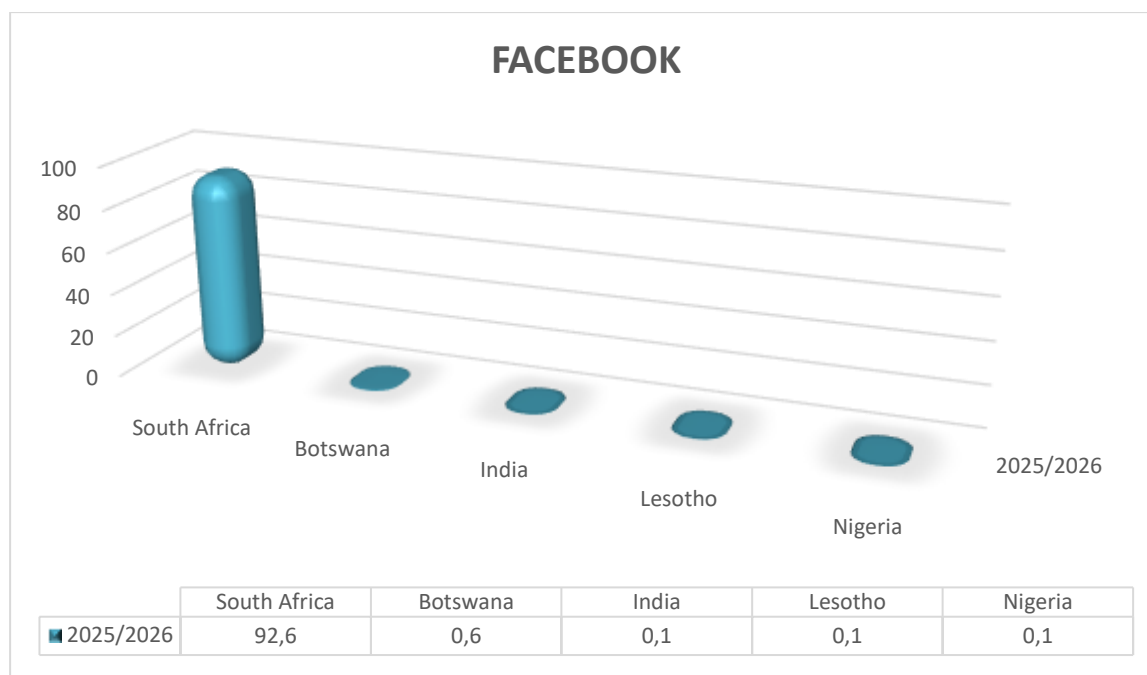
Graph 5: Facebook Gender Statistics

The above graph indicates the age and gender groups that follow the PSCBC on Facebook. The number of males and females, as well as the age groups, is represented in percentages.

In the age group 18 years to 24 years, the males are 0.5% and the females are 0.5% while 25yrs to 34 years, males are 7.8% and females are 6.7%.

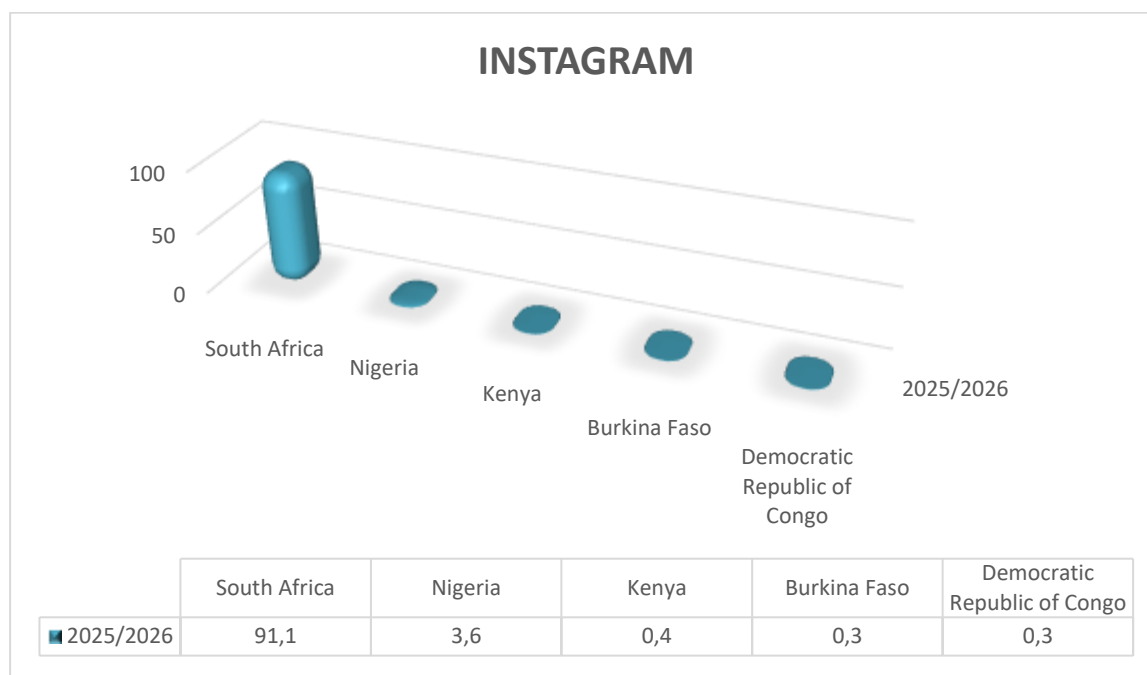
The age group between 35 years and 44 years, males are 18.8% and females are 17.7% and 45 years to 54 years, males are 11.9%, and females are 11.8%. 55yrs to 64yrs, males are 4.4% and females are 4.8%. 65yrs +, Males are 7% and females are 8.1%.

The below graph represents the top five countries that follow the PSCBC on Facebook, Instagram and LinkedIn. The below figures are in the percentile.



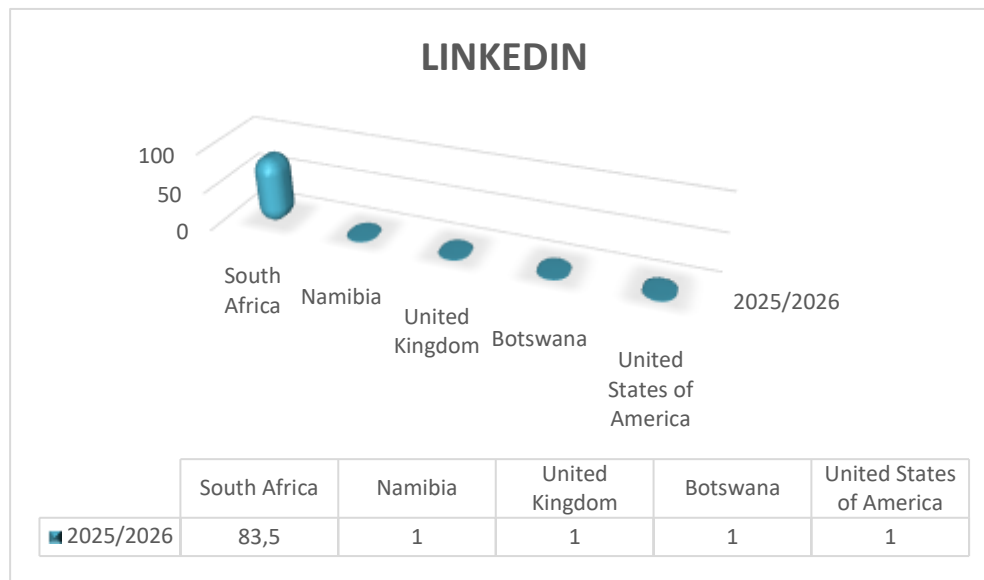
Graph 6: Facebook Top 5 countries

The above graph represents the top five countries that follow the PSCBC on Facebook. The figures are in the percentile. In South Africa we have 96.2% followers. Botswana 0.6% followers, India 0.1% followers, Lesotho 0.1% and Nigeria 0.1% followers.



Graph 7: Instagram Top 5 countries

The above graph represents the top five countries that follow the PSCBC on Instagram. The figures are in the percentile. In South Africa we have 91.1% followers. Nigeria 3.6% followers, Kenya 0.4% followers, Burkina Faso 0.3% and Democratic Republic of Congo 0.3% followers.



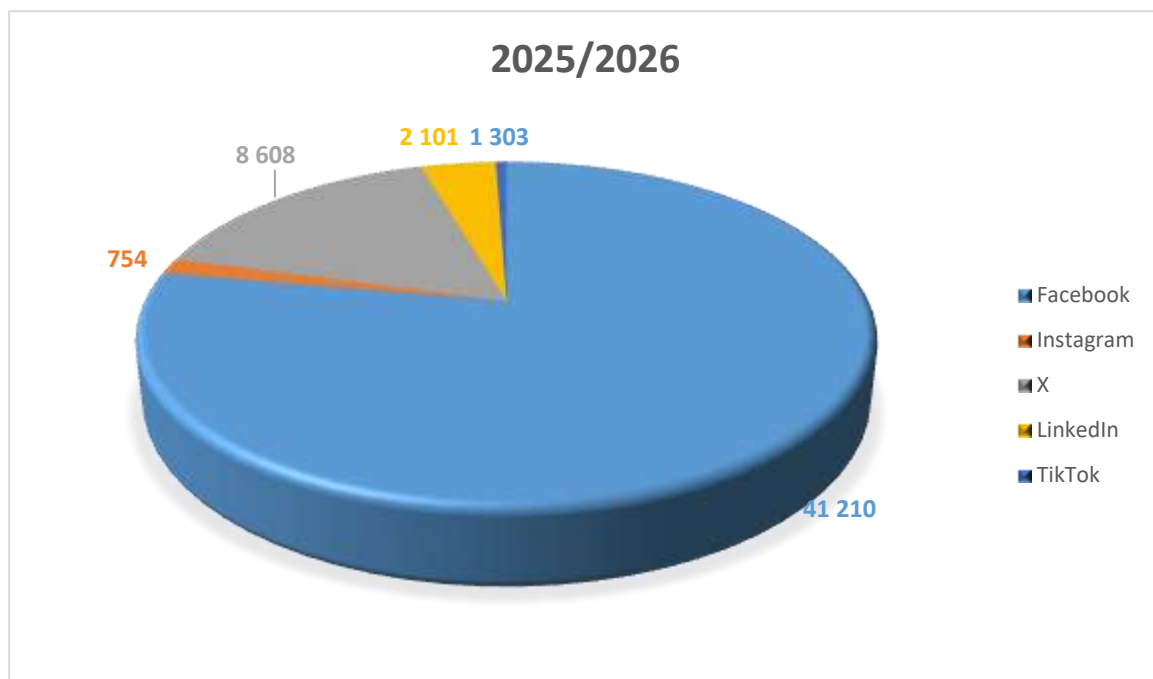
Graph 8: LinkedIn Top 5 countries

The above graph represents the top five countries that follow the PSCBC on LinkedIn. The figures are in the percentile. In South Africa we have 83.4% followers. Namibia 1% followers, United Kingdom 1% followers, Botswana 1% and The United States of America 1% followers.

Overall 2025/26 Social Media Performance Statistics

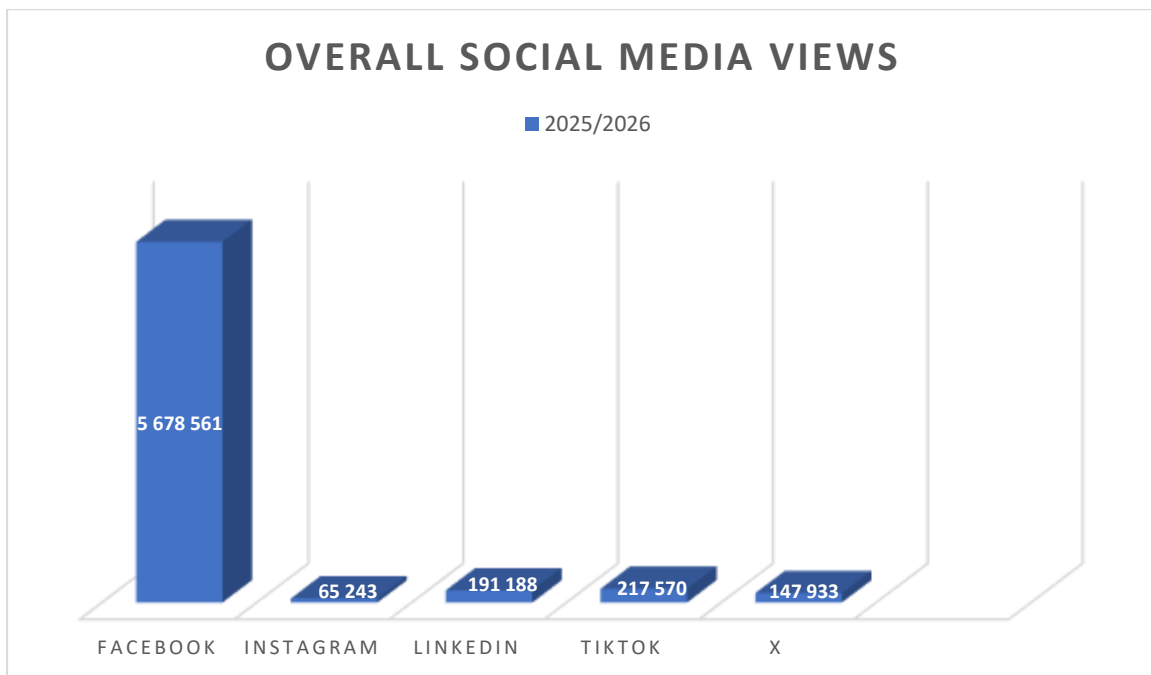
The below graphs indicate the overall views, followers, and overall content interaction the PSCBC has gained on Facebook, Instagram, X, LinkedIn and TikTok, during the 2025/2026 financial year.

The below graph represents the number of accumulated followers on our social media platforms in the 2025/2026 financial year.



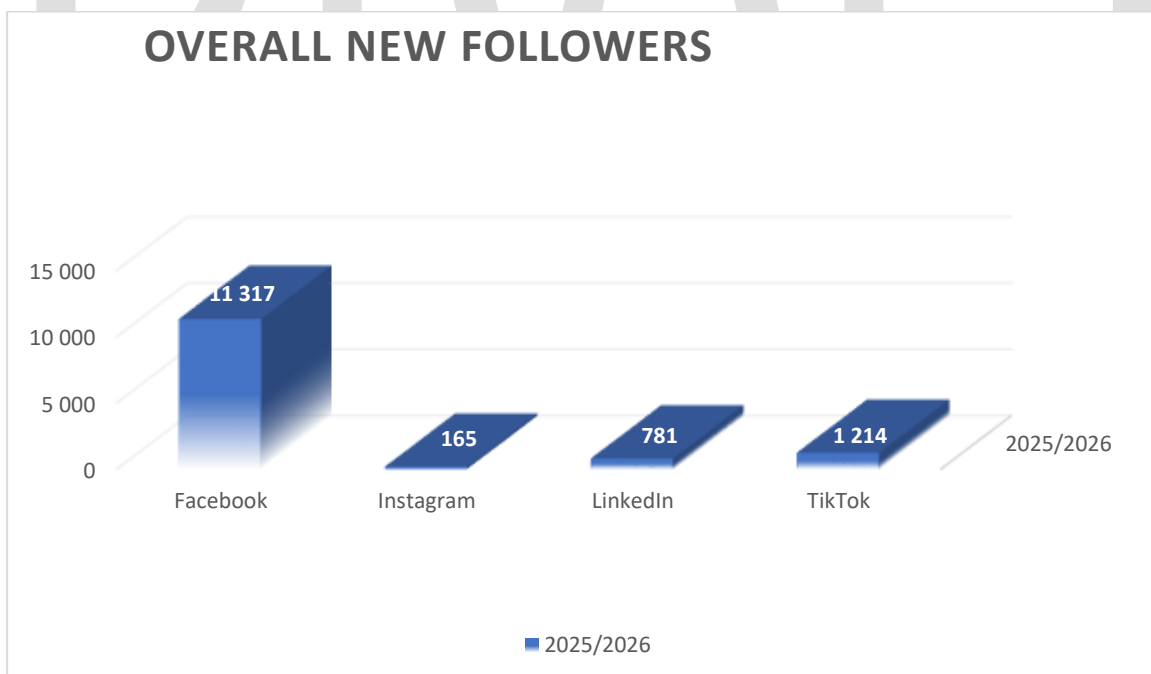
Graph 9 : Social Media Followers

Graph 9 show that the Facebook page has accumulated 41 210 followers, while Instagram has accumulated 754 followers, X 8 608 followers, LinkedIn 2 101 followers and TikTok 1 303 followers.



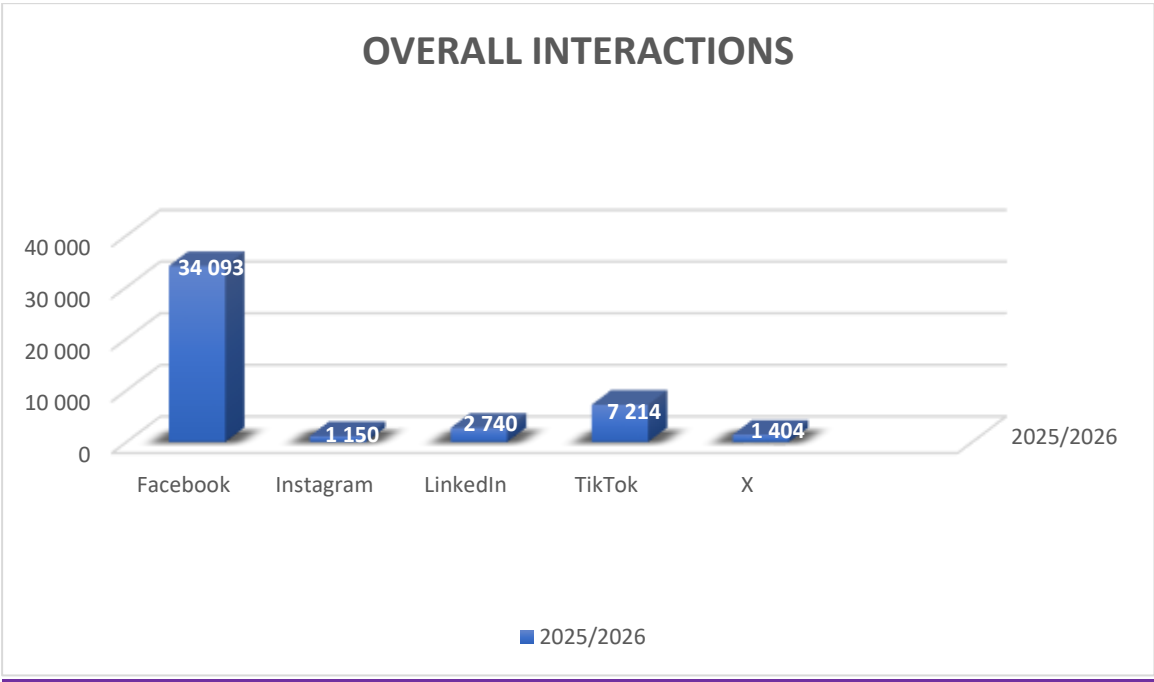
Graph 10: Overall social media Views

The above graph indicates the overall views for all the social media platforms for the 2025/2026 financial year. Facebook accumulated 5 678 531 views, while Instagram accumulated 65 243 views. LinkedIn accumulated 191 188 views, while TikTok accumulated 217 570 views. The X page accumulated 147 933 views.



Graph 11: Overall new followers

The above graph indicates the overall new followers for all the social media platforms for the 2025/2026 financial year. Facebook gained 11 317 overall followers, while Instagram gained 165 overall followers and LinkedIn gained 781 overall followers. TikTok also gained 1 214 overall followers during this period as new platform. The above graph does not show the analytics performance of the PSCBC X account. Due to X's terms and conditions, analytics are only available to accounts that are subscribed to their payment services.



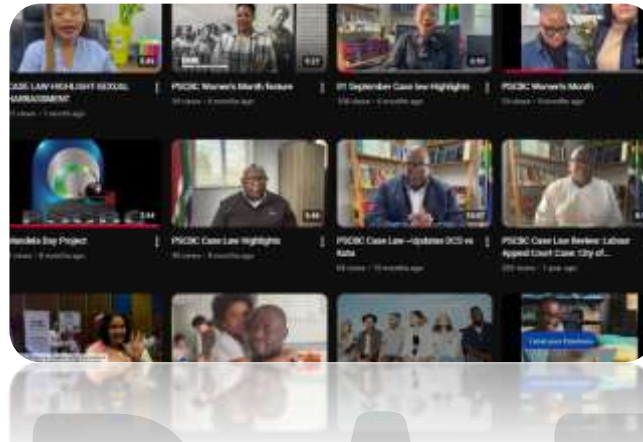
Graph 12: Overall Content Interaction

The above graph indicates the overall interactions received for all the social media platforms for the 2025/2026 financial year. Facebook received 34 093 overall interactions, while Instagram received 1 150 overall interactions and LinkedIn received 2 740 overall interactions. TikTok also received 1 214 overall interactions, and X received 1 404 overall interactions during this period.



YouTube:

The PSCBC uses YouTube as a social media channel to upload our videos. The channel has a total of 164 subscribers, and we have uploaded 41 videos since the creation of the channel in 2020. Below is an illustration of the various videos and the number of views:



Events and Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

During the 2025/26 financial year, the Communications Section successfully coordinated and supported a diverse range of events aimed at strengthening stakeholder engagement, promoting social responsibility, and enhancing the visibility of the Council across various platforms. These initiatives were strategically aligned to ensure balanced representation across internal activities, corporate social responsibility programmes, labour-supported events, and employer-supported engagements.

Internal events played a critical role in strengthening organisational cohesion and supporting institutional priorities. Key activities included awareness campaigns such as Breast Cancer Month, the PSCBC, GPSSBC and PSETA Graduation Ceremony, the 28th Annual General Meeting, the Genes Women Empowerment Programme Graduation Ceremony, and the PSCBC Strategic Planning Session. These events contributed to organisational development, employee engagement, and the reinforcement of the Council's strategic direction.

The Council also demonstrated a strong commitment to social responsibility through a number of impactful CSR initiatives. These included support to the Itereleng Disability Centre during National Disability Awareness Month, participation in the 67 Minutes of Mandela Day initiative at the Bombani Shelter for Abused Women and Children, and contributions to Cothoza Primary School in Mpumalanga through an ongoing school uniform drive. These initiatives underscore the Council's dedication to community upliftment and social impact.

Labour-supported events formed a significant component of stakeholder engagement, with the Council actively participating in key sectoral gatherings. These included the Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union (POPCRU) Central Executive Committee, the National Professional Teachers' Organisation of South Africa (NAPTOSA) National Congress, the National Education, Health and Allied Workers' Union (NEHAWU) conferences and commemorative events, the Democratic Nursing Organisation of South Africa (DENOSA) International Nurses Day celebrations, and other strategic engagements such as training programmes and wellness initiatives. These platforms provided opportunities to strengthen relationships, support labour stakeholders, and enhance collaboration within the public service sector.

In addition, the Council participated in several employer-supported events, further strengthening its engagement with government institutions. These included the Department of Public Service and Administration (DPSA) Batho Pele Excellence and Innovation Awards, the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) Symposium, and events hosted by the South African Police Service (SAPS), among others. Participation in these events reinforced the Council's presence within the broader public sector and contributed to knowledge sharing and institutional collaboration.

Overall, the successful implementation of these events reflects the Communications Section's ability to effectively coordinate multi-stakeholder engagements, promote the Council's strategic objectives, and maintain a strong presence across key platforms. The balanced approach to internal, social, labour, and employer engagements demonstrates a comprehensive and inclusive stakeholder engagement strategy.

2025/26

Communications

Internal Events	Corporate Social Responsibility	Labour Supported Events	Employer Supported Events
•Event To Raise Awareness During Breast Cancer Month •PSCBC, GPSSBC & PSETA Graduation Ceremony •28th Annual General Meeting •Genes Women Empowerment Program Graduation Ceremony •PSCBC Strategic Planning Session	•Itereleng Disability Centre as Part of National Disability Awareness Month •67 Minutes of Mandela Day at Bombani Shelter for Abused Women and Children •Cothoza Primary School in Mpumalanga for Its Ongoing School Uniform Drive	•PEU Elective Congress •POPCRU Central Executive Committee •NAPTOSA Hosted Its 8th National Congress •NEHAWU Hosts Its National Organising, Servicing, and Bargaining Conference •National Teachers' Union Celebrates Its 107th Triennial National Conference •DENOSA in Honouring Nurses at Bushbuckridge International Nurses Day •NEHAWU Commemorates International Nurses Day in Mpumalanga	-DPSCA at the Annual Batho Pele Excellence and Innovation Awards -PSCBC Attends the Annual Government Employees Medical Scheme Symposium at Focus Rooms, -SAPS Division of Visible Policing Women's Month Celebration -SAPS Division of Visible Policing

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		•NAPTOSA Hosts Staff Training Programme •POPCRU Potchefstroom Hosts First Annual Wellness Day •SAPU Book Launch on Gender-Based Violence	Mothers' Day Celebration -DPISA National Labour Relations Forum
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67 Minutes of Mandela Day at Bombani Shelter for Abused Women and Children



In honour of Nelson Mandela's legacy of service, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) dedicated its 67 Minutes of Mandela Day to supporting the Bombani Shelter for Abused Women and Children in Alexandra. The shelter serves as a safe haven for victims of gender-based violence, working closely with the South African Police Service and civil society organisations in Gauteng, and is staffed by professional social workers who assist victims in overcoming trauma.

As part of the initiative, the PSCBC called for donations of non-perishable items, a request that was generously answered by both staff and Council members. Beyond donations, the day was filled with activities aimed at promoting wellbeing and skills development. A yoga session, facilitated by Mr. Oomang Parag, PSCBC Senior Manager for ICT, encouraged mindfulness and healing, while staff members under the guidance of Ms Shriya Budhram, PSCBC Administrator, hosted crochet lessons to help women and shelter staff develop new income-generating skills.

PSCBC Staff and volunteers also assisted with cooking and helped refurbish the shelter's walls through painting, creating a brighter and more welcoming environment.

In his address, the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, thanked staff and Council members for their contributions. He stressed that Mandela Day is not about recognition but about making a lasting impact on the lives of those most in need.

The PSCBC remains committed to supporting initiatives that promote dignity, empowerment, and social justice. For more information or to support the Bombani Shelter, contact them at 011 027 1513 or info@bombanishelter.org.

PSCBC SPENDS THE DAY AT ITERELENG DISABILITY CENTRE AS PART OF NATIONAL DISABILITY AWARENESS MONTH



In commemorating and honouring National Disability Awareness Month, the PSCBC, as part of its Corporate Social Responsibility programme, spend the day at the Itereleng Centre for the Disabled in Ga-Rankuwa. The primary objective of the event was to raise awareness about inclusion of disabled people, promote dignity and equal opportunities, and extend support to individuals living with disabilities.

Faith Mhlanga who is a centre manager at the facility gave a warm welcome and noted that this is a special day where people come together to raise awareness and support those individuals who live with disabilities. Also present at the event was the PSCBC ICT Senior Manager Mr Oomang Parag who in his message of support highlighted that disability does not mean inability but rather this ability because everyone has their own unique abilities. He further emphasized that we are all built differently but we are same and that God shaped each person in a unique way to serve their purpose in life. The PSCBC will continue its commitment in supporting and practising inclusivity by creating an environment where people living with disabilities are respected, empowered, and fully included.

PSCBC Visits Cothoza Primary School in Mpumalanga for its ongoing School Uniform Drive



The PSCBC, as part of its Corporate Social Responsibility programme, embarked on a School Uniform Drive on the 11th March 2026 at Cothoza Primary School in Standerton, Mpumalanga. The initiative aimed to support learners from underprivileged communities by donating essential school uniforms, ensuring that learners are able to attend school with dignity, confidence, and a renewed sense of pride.

Present at the drive was the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, who officially handed over the school uniforms to the school's principal. In his remarks, he expressed appreciation to the teachers for the remarkable work they do in educating learners and imparting foundational knowledge that shapes their future.

In closing, learner Amahle Dlamini spoke on behalf of the learners, expressing heartfelt gratitude and appreciation. She noted that the donation from the PSCBC would bring hope and help restore a sense of dignity and confidence among the learners.

The PSCBC is proud to have played a meaningful role in supporting school learners, particularly those in underprivileged and underserved communities. This initiative ensured that children in these areas had access to appropriate school uniforms, enabling them to attend school with dignity, confidence, and a strong sense of belonging. Initiatives such as these not only promote equality but also empower learners to focus on their education without the burden of social stigma. As Nelson Mandela once said, “It is through education that the daughter of a peasant can become a doctor, that a child of farm workers can become the president of a great nation.”

Council Events

PSCBC WELCOMES NEW LEADERSHIP AT THE 28TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING



The PSCBC held its 28th Annual General Meeting (AGM) on 26 June 2025 in Gauteng. Hosted under the theme "From Struggle to Structure, One Agreement at a Time," the AGM highlighted the Council's journey and progress in advancing collective bargaining in the public service.

The event brought together key representatives from PSCBC stakeholders, state institutions, admitted trade unions, sector bargaining councils, Sector Education and Training Authorities (SETAs), and other labour-related organisations.

General Secretary Mr. Frikkie de Bruin delivered a detailed presentation on the determination of vote weights, followed by the presentation of the Annual Report, Financial Report, and Auditor's Report, collectively reflecting the Council's performance for the 2024/25 financial year.

A notable highlight of the AGM was the announcement of new leadership appointments. Mr. David Phala was appointed as the new Vice-Chairperson: Labour, while Mr. Magate Phala was announced as the newly elected Chairperson of the PSCBC. These appointments were warmly received, symbolising a promising future for the Council under their stewardship.

The outgoing Vice-Chairperson: Labour, Mr. Aubrey Zungu, delivered a heartfelt farewell address, reflecting on his tenure and the personal and professional growth it brought. He acknowledged the challenges faced, the invaluable lessons learned and expressed gratitude to the South African Democratic Teachers Union (SADTU) for the opportunity to lead. He praised Council members for their unwavering unity and the PSCBC team for their professionalism and commitment, referring to them as the "unsung heroes" of the Council. In closing, Mr. Zungu urged the new leadership to preserve the unity that has defined the Council's progress; "Let us continue to build, unite, and never lose sight of the needs of the workers we serve."

The proceedings were enriched by a moving performance from the PSCBC Choir, whose vibrant songs added a spirit of celebration to the occasion. A prestigious awards ceremony held during the AGM dinner honoured both posthumous and stalwart members for their significant and lasting contributions to the Council's legacy and growth.

The event also marked the official launch of the PSCBC's commemorative book, "From Struggle to Structure, One Agreement at a Time," authored by Mr. Frikkie de Bruin, Dr. Christopher Phiri,

and Mr. Mbuso Mdingi. The publication chronicles the Council's three-decade journey, capturing the evolution, achievements, and continued impact of the PSCBC in shaping the public service through collective bargaining.

As the Council turns a new page, it remains steadfast in its founding values of unity, inclusivity, and service to the workers of the public service. We extend our deepest appreciation to Mr. Frikkie de Bruin for his visionary leadership and offer our full support and best wishes to the newly appointed Chairperson, Mr. Magate Phala, and Vice-Chairperson, Mr. David Phala, as they lead the PSCBC into the future.

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PSCBC RESOLUTION 1 and 2 OF 2025 PROVINCIAL WORKSHOPS



The PSCBC successfully conducted a series of 11 Wage Negotiation Workshops across all nine provinces between March and April. The primary objective of the workshops was to provide in-depth insights into the recently signed PSCBC Resolution 01 and 02 of 2025, ensuring that all stakeholders are well-informed and equipped for the effective implementation of these Resolutions.

The workshops were facilitated by the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie de Bruin, Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining Ms Valencia Kola and Mr Mompoti Galorale the Vice-Chairperson Employer, sharing valuable contributions throughout the sessions. Mr. Frikkie de Bruin highlighted that PSCBC Resolutions 01 and 02 of 2025 constitute a three-year multi-term agreement, covering the financial years from 2025/26 through to 2027/28. He outlined that, under the first leg of the multi-term agreement, employees will receive a salary adjustment of 5.5% of the Consumer Price Index (CPI) for the financial year 2025/2026. The salary adjustments for the second and third legs of the agreement, covering the 2026/27 and 2027/28 financial years will be based on the applicable CPI at the time.

In addition, he indicated that the housing allowance will be increased from R1, 784.55 to R1, 900.00 and will also be subject to annual adjustments based on the CPI. He also highlighted the revised provision of the Individual Linked Saving Facility provision (ILSF), which now allows public servants to access their accumulated savings upon resignation or dismissal from the public service.

He also spoke on Resolution 02 of 2025, addressing several key issues including the death grant, childcare and breastfeeding facilities, recruitment policies, bursary scheme, uniform policy, incentive policy framework, and comprehensive danger insurance. He stated that the clauses outlined in Resolution 02 of 2025 will undergo further research, investigation, and negotiations during the 2025/2026 financial year.

Amidst the presentation, Mr Frikkie de Bruin reassured public servants that the PSCBC has included measures to ensure full compliance by both the employer and National Treasury which warrants that the employer to conclude these agreements by complying with the Public Service Act 103 of 1994, along with Regulations 78 and 79 of the Public Service Regulations of 2016.

He further comforted attendees by stating that the technical issues encountered in previously signed multi-term Resolution will not be repeated. Moreover, he noted that the processes and technicalities related to the 2018 multi-term agreement were acknowledged and addressed through a compliance clause included in the 2025 signed agreements. The Council will actively monitor and enforce the implementation of these agreements.

The series of workshops was a resounding success, marked by productive participation and valuable insights from stakeholders. The Council remains committed to ensuring fair and peaceful labour relations between the public servants and the Employer.

PSCBC Joins DENOSA in Honouring Nurses at Bushbuckridge International Nurses Day



Celebration



The Democratic Nursing Organisation of South Africa (DENOSA) hosted a powerful and moving International Nurses Day celebration in Mpumalanga on the 12th of May 2025. The event brought together nurses from across the Bushbuckridge Local Municipality to honour their profession, reflect on challenges, and recommit to advancing healthcare delivery within the region.

An official welcome address was rendered by the Executive Mayor of the Bushbuckridge Municipality Cllr Lydia Moroane-Zitha, who extended warm greetings to all nurses gathered. The

mayor also the paid special tribute to Mama Albertina Sisulu, a stalwart of the struggle and a professional nurse, noting her enduring legacy in nursing profession. This year's celebration also marked the anniversary of Florence Nightingale, the founder of modern nursing. She praised the critical role nurses continue to play in communities across the Ehlanzeni District, especially in underserved rural areas.

The day featured powerful addresses from DENOSA General Secretary Mr. Kweni Manamela, and Provincial Secretary Mr. Cyril Mdhuli. In his speech Mr. Manamela spoke candidly about the ongoing issue of nurses' uniforms shortage which is currently being addressed at the bargaining council. He also encouraged nurses to remain engaged and united in seeking long-overdue resolutions. DENOSA used the occasion to honour nurses working under extremely challenging conditions who continue to deliver care despite staff shortages, lack of resources, and limited recognition, embracing theme under the theme "Caring for Nurses Strengthens economies".

In line with global recommendations, DENOSA called for the appointment of a Nursing Directorate, as per the resolutions of the 2022 National Nursing Summit and World Health Organisation's guidelines. "We cannot implement meaningful change in nursing without leadership structures dedicated to advancing the profession," said Mr. Mdhuli.

Representing the PSCBC, Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining Ms Valencia Kola delivered a message of support and solidarity. She spoke on the mandate of the Council and reaffirmed PSCBC's commitment to working collaboratively with stakeholders to improve the working conditions of public servants. She highlighted the critical role that collective bargaining plays in addressing systemic issues in the health sector and ensuring that nurses' voices are heard at the highest decision-making levels.

"As the PSCBC, we recognise that nurses are not only the backbone of the health system, but also key agents in realising the goals of public service transformation. We remain committed to strengthening platforms that support fair, equitable, and safe working environments for all," she said.

The event concluded with an address by the MEC for Health, who acknowledged the long-standing issues confronting nurses, from the shortage of medical equipment and staff to budgetary constraints that compromise the quality of patient care. She described the NHI as a strategic intervention to reduce health disparities and called on nurses to embrace its roll-out with commitment and resilience. The day also diligently honoured some of the nurses nominated by

their fellow colleagues who still continue to serve within the region with profound integrity and patient care

“We know the system is under strain,” she said, “but NHI offers a path toward equity. Nurses must lead that transformation.”

The day was a testament to the power of unity, recognition, and advocacy and a reminder that nurses must continue to be at the forefront of both healthcare delivery and healthcare reform in South Africa.

NEHAWU Commemorates International Nurses Day: A Call to Uplift the Bondage and Honour the Backbone of Healthcare



The National Education, Health and Allied Workers' Union (NEHAWU) hosted the widely celebrated International Nurses Day in Mpumalanga on the 21st May 2025, bringing together healthcare workers, government officials, and nursing professionals under the theme “Uplifting

Austerity Measures to free Nurses from the Bondage of staff shortages-Towards the full implementation of NHI”. The event served as a platform to honour nurses for their tireless service and to advocate for urgent transformation within the healthcare sector.

The Provincial Chairperson of NEHAWU in Mpumalanga Cde Fannie Ngwenyana officially opened the event, warmly acknowledging all dignitaries in attendance. He paid tribute to the nurses for their commitment and resilience, particularly in times when resources are stretched thin. He also raised critical concerns about job placements for newly qualified nurses and noted with alarm that while the province faces a dire shortage of nursing staff, nursing colleges that once trained 200 students now only accept 50 which is a worrying trend that must be addressed urgently.

The MEC for Health Honourable Sasekani Manzini also delivered a passionate address, stressing the need to lift the austerity measures that have constrained the healthcare system, particularly as the country prepares for the full implementation of the National Health Insurance (NHI). She described the Department of Health as the foundation of government and emphasised the importance of collaboration with the private sector to ensure that clinics and hospitals are well-equipped to serve communities. The MEC further highlighted the Premier's recent pronouncement on prioritising safety for nurses, particularly at rural clinics and hospitals, and applauded NEHAWU's efforts to champion community healthcare workers in the province. She also noted a new focus on nurses' wellness, including access to routine health checks and emotional support services, acknowledging the immense emotional toll the profession can take.

A retired nurse who spoke at the event shed light on the long-standing challenges faced by nurses ranging from chronic staff shortages to the lack of practical training opportunities. She described the intense pressure under which nurses operate and called for renewed efforts to ensure skills development and adequate support systems for the next generation of nursing professionals.

NEHAWU's President, Cde. Mike Shingange, delivered a moving keynote address, encouraging nurses to combine their professionalism with the broader struggles of their communities. “To be a NEHAWU nurse is to stand at the intersection of care and activism,” he declared. “Nurses must not only deliver quality healthcare but also act as catalysts for social change.”

He urged healthcare workers to unite, asserting that nurses' challenges are shared across the public service, and called on them to take pride in their identity as NEHAWU members, working together to foster wellness and equity in healthcare for all.

The Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining Ms Valencia Kola, delivered a message of support at the event, noting the extraordinary challenges that nurses face with the long hours, the emotional toll, and the constant pressure to deliver exceptional care under difficult circumstances,” she said. “Yet despite it all, we see your resilience, your dedication to your patients, and your unwavering professionalism.”

In her message, Ms Kola also acknowledged the presence of student nurses, highlighting that as we also look toward the future we remember to nurture, support and empower the next generation of nurses, to ensure they are equipped with the skills, knowledge and resources needed to carry the profession forward.

Overall, the NEHAWU Nurses Day celebration was a resounding affirmation of the critical role nurses play in South Africa’s healthcare system, and a powerful reminder that transformative change begins with recognising and uplifting those who serve on the frontlines every day.

SOUTH AFRICAN POLICE SERVICE MOTHERS’ DAY CELEBRATION



On the 9th of May 2025, the PSCBC had the honour of attending and sponsoring the South African Police Service Mother's Day event held at the Arcadia Hotel in Pretoria, Gauteng. The purpose of the event was to acknowledge and appreciate the remarkable mothers in the SAPS Division of Visible Policing and Operations who show dedication and make sacrifices to keep our communities safe.

Present at the event was SAPS Brigadier Tsakane Mtileni, who extended a heartfelt welcome to all the women attending the event. She opened her remarks by sharing a brief history of the Mother's Day, emphasizing its significance. In her keynote address, she highlighted the important prominent mother figures in the South African history who played a vital role in the fight for freedom and the eradication of gender discrimination. Lillian Ngoyi, Charlotte Maxeke, and Helen Joseph as key figures who helped pave the way for gender equality in the country. In addition, she noted the incredible shift in the SAPS of when the first women were appointed as police officers in 1972, paving a way for generations of women who currently serve with the police service.

Representing the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Senior Manager: ICT Mr. Oomang Parag delivered a message of support, reaffirming the Council's commitment to advancing gender equality in the workplace. In his address, Mr. Parag highlighted PSCBC Resolution 01 of 2022: The Public Service Declaration, as a critical vehicle for women empowerment within the public service.

He emphasized that the resolution not only promotes equal opportunities for women but also advocates for the provision of childcare and breastfeeding facilities, alongside a range of supportive benefits designed to create a more inclusive and enabling working environment for women. This commitment aligns with the Council's broader objective of fostering a professional, ethical, and equitable public service for all. As we look forward to future partnership and collaboration with members with the SAPS, the PSCBC remains committed in its dedication to championing women empowerment through various platforms and strategic stakeholder engagements.

GENES WOMEN EMPOWERMENT PROGRAM GRADUATION CEREMONY



On 22 May 2025, the second cohort of the GENES Women Empowerment Programme graduated in a ceremony held in Centurion. A total of 13 women successfully completed the programme. The event served to honour the achievements of the graduates, celebrate their personal and professional growth, and to equip them with a practical life skill through a creative session on flower arranging.

The program started with an opening address by Mr. Aubrey Zungu, Vice Chairperson (Labour), who inspired attendees with a message of hope and continuity. He emphasised that the graduates now serve as role models and torchbearers for future women leaders in the public service.

The welcome remarks were conducted by Mr. Frikkie de Bruin, General Secretary of the PSCBC, reaffirmed the Council's commitment to women's empowerment, stating the need to integrate this into future strategic planning. The participant thereafter went on to provide personal testimonies and graduates shared their experiences, noting the programme's positive impact on their personal development and effectiveness in the workplace.



Ms. Vesper Nkoane, a Master Coach with a psychology background, delivered a powerful motivational talk that resonated deeply with the attendees. Her session was acknowledged by Mrs. Sharlaine Oodit, General Secretary of the GPSSBC, who reiterated that women empowerment should remain a continuous priority, not a once-off initiative.

In closing Mr. Mompoti Galorale, Vice Chairperson (Employer), congratulated the graduates and encouraged them to seek further inspiration from “The 48 Laws of Power” by Robert Greene, which he cited as a personal resource.

As GENES Women Empowerment Programme continues to deliver tangible benefits in line with the strategic goals of the PSCBC, the second cohort's graduation marks another step forward in building a stronger, more inclusive public service negotiating cadre. The Council reaffirms its commitment to expanding such initiatives and embedding empowerment as a core strategic priority.

PSCBC CELEBRATES MEN'S HEALTH MONTH TO COMBAT STIGMA



On the 12th of June 2025, the PSCBC in commemorating Men's Mental Health Month championed an initiative focused on raising awareness around men's wellness. The primary objective of the

initiative was to encourage men to seek help in issues related to mental wellness, break down barriers, and challenge stigmas around men's mental health and to advocate for the holistic well-being of all men.

As part of the awareness campaign, the PSCBC GS, Mr Frikkie de Bruin together with Ms Priyanka Kisten hosted a wellness session encouraging men to prioritise their mental health, open up about their struggles and embrace healthy coping mechanisms in their personal and professional lives.

The PSCBC recognises that men's health extends beyond physical fitness it includes mental, emotional, and social well-being. As the Council, we remain committed to creating a supportive environment where every man feels seen, heard, and valued. By championing men's wellness, we are contributing towards building healthier workplaces and communities.

Conclusion of the PSCBC Provincial Chambers Strategic planning Sessions and Annual General Meetings



The Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) recently concluded its Provincial Chambers Strategic Planning Sessions and Annual General Meetings, marking the final year of its current five-year strategic cycle. This milestone sets the stage for the launch of a new five-year

strategic plan, designed to strengthen the Council's role in advancing labour relations and effective service delivery within the public service.

As part of this process, the PSCBC engaged chambers across all nine provinces to assess key challenges and gather first-hand insights. Issues such as operational inefficiencies, resource limitations, policy implementation difficulties, and inter-departmental coordination were critically examined. At the same time, chambers showcased successful strategies and innovative approaches that could be scaled to benefit the entire Council.

The sessions were led by the General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, alongside the Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining, Ms. Valencia Kola, and facilitated by Mr. Gerald Maube. The discussions were structured around key strategic themes, including; strengthening collective bargaining processes and fostering constructive dialogue, promoting collaborative, interest-based approaches to negotiations, enhancing the efficiency of dispute resolution mechanisms, addressing demographic shifts and workforce planning needs and Improving stakeholder relationships across the public service.

Special focus was also placed on the quality of relationships between employers, trade unions, and the Council. Chambers explored ways to improve communication and transparency, reviewed rules of engagement, and emphasised the chambers' role in shaping public service employment policies. Furthermore, mental health support through employee assistance programmes, as well as stronger workplace guidelines for women and persons with disabilities, were highlighted as priority areas.

These sessions were a resounding success, providing invaluable insights that will guide the development of a responsive, inclusive, and effective strategic plan for the next five years. With these outcomes, the PSCBC is well-positioned to remain adaptive to the evolving needs of the public service workforce and to continue building a foundation of fairness, inclusivity, and collaboration.

PSCBC, GPSSBC & PSETA Graduation Ceremony



The Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC), together with the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC) and in partnership with the Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA), proudly hosted a series of provincial graduation ceremonies throughout July 2025. These ceremonies were held across four provinces: Gauteng, North West, KwaZulu-Natal, and the Eastern Cape.

The purpose of these graduations was to recognise and celebrate the dedication, commitment, and perseverance of the 560 learners who successfully completed the *Skills Programme in Apply Labour Dispute Prevention Approaches*. This programme forms part of a broader initiative to enhance labour relations capacity within the public service.

The ceremonies were graced by several distinguished guests, including Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, General Secretary of the PSCBC; Ms. Sharlaine Oodit, General Secretary of the GPSSBC; the

Vice-Chairpersons of both Bargaining Councils; the Chief Operating Officer of PSETA; and Mr. Freeman Nkompilo from VBSKILLS.

In their keynote addresses, speakers extended warm congratulations to the graduates, acknowledging that their achievement marks a significant milestone in both their personal and professional lives. They highlighted that this qualification opens doors to new career opportunities, potential advancement, and future academic pursuits. Importantly, they praised the graduates for embracing lifelong learning, describing it as a vital tool for those seeking to make a lasting impact within the public service.

The PSCBC, GPSSBC, and PSETA collectively extended their heartfelt appreciation to the graduates for their commitment to self-development and professional excellence. They noted that these individual accomplishments contribute meaningfully to strengthening labour relations and improving service delivery across the public service.

The ceremonies were a great success, filled with joy, pride, and celebration. The remarkable dedication of the graduates was evident, making these events not only a recognition of achievement but also a testament to the transformative power of education in shaping the future of public service.

NEHAWU Hosts Its National Organising, Servicing, and Bargaining Conference at Birchwood Conference Centre



The National Education, Health and Allied Workers' Union (NEHAWU) hosted its National Organising, Servicing, and Bargaining Conference from 27–29 August 2025 at the Birchwood Conference Centre. The event was held under the theme:

“Strengthening workplace organisation to defend collective bargaining, deepen class consciousness, and advance internationalism.”

The conference served as a platform for NEHAWU to review its national bargaining strategy across public service sectors, strengthen workplace organisation, and advance internationalist alliances. The PSCBC proudly exhibited at the three-day conference, engaging delegates on its mandate and role in advancing effective labour relations.

The event opened with a keynote address by Comrade Mike Shingange, President of NEHAWU, who reminded delegates that a union's true strength is not measured at conferences but in the daily struggles of its branches and workplaces. He emphasised that branches must remain active at all times, and leaders must carry the responsibility of ensuring that workers' challenges are never ignored. "If workers cannot sleep peacefully because of unresolved issues, then union leaders cannot afford to sleep either," he stated, underscoring the deep responsibility of leadership.

The Minister of Public Service and Administration, Honourable Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi, addressed delegates on key issues affecting the public service. His remarks carried direct significance for the PSCBC and its stakeholders. The Minister emphasised the need to restore the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) to its founding mandate, raising concerns over governance lapses, fraud, and corruption. He reaffirmed government's commitment to working closely with NEHAWU, the PSCBC, and other partners to strengthen oversight. Concluding his address, the Minister pledged stronger accountability, closer engagement with organised labour, and collective efforts to build a resilient, citizen-centred public service.

On the second day, the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, delivered a thought-provoking address on the "State of Collective Bargaining: Challenges and Opportunities." He highlighted critical issues within the public service, including non-compliance with collective agreements such as GEHS, GEMS, the Service Charter, the Public Sector Summit Agreement, and the Professionalisation of the Public Service. He also raised concerns about wasteful expenditure linked to legal costs, referencing the National Treasury investigation, as well as the implementation of Resolution 2 of 2025. Delegates actively engaged with the General Secretary during a lively Q&A session, further strengthening dialogue between leadership and members.

In addition to formal proceedings, the PSCBC hosted an exhibition stand where delegates interacted with Council representatives. A fun Q&A session about the PSCBC's mandate and role created an interactive platform for members to learn more about the organisation's work and impact.

PSCBC Attends the Annual Government Employees Medical Scheme Symposium at Focus Rooms, Sandton



The Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) brought together key stakeholders,



including government representatives, labour, health sector partners, and policy experts, at its annual GEMS Symposium held at Focus Rooms, Sandton, 28–29 August 2025. The symposium was hosted under the theme: “Building a Sustainable & Affordable Future: Enhancing Member Value in a Changing Healthcare Landscape.”

The event provided a platform to explore how a member-focused healthcare system can deliver better value, improve access, and ensure long-term sustainability. Key strategies discussed included risk pooling, strategic cost management, preventative care models, and digital transformation, with a strong emphasis on collaborative action to build a resilient healthcare system that prioritises member well-being and long-term value.

The General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, represented 1.3 million public servants during an interactive expert panel session focusing on Member Centricity. Drawing on

recent PSCBC research, he raised urgent concerns regarding the affordability and accessibility of GEMS. He reminded delegates that GEMS was founded to ensure that every public servant, regardless of income, has access to affordable, quality healthcare and promise now under strain. Key challenges highlighted included; contributions rising faster than wages, increasing out-of-pocket expenses, uneven access to services and complex communication that makes navigating the scheme difficult for members.

Mr. De Bruin emphasised that public servants are not asking for luxury, but for dignity, the assurance that teachers, nurses, police officers, cleaners, and administrative personnel receive care when they need it most. He called on unions, government, GEMS leadership, and healthcare partners to work together to address the affordability challenge, stressing that only joint efforts can ensure GEMS remains the trusted guardian of public servants' health and well-being.

Broader symposium discussions included strategies to; strengthen GEMS governance, improve service delivery within the healthcare system, tackle fraud and corruption and ensure the scheme adapts to changing member needs in an evolving fiscal environment. Collectively, these discussions reflected a shared commitment to safeguarding the founding vision of GEMS while responding to the pressing realities faced by its members today.

National Teachers' Union Celebrates Its 107th Triennial National Conference



The PSCBC was honoured to attend the National Teachers' Union (NATU) 107th Triennial National Conference, held at the Birchwood OR Tambo Conference Centre in Boksburg from 03–05 September 2025. The event, themed “Beyond the Classroom: Re-imagining Education Funding to Support Teachers and Transform Education,” brought together educators, union leaders, and government representatives to reflect on the future of education in South Africa.

On the first day, PSCBC General Secretary Mr. Frikkie De Bruin addressed the delegates, acknowledging NATU's 107-year legacy and principled leadership. He highlighted that teachers remain the architects of South Africa's future, often working under overcrowded and under-resourced conditions. Mr. De Bruin stressed the need to reimagine education funding, placing teachers at the centre of policy and prioritising investment in people over infrastructure. He further emphasised that collective bargaining is a constitutional right and pledged PSCBC's continued solidarity with NATU in advancing support for educators.

The sentiments were echoed by Deputy Minister of Basic Education Dr. Makgabo Reginah Mhaule, who underscored the importance of supporting teachers as the backbone of the education system. She highlighted the need for holistic education funding that balances salaries with resources for infrastructure, learning materials, transport, and Early Childhood Development

programs. She also called for teacher development, wellbeing initiatives, and access to digital tools to empower educators to innovate beyond the classroom.

On day two, Minister of Public Service Administration Honourable Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi delivered a passionate address on the systemic challenges facing teachers, including corruption, political interference, and unequal resource distribution. He stressed that teachers' wellbeing is critical to effective teaching and encouraged delegates to uphold ethical leadership while prioritising educators' development and dignity.

FEDUSA General Secretary Ms. Riefdah Ajan also addressed the conference, highlighting the need to eradicate corruption, recognise teachers' value, and defend collective bargaining. She encouraged delegates to build alliances and work boldly to restore dignity in public schools.

The conference also marked the election of NATU's new leadership. PSCBC congratulates the newly elected office bearers:

- President: S.V. Malinga
- Deputy President: G.M. Mabuza
- General Secretary: M. Mabija
- Vice Presidents: S.A. Dlamini, P. Mnabe, S.L. Mabele and B.Z. Mbatha

The PSCBC looks forward to continued collaboration in championing teachers' rights, ensuring they are supported, valued, and empowered to shape the nation's future.

SAPS Division of Visible Policing Women's Month Celebration at Arcadia Hotel



The South African Police Service, Division of Visible Policing hosted an insightful Women's Month Celebration on 5 September 2025 at the Arcadia Hotel in Pretoria, under the theme Accelerating Action for Gender Equality. The event brought attention to key workplace challenges faced by women, including sexual harassment and bullying, while emphasising the importance of equal opportunities and empowerment for women.

The event was officially opened by Brigadier Tsakane Mtileni, who extended a warm welcome to all attendees and highlighted the role of Women's Month in driving meaningful change for women in the workplace. In her opening remarks, she urged women to empower one another, pursue education, explore entrepreneurship, and refrain from gossip, stressing that collective support and personal growth are key.

Also present at the event was Brigadier Njikela, who addressed the gathering on issues affecting women in the workplace. She spoke about the prevalence of sexual harassment and gender-based violence (GBV), noting the high levels of GBV in professional environments and its impact on women's mental health. She emphasised that the police service maintains a zero-tolerance approach to GBV and is developing new policies to address sexual harassment and violence in the workplace. Brigadier Njikela also spoke on the importance of women actively implementing these policies to protect themselves and others from abuse. She further noted that the Constitution provides a framework for women to thrive in their careers and outlined the processes for reporting sexual harassment, reinforcing SAPS's commitment to a safe, inclusive, and supportive work environment for all women.

Representing the General Secretary of the PSCBC, was the Senior Manager for ICT, Mr Oomang Parag. He gave an address at the gathering as he reflected on the history of Women's Day, noting that women of today are leading divisions, and emphasised that women play a crucial role in getting things done. He acknowledged the challenges women face in the police division and stressed the importance of mental well-being alongside physical safety, highlighting the PSCBC's continued efforts to provide support systems for Police officers.

Mr Parag further noted that Women's Day is a reminder of the power of the women's movements and the progress achieved since the appointment of the first women police officers in 1972. He praised the attendees as products of generations of courageous women, describing them as the heartbeat of policing, and encouraged them to continue to build a service based on unity, respect, inclusivity, and integrity. He concluded by urging women to keep shining, leading, and inspiring.

PSCBC General Secretary Mr Frikkie De Bruin represents South Africa at the 14th ILERA European Congress

The Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie de Bruin, represented South Africa at the 14th ILERA European Congress, held at Durham University Business School in the United Kingdom from 10 to 12 September 2025. The congress was hosted under the theme “Navigating Challenging Times” and brought together academics, researchers, and practitioners in the field of industrial and employment relations from across the globe.

Mr. De Bruin actively contributed to several sessions during the congress, showcasing South Africa’s experiences and perspectives. He participated in a special session on Industrial Researchers and their Professional Associations, where discussions centred on the crucial role that both national and international professional associations play in supporting research and knowledge exchange.

Another significant highlight was his participation in the session on “The Role of Gender in the Employment Relationship, Global Issues and Aspects.” Here, Mr. De Bruin presented a thought-provoking paper on “The Influence of Gender Equality on Employment Relations and Social Policies in the South African Public Service.” His insights generated robust discussions among global peers and highlighted the strides South Africa has made, while also reflecting on ongoing challenges in advancing gender equality in the workplace.

As the congress concluded, Mr. De Bruin also took part in the session on “Past and Current Developments and Challenges in Industrial Relations,” where he shared perspectives on Labour



Relations in 30 Years of South African Democracy. His contribution provided delegates with an important reflection on the progress and complexities of labour relations within the South African public service. The PSCBC is honoured to have contributed to these important international conversations on labour relations, gender equality, and social justice. Our participation reaffirms the Council's commitment to ensuring that the experiences and voices of the South African Public Service remain part of shaping global perspectives on these critical issues.

PSCBC General Secretary Festive Message

As we are about to bid farewell to the year 2025, I wish to express my sincere appreciation to all stakeholders of council for a year of meaningful progress, renewed collaboration and strengthened partnerships. This has been a year in which our collective efforts have continued to reinforce the PSCBC's role as a cornerstone of labour relations within the public service. Through commitment, teamwork, and shared purpose, we have advanced initiatives that supported the vision to influence and advance change in the labour market.

One of our most notable achievements this year was the successful capacitation of chambers across all nine provinces through our dedicated mental health workshops. These sessions played a significant role in equipping chambers with the tools needed to address mental wellness concerns in the workplace and they were met with strong participation and positive feedback. The success of these engagements reinforces our commitment to supporting the holistic wellbeing of public servants and strengthening the structures that enable effective labour relations.

We celebrated the continued success of our long-standing training partnership with the Public Service Sector Education & Training Authority (PSETA) and the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC). This annual collaboration has become an important pillar of capacity building in the public service, and this year's programmes further deepened our professional relationships while providing valuable skills development opportunities to participants. It is through partnerships such as these that the PSCBC continues to empower stakeholders and contribute to a more capable and responsive public sector. Another milestone for the PSCBC in 2025 was the successful implementation of the Enforcement of the collective agreement function. This addition reflects our ongoing commitment to ensuring that the outcomes of our operational processes are upheld effectively.

As we look toward the new year, we remain dedicated to strengthening all our core functions, to serve public service with excellence while scaling our operations to meet the evolving needs of our stakeholders in an ever-changing labour environment.

I also extend my heartfelt gratitude to all PSCBC staff, stakeholders, and partners for your dedication, professionalism, and steadfast commitment throughout the year. Your contributions have strengthened the work of the PSCBC and played an essential role in the progress we have collectively achieved in 2025.

The festive season is upon us, I wish to encourage everyone to take this time to rest, reconnect with loved ones and reflect on the meaningful impact you have made in the public service landscape.

Many of us will be travelling to our different destinations, I wish you safe journeys, responsible festivities, and moments of peace and joy. May this season renew your energy and spirit and may the new year bring continued growth, and lasting progress.

Wishing you all a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year!!

— **Frikkie de Bruin, General Secretary of the PSCBC**

PSCBC HOSTS AN EVENT TO RAISE AWARENESS DURING BREAST CANCER MONTH



October is observed as month that raises awareness about Breast Cancer, it is a month where we join hands to share insights about breast cancer, honour those who survived and promote early detection and prevention. In honour of this month the PSCBC hosted a Breast Cancer Awareness event for its staff members on the 31st of October 2025. The purpose of the event was to educate staff members about breast cancer and prostate cancer, emphasizing the importance of self-examinations, early detection, prevention, treatment and the possible health complications linked to the condition.

To ensure the success of the event, the PSCBC invited Ms Palesa Mashapa, a cancer awareness activist and palliative care counsellor from Healing Hands of Grace, who also serves as a Medical Chaplain at Charlotte Maxeke Hospital. During her presentation, Ms Mashapa explained how cancer starts and spreads within the body, highlighted dietary risk factors that may contribute to cancer, and emphasized the importance of regular medical check-ups as well as maintaining a healthy lifestyle to improve survival outcomes.

The event also featured Pastor Betty Siphonogo, a breast cancer survivor, who shared her inspiring journey of overcoming stage 4 breast cancer. Her testimony reinforced the message that every individual's experience is unique, and that early detection and timely treatment are essential for achieving positive outcomes.

The overall event was not only informative and inspiring but also impactful and enriching, serving as an important reminder of the importance of early detection, prevention, and proactive healthcare.

POPCRU CENTRAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE HELD AT BIRCHWOOD CONFERENCE CENTRE



The PSCBC had the honour of attending the Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union Central Executive Committee conference at Birchwood conference centre from the 7 -10 October 2025. The conference was held under the theme “Building a Sustainable Organisation in Defence of Collective Bargaining”. Representing the PSCBC at the conference was the Chairperson of the council Mr Magate Phala and the Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining, Ms Valencia Kola.

The event commenced with a welcome address by POPCRU President, Mr Thulani Ngwenya, who highlighted the power of unity within civil rights unions and stressed the urgent need to address the alarming rise in police killings through initiatives such as a dedicated police summit and the strengthening of alliance structures.

During the conference, POPCRU officially introduced its newly elected National Office Bearers, who were appointed by the Central Executive Committee. The council welcomes and congratulates the 2nd Deputy President, Mr Sipho Nkambule, General Secretary, Mr Xolani Presente, and the 1st Deputy General Secretary, Ms Phuti Mabotja, all of whom are dedicated to strengthening the union, advancing its objectives, and promoting unity among its members.

Present at the conference was the Executive Director of the Safer South Africa Foundation, Ms Riah Phiyega, who highlighted that SSAF has launched the Communities and Justice Programme, targeting learners from Grade 8 to Grade 11. In her presentation, she stated that the programme’s primary objective is to expose learners to the criminal justice system through visits to police stations, courts, and correctional facilities. She further explained that the initiative aims to raise awareness about how justice operates and the consequences of crime. Ms Phiyega also noted that the programme extends its reach to out-of-school youth across several provinces, fostering greater understanding and promoting responsible citizenship.

The PSCBC encourages all citizens to unite in preventing and fighting crime in our country for a safer and better future.

PSCBC EXHIBITING AT THE PROFESSIONAL EDUCATORS' UNIONS ELECTIVE CONGRESS



On 1st of October 2025 the PSCBC proudly participated in the Professional Educators' Union Elective Congress held at the Kopanong Conference Centre in Benoni. The congress was guided by the theme, "Strengthening Servant Leadership in Pursuit of Membership Growth Towards Driving Quality Education for All."

Representing the General Secretary Mr Frikkie De Bruin was the Senior Manager for Collective Bargaining, Ms Valencia Kola, who delivered a message of support highlighting the importance of membership growth, unity in delivering quality education, and the crucial role of leadership in the workplace. In her presentation, she emphasised that by working together, we can be the force that drives meaningful change, advocates for fair policy, improves working conditions for educators, and promotes equal opportunities for all learners. She further noted that through the partnership between the PSCBC and PEU, we can ensure that quality education is not a privilege for a few, but a right enjoyed by all.

The conference was also graced by the presence of the Minister of Basic Education, Honourable Siviwe Gwarube, who delivered a powerful address highlighting the vital role teachers play in shaping South Africa's future. She reminded us that teachers remain the beating heart of every classroom. During her presentation, she noted that it is the government's responsibility to protect, invest, and uplift teaching conditions. She further emphasized that the Department of Basic Education is working closely with unions such as PEU to strengthen teacher development and expand opportunities for continuous professional training, ensuring that teachers are equipped with the necessary tools to succeed in an increasingly complex classroom environment.

The Department is allocating funding to support the upskilling of 7 000 Grade R practitioners, allowing them to complete the qualifications needed to serve as fully qualified educators” she said.

The PEU Elective Congress was a resounding success, marking a meaningful step forward for the organisation and its future plans in the education sector.

NAPTOSA HOSTED ITS 8TH NATIONAL CONGRESS UNDER THE THEME “BELIEVING, PLANNING, CARING AND FIGHTING”



The PSCBC actively participated in NAPTOSA's 8th National Congress, held from the 4th to 5th of November 2025 at the Emperors Palace Convention Centre in Johannesburg. The Congress was held under the theme "Believing, Planning, Caring and Fighting." The primary objective of the congress was to provide a platform for leaders to discuss key issues affecting teachers and learners, support staff, special needs schools, as well as Technical and Vocational Education and Training and Community Education and Training institutions.

The congress began with welcome address by the President of NAPTOSA Mr Thabo Manne who noted that the congress serves as a platform to pause and reflect on the journey of advancing the rights and interests of workers in the education sector, celebrate the achievements and renew the strength, purpose and unity of the organisation.

The PSCBC's General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, in his virtual message of support stated that the theme of the *congress* brought genuine excitement and it is from the long philosophical statements that never came to fall. He noted that he hopes this excitement would be evident in the commissions and deliberations, and the resolutions that are to come. He further indicated that he is looking forward to the hard work as it continues to shape the direction and strength not only of NAPTOSA, but also of the PSCBC. He also extended his best wishes as NAPTOSA members elected their national office bearers, stating that NAPTOSA's leadership has always been exemplary and that he was confident the election outcomes would once again affirm that.

The Minister of Basic Education, Ms Siviwe Gwarube, also conveyed a message of support, noting that South Africa has recently concluded Teacher Appreciation Month. She emphasised that the recognition of educators' work should not be limited to October, stating that it must remain a continuous commitment to appreciate educators. She further mentioned that the education sector was operating under significant constrain and confronted with various challenges, including issues of safety in schools, bullying, and educators' wellbeing. In her address she assured stakeholders that the Department was working day and night, together with teachers, to ensure that the teaching and learning environment remains conducive not only for learners but also for educators. She emphasised that teachers are the backbone of the education system, and without them, there would be no system at all.

She extended her gratitude to all educators, thanking them for walking the journey with the Department, for holding hands as partners, and for helping to ensure the delivery of quality education to all learners in the country.

Amidst the congress, NAPTOSA reappointed its leadership. Mr Thabo Manne as the President, Mr Nkosiphendule Ntlantala who serves as the Deputy President and Ms Rene Marnse as Vice Presidents. The PSCBC congratulates and wishes them success in their leadership roles and in advancing the organisation's vision and mission.

The PSCBC reaffirm its commitment to supporting the organisation in its efforts to strengthen the voice and rights of workers in the education sector.

PSCBC/GPSSBC & PSETA PUBLIC SERVICE DISPUTE MANAGEMENT AND NEGOTIATION SKILLS TRAINING



The PSCBC and GPSSBC, in collaboration with PSETA, hosted a hybrid skills development training on Public Service Dispute Management and Negotiations for all chamber representatives

across the nine provinces. The training was aimed to strengthen the knowledge, skills, and capacity of public service representatives in effectively managing disputes and conducting negotiations within the public sector.

The training sessions were facilitated by a well-equipped and experienced facilitators, Livhuwani Nengovhela, Gerald Maumbe, and Yolanda.

The skills programme was focused on labour relations, conflict management, collective bargaining, negotiation skills, and included practical activities to equip our stakeholders with hands-on experience in managing dispute and negotiations processes.

We remain committed to fostering collaboration, promoting labour peace, and enhancing service delivery by continuously investing in capacity-building initiatives that strengthen skills, knowledge, and effectiveness across the Public Service.

PSCBC Celebrate with DPSA at the Annual Batho Pele Excellence and Innovation Awards



The Department of Public Service and Administration hosted its annual Batho Pele Excellence and Innovation Awards on the 28th of November 2025. The annual prestigious awards were held at Emperors Palace and are hosted to honour the excellence of public servants across the nation who continue to tirelessly serve within their areas of specialisation.

In attendance was Honourable Minister Nkosi Mzamo Buthelezi and Honourable Deputy Minister Pinky Kekana for Public Service and Administration. In his welcoming address, the minister spoke on the day's purpose, noting that the day's purpose is more than just the handing out of trophies, but a declaration of public service Excellence. He further noted that when public servants deliver excellence and innovation will be celebrated and that going the extra mile will never go unnoticed.

“We are not working in silos. We are one government with a vision to serve the public. We have strengthened intergovernmental relations, and we are not competing with one another but complementing one another for excellent service delivery,” he said.

As part of a team for ensuring the success of the awards was the PSCBC Senior Manager for ICT Mr Oomang Parag, who is also the Chairperson of the Adjudication Committee for the Batho Pele Excellence Awards. In his welcome address, he praised the awards as a beacon for those who exemplify integrity, accountability, and the pursuit of the public good. He also noted that in an era of rapid change, our public servants have met challenges with resilience and creativity, showing that our sector is where responsibility meets innovation for the benefit of all citizens. He further went on to congratulate the nominees and the winners for their exemplary contribution in the public service

The evening showcased the excellence and dedication that drive the public sector forward, reaffirming the principles of Batho Pele, putting people first. The awarded individuals and institutions serve as a powerful reminder that exceptional public service remains the foundation of a capable, ethical, and developmental state.

COUNCIL FINALISES 2025 AGENDA AND BIDS FAREWELL TO RETIRING COUNCIL MEMBERS



The PSCBC convened its final Council sitting for 2025 on 3 December at Kievits Kroon, closing the year with key resolutions and progress reports. The sitting reflected on various outstanding matters, including the review of the Levy Agreement, a positive overview of the PSETA/PSCBC training partnership project, and the ongoing discussions regarding the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) contribution increase. The Council reaffirmed its commitment to protecting workers' rights and strengthening social dialogue within the public service.

Also, part of the meeting agenda was the recent engagement between the PSCBC and GEMS where council reiterated concerns raised by both Labour and the Employer regarding the proposed GEMS 9.8% contribution increase scheduled for January 2026. Parties to council both rejected the increase and expressed dissatisfaction with the consultation process, urging GEMS to review its decision and improve stakeholder engagement going forward.

GEMS noted the concerns raised by parties to council and committed to address the issues raised in a formal sitting with council. Council further welcomed GEMS' commitment to provide a formal response and demonstrating continued dialogue and accountability in safeguarding the interests of public servants.

The meeting also marked a moment of gratitude and appreciation as the PSCBC bid farewell to three long-serving Council members retiring from public service. Mr. Gregory Masondo, who served the Council since for eight years; Mr. Pat Mphela, whose service spans an exceptional 16 years; and Mr. Vuyani Sipambo. The PSCBC extended its best wishes to the retiring members, acknowledging their invaluable contribution to advancing workers' rights and strengthening collective bargaining. Their dedication and leadership leave a lasting legacy aligned with the Council's mandate to foster fair, transparent and progressive labour relations in the public sector.

PSCBC STRATEGIC PLANNING SESSION



Council successfully convened its highly anticipated three-day strategic planning session from 3rd to 5th March 2026 at the Radisson Hotel and Convention Centre in Johannesburg. The session was held under the theme *“Collective Bargaining in the Digital Era: Building Trust, Managing Disputes, and Ensuring Good Governance,”* the session brought together key stakeholders from the Department of Public Service and Administration, trade unions, Federations and sector bargaining councils, and other council stakeholders to reflect, plan, and strengthen the public service in the labour relations realm.

The primary objective of the strategic planning session was to embed the principles of good governance, transparency, accountability, and inclusivity across all PSCBC structures and processes. It also aimed to explore the effective use of technology and innovation to modernise labour relations, improve access to information, and enhance overall structure of the public service.

The session commenced with opening remarks delivered by the general secretary of the PSCBC, Mr Frikkie De Bruin. In his address, he emphasised that the theme underscores the importance of safeguarding the institution of collective bargaining, while simultaneously modernising dispute resolution and governance processes through the responsible use of technology.

The session was also honoured by the presence of the Minister for the Department of Public Service and Administration, Honourable Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi, who delivered a keynote address. In his address, the Minister highlighted that protecting collective bargaining does not mean keeping it static, but rather ensuring that it evolves to withstand the pressures of a modern economy and a digitally enabled workforce. He emphasised that dispute management mechanisms must be beyond reproach, emphasizing that they must be timely, fair, and sustainable in their outcomes.

The Minister also underscored the importance of leveraging innovation to improve operational efficiency, while preserving the human element that remains essential to mediation, conciliation, and negotiation processes. He called on the Council to adopt technology in a thoughtful and responsible manner, ensuring that its integration strengthens, rather than compromises, the integrity of labour relations systems.

As day two continued, the focus was on key themes, including embedding good governance, strengthening professionalism, and advancing workplace wellbeing and transformation within the public service. Special attention was given to mental health and wellness, with presentations underscoring the increasing need to support employees in maintaining their overall wellbeing.

During the session, presentations were delivered by PSCBC General Secretary Mr Frikkie De Bruin on challenges in enforcing collective agreements, Trade Union Membership trends, and bargaining approaches. The Labour representative, Mr Thobja Monyai, highlighted the need to train negotiators for better outcomes, while the Employer representative, Ms Mmapitso Mashele, proposed a centralised “clubhouse” system to track and audit decisions, enhancing transparency and accountability.

Day three of the Strategic Planning Session commenced with a special session on *“Modernisation and the Future of Work.”* The session featured the CEO of PSETA, Ms Bontle Lerumo, who delivered a detailed and insightful presentation on skills development and the future of work.

In her presentation, she emphasised the need to prepare public service employees for a rapidly evolving digital environment. She also highlighted the importance of capacitating young people and meaningfully integrating them into workplace activities and processes to promote sustainability and long-term career growth.

The programme continued with plenary sessions covering key topics, including *“The Future of Work,” “Technology and Digital Transformation in the Workplace,”* and *“A Sustainable Public Service, Fiscal Framework and Wage Policy.”* These discussions underscored the importance of equipping employees with the necessary skills to remain relevant and competitive in a changing world of work.

As the strategic planning session concluded, it was regarded as a resounding success, marked by insightful and constructive engagements. Members of the Council emphasised that government must ensure that digital transformation initiative within the public service aligned with the realities of workplace environments, so that innovation supports and strengthens service delivery across the public sector

FEDUSA-Affiliated Public Service Trade Unions and SAPU March to GEMS to Submit a Memorandum on the 9,8% Increase



On 15th of February 2026, PSCBC-affiliated trade unions under FEDUSA and SAPU held a media briefing at the PSCBC offices in Centurion to address the ongoing increases in medical aid contributions imposed by the Government Employees Medical Scheme.

The briefing was followed by a march on 21st of February 2026 to GEMS offices in Menlyn to table and submit a memorandum of demands regarding the proposed 9.8% increase in medical aid contributions. The President of FEDUSA, Godfrey Selematsila, noted that the unions have the

intention to review PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2026 while exploring alternative medical aid options to provide greater financial relief and improved affordability for public servants.

During the reading of the memorandum, the President of FEDUSA outlined the unions' demands, which included:

- Immediate withdrawal of the 9.8% increase from January 2026 and the 9.5% adjustment effective 1 April 2026
- A forensic audit into governance, finances, procurement practices, and administrative expenditure
- Full transparency on operational budgets and specific line items
- A comprehensive review of outsourcing arrangements and administrative cost drivers
- Implementation of labour-proposed anti-fraud and cost-containment measures
- Review of the funding model, including the statutory 25% reserve ratio requirement
- Structured and meaningful engagement with organised labour at the PSCBC
- Appropriate governance interventions at executive level

The memorandum was signed and acknowledged by the Principal Officer, Dr Stan Moloabi, with GEMS given a seven-day deadline to respond to the memorandum.

COSATU-Affiliated Public Service Trade Unions Escalate Action Against GEMS Contribution Increases



On 23 February 2026, COSATU-affiliated public service trade unions, namely DENOSA, NEHAWU, SADTU, POPCRU, SAMATU, PAWUSA and SAEPU, convened a media briefing at the COSATU House in Johannesburg to formally outline their rejection of the 9.8% medical scheme contribution increase for 2026 implemented by the Government Employees Medical Scheme. The briefing was led by DENOSA President Cde Simon Hlungwani, who addressed union members and the media on behalf of COSATU-affiliated trade unions admitted at the PSCBC. The engagement aimed to communicate growing dissatisfaction with escalating healthcare costs and to mobilise their members ahead of the planned protest action.

During the briefing, union leaders emphasised that the latest increase follows a significant 13.4% contribution adjustment implemented in 2025, resulting in a cumulative increase of approximately 23.3% over a two-year period. They argued that these escalations have occurred without corresponding improvements in benefits, placing additional financial strain on public servants already facing rising living costs. This concern was further compounded by relatively modest public service wage adjustments of 5.5% in 2025/26 and a projected 4% in 2026/27, while inflation remains around 3.5% and medical aid subsidy increases are capped at roughly 4.5%.

Beyond affordability concerns, unions also highlighted broader governance and operational challenges within the scheme. These included dissatisfaction with contribution determination processes, allegations of governance shortcomings, and concerns that GEMS is deviating from its founding purpose of providing affordable, solidarity-based healthcare for government employees. Trade Union representatives outlined a multi-pronged strategy to address these issues, including exploring legal avenues, intensifying workplace mobilisation, and coordinating a structured programme of advocacy across provinces.

This mobilisation culminated in a protest march on 26 February 2026, where COSATU-affiliated unions gathered at the GEMS headquarters to formally submit a memorandum outlining their demands. The memorandum called for the immediate withdrawal and reversal of the 9.8% contribution increase, the commissioning of a full forensic audit into governance, finances, and procurement practices, and the removal of the current Principal Officer and implicated executives. Furthermore, unions demanded the full implementation of PSCBC Resolution 4 of 2017 (Clause 5) to ensure 50% labour representation on the scheme's board, reflecting the collective bargaining nature of the medical aid structure.

Additional proposals included the redesign of benefit structures to better protect lower-income members, the restoration of full benefits for beneficiaries on the Tanzanite option, and a review of executive remuneration and outsourcing contracts to ensure alignment with public service norms. Union leaders stressed that these reforms are necessary to restore trust among members and to ensure that the scheme operates in a manner consistent with its mandate and the financial realities faced by public servants.

Overall, the coordinated media briefing and subsequent protest action signalled a significant escalation in organised labour's response to rising healthcare contribution costs and governance concerns within GEMS. COSATU-affiliated unions reiterated their commitment to sustained engagement, structured mass action, and continued advocacy in pursuit of equitable healthcare access and transparent scheme management. The developments reflect ongoing tensions between organised labour and medical scheme leadership, while also highlighting the importance of constructive dialogue to achieve sustainable solutions for public servants.

NAPTOSA Hosts Staff Training Programme at Emperors Palace Convention Centre



The National Professional Teachers' Organisation of South Africa hosted a staff training programme from 22 to 23 January 2026 at the Emperors Palace Convention Centre. The training initiative was aimed at strengthening internal staff capacity and enhancing organisational knowledge on key labour relations frameworks impacting the education sector and the broader public service. The programme brought together NAPTOSA staff and stakeholders to engage on critical themes relating to collective bargaining, dispute resolution, and access to labour justice.

A key highlight of the training was a presentation delivered by the ICT Senior Manager of the PSCBC, Mr Oomang Parag, titled "Enhancing Access to Labour Law: The Role of Bargaining Councils." The session provided participants with a comprehensive overview of the statutory role of bargaining councils as established under the Labour Relations Act, 66 of 1995, emphasising their importance in institutionalising social dialogue, regulating collective bargaining, and providing accessible mechanisms for dispute prevention and resolution. The presentation further unpacked the two-tier public service bargaining architecture, highlighting the coordinating function of the PSCBC at the central level and the specialised role played by sector councils in addressing sector-specific labour matters.

The training underscored the value of structured negotiation processes, democratic representation through weighted voting systems, and governance mechanisms that ensure accountability, and compliance within council operations. These insights reinforced the importance of effective utilisation of bargaining structures in promoting labour stability, reducing industrial conflict, and improving public service delivery outcomes.

Overall, the training programme reflected NAPTOSA's continued commitment to professional development, policy influence within the education sector, and strengthening access to labour law for educators. By equipping staff with deeper institutional knowledge of bargaining frameworks and dispute resolution systems, the initiative contributes to building a more informed and capable union leadership that can effectively represent members and advance fair labour practices. The engagement also highlighted the critical role of collaboration between unions and bargaining institutions in sustaining orderly labour relations across the public service.

PSCBC Labour Parties Caucus Ahead of Strategic Planning Session



Labour parties within the PSCBC convened a 3-day Labour Caucus in Gauteng from 11 to 13 February 2026 as part of preparatory engagements ahead of the recently hosted Strategic Planning session. The caucus brought together labour representatives to deliberate on priority issues shaping the future of public service labour relations. The session kicked off with the Opening and Welcome by PSCBC General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, setting the tone for robust and forward-looking discussions. Proceedings were thereafter chaired by the PSCBC Vice Chairperson: Labour, Mr David Phala, whose leadership guided engagements aimed at laying a strong strategic foundation for the planning processes.

Overall, the Labour Caucus served as a critical platform for consolidating labour's strategic priorities ahead of the Strategic Planning Conference scheduled for early March 2026, where parties to Council collectively charted a roadmap for the period 2026–2031. The engagements underscored the importance of proactive planning, collaboration, and innovation in strengthening the resilience and credibility of the PSCBC as a central institution in public service collective bargaining.

POPCRU Potchefstroom Hosts First Annual Wellness Day in North West



On 27 February 2026, the Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union (POPCRU) in the North West Province hosted its first Annual Wellness Day at the Potchefstroom Correctional Centre. The event brought together union members and public service employees for a focused initiative to promote employee wellness, unity, and resilience within the correctional services environment. The wellness day formed part of POPCRU's broader efforts to strengthen the well-being of its members while enhancing workplace morale and productivity.

The programme placed particular emphasis on health awareness and financial literacy, recognising the critical role these elements play in supporting a motivated and service-oriented

workforce. Through informative engagements and wellness-focused activities, participants were encouraged to prioritise both their physical wellbeing and financial sustainability. Such initiatives highlight the importance of proactive interventions that address the holistic needs of employees operating in demanding public service environments.

Representatives from the PSCBC were also in attendance and actively participated in the event through an exhibition stand where they engaged directly with attendees. Present from the PSCBC were Senior Officer: Trade Union Management, Tseke Mphahlele, Officer: Trade Union Management, Shriya Budhram, and PSCBC Mental Health Coach, Priyanka Kisten, who facilitated meaningful discussions with members on the importance of mental health awareness in the workplace. These engagements provided an opportunity to gather insights from employees on what mental wellness means to them and how improved psychosocial support can contribute to healthier and more productive work environments.

Overall, the successful hosting of the wellness day reflects POPCRU's continued commitment to advancing programmes that foster a supportive and empowering workplace culture. The PSCBC welcomed and supported the initiative, recognising employee wellness as a key pillar in sustaining a productive, engaged, and resilient public service workforce.

PSCBC Convenes Trilateral Planning Meetings Ahead of Strategic Planning Session



The PSCBC convened a series of 3 strategic planning engagements to kickstart the 2026 calendar as part of preparations for its recently hosted Strategic Planning Conference from 3–5 March 2026. These trilateral meetings brought together Council leadership, including the

Chairpersons, the General Secretary, the Executive Committee (EXCO), and the Management Committee (MANCO), to deliberate on priority areas that will shape the Council's strategic direction for the 2026–2031 period. The engagements were aimed at strengthening alignment among leadership structures while ensuring a coordinated and impactful planning process.

The planning cycle commenced with a 2-day Council Management strategic session held from 14 to 15 January 2026, where the management team focused on developing forward-looking strategies and actionable insights for the future of public service labour relations. Discussions centred on outlining key agenda items, defining stakeholder roles, and embedding structured goal-setting methodologies. This was followed by a strategic meeting of PSCBC Chairpersons, together with the general secretary and MANCO, on 19 and 20 January 2026, which emphasised strategic alignment, priority setting, and strengthening leadership continuity across Council structures.

Building on these engagements, the PSCBC Executive Committee convened an operational Planning Session on 29 January 2026 to deliberate on critical organisational priorities and operational matters ahead of the strategic planning conference. Key thematic considerations across the trilateral meetings included reinforcing collective bargaining as the cornerstone of labour relations, modernising dispute resolution mechanisms through innovation and digitalisation, embedding good governance principles such as transparency and accountability, and promoting workforce wellbeing, transformation, and skills development within the public service.

Overall, the trilateral planning process reflects the council's commitment to proactive governance, institutional resilience, and collaborative leadership in advancing effective labour relations. By ensuring strategic coherence across its leadership structures and focusing on emerging challenges in a rapidly evolving public service environment, the Council continues to position itself as a central pillar in safeguarding social dialogue, managing disputes, and shaping a more equitable and responsive public service landscape.

DPSA NATIONAL LABOUR RELATIONS FORUM



The PSCBC attended the National Labour Relations Forum in KwaZulu-Natal, hosted by the Department of Public Service and Administration on the 19th of February 2026. The Council's General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, delivered a presentation on the implementation and enforcement of collective agreements, highlighting the critical role of compliance in maintaining fair and effective labour relations within the public service.

During his presentation, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin also examined a prominent case involving the Department of Correctional Services and Nxele, providing delegates with valuable insights into the practical and legal implications of enforcing collective agreements. Council's participation was noted to reflect its ongoing commitment to promoting compliance and contributing to meaningful engagement platforms within the public service.

Key discussions at the forum included the Constitutional Court judgement on parental leave, the cost implications of legal representation and precautionary suspension in disciplinary processes, and emerging post-COVID trends regarding how employers have responded to remote work, including whether it has been embraced or resisted.

The forum concluded successfully, providing a platform for constructive dialogue, knowledge sharing, and collaboration among public service stakeholders. The PSCBC reaffirmed its commitment to fostering compliance, enhancing labour relations, and supporting initiatives that strengthen fairness, accountability, and efficiency, within the public service sector.

PSCBC Employer Caucus Ahead of the Planned Strategic Planning Session



Employer parties held a three-day preparatory employer caucus from 11–13 February 2026 ahead of the upcoming Strategic Planning Session. The caucus brought together key employer delegates to discuss strategic priorities and ensure a coordinated approach for the year ahead.

The first day opened with a welcoming address by the Acting DDG, Mr. Dumisani Hlophe. He highlighted the employer's achievements during the current strategic period and emphasized the critical importance of robust planning for the upcoming cycle. His address was followed by the

employer's Chief Negotiator and PSCBC Vice Chairperson Employer, Mr. Mompoti Galorale, who provided the formal contextualization for the caucus, setting the tone for the three-day session.

On the second day, Mr. Modise Letsatsi facilitated a recap of day 1, during which delegates expressed their appreciation for the depth of discussions and the valuable insights shared. Mr. Galorale then presented the proposed roadmap for the 2028/29 public service wage negotiations, providing a detailed overview for consideration by all participants.

The caucus also included a comprehensive workshop on the Personnel Expenditure Review which generated active dialogue and engagement among delegates. In addition, presentations and feedback from the Strategic Planning Thematic Area breakaway groups were discussed.

Day 3 of the preparatory employer caucus commenced with a recap of day 2, with featured engagements on the proposed roadmap for the 2028/29 Public Service wage negotiations, the National Labour Relations Conference and preparations for the GEMS Strategic Workshop.

The caucus concluded successfully, having provided a platform for meaningful engagement, reflection, and strategic alignment among employer representatives for the upcoming PSCBC Strategic Planning Session

SAPU BOOK LAUNCH on Gender-Based Violence



The PSCBC proudly attended the South African Police Union book launch on 19 February 2026 at the Irene Hotel in Centurion. The event marked the launch of a book addressing the critical issue of Gender-Based Violence.

The book, titled “Understanding and Combating Gender-Based Violence” and written by Professor Motsamai Molefe, a key South African figure in discussions on gender-based violence, encouraged all attendees to speak out against GBV and take a firm stand in ending violence in our society. The message underscored the urgent call to Stop GBV, Stop Femicide, Stop Rape, and Stop Murder. In support of this initiative, SAPU encouraged its members to wear black t-shirts on the last Friday of every month as a symbolic action in the fight against GBV.

The PSCBC fully supports SAPU’s initiative and the launch of this important book and calls on all citizens to unite in fighting against any form of violence, particularly violence directed at women and children. Together, we can achieve the call to end Gender-Based Violence and make a tangible impact in eradicating this crisis from our society.

Management of Trade Union Follow-Up Workshop



On the 11th of February 2026, the PSCBC hosted a Management of Trade Union Membership Follow-Up Workshop. The session focused on recapping system processes, enhancing stakeholder engagement, and strengthening Trade Union Membership procedures within the public service.

The workshop was attended by representatives from the Labour parties, Trade Union Membership teams, and IT personnel. The workshop aimed to facilitate discussion on the

proposed trade union management system and to provide a platform for stakeholders to consult, share inputs, and seek clarity on technical, operational, and policy considerations.

Labour representatives raised concerns regarding challenges with membership verification, noting that some members decline PSCBC confirmation. They emphasized the administrative burden and financial implications associated with re-verifying members. Additionally, concerns were expressed about the sensitivity of union affiliations and the extent of HR involvement.

Discussions also highlighted discrepancies between union and council data requirements, as well as the need to ensure alignment with the Labour Relations Act and the Consumer Protection Act to prevent misuse of information.

During the workshop stakeholders proposed several recommendations to the Executive Committee, including the establishment of a dedicated Task Team to co-design the trade union management system implementation plan. Stakeholders stated that the role of dedicated Task Team will be to:

- Defining phased implementation milestones
- Agreeing on realistic and achievable timelines
- Identifying dependencies, risks, and organisational readiness requirements
- Ensuring sufficient planning and budgeting time for trade unions
- Developing a Service Level Agreement (SLA) with PERSAL
- Enabling the PSCBC Secretariat to provide regular progress updates to Council
- Facilitating the participation of trade union principals through PSCBC Vice-Chairpersons
- Ensuring implementation proceeds only once system readiness has been confirmed by all parties

It was further proposed that implementation of timelines be developed collaboratively, considering the variations in union systems and levels of operational maturity, budget cycles, internal approval processes, and system integration and change management requirements, including training and communication needs.

Overall, the workshop was successful and insightful, with stakeholders actively engaging in discussions and providing valuable recommendations to enhance the effectiveness of the trade union management system.

Botswana Hosts 7TH African Labour Law Society Conference



The PSCBC had the privilege of attending the 7th African Labour Law Society Conference in Gaborone, Botswana. This important gathering brought together leading scholars, practitioners, and policymakers to engage on critical developments in labour law across the African continent.

Attending the Conference from council was the General Secretary of the PSCBC Mr Frikkie De Bruin, parties to council and the Management Committee of the PSCBC.

Mr Oomang Parag expertly facilitated and chaired the breakaway sessions for the Conference, fostering engaging dialogue and insightful exchange among delegates on key labour law developments and contemporary challenges.

Dr. Christopher Phiri delivered a thought-provoking and insightful paper titled “*30 Years of Labour Relations: From Struggle to Structure*,” providing a comprehensive reflection on the evolution, challenges, and key milestones of labour relations in South Africa over the past three decades.

Our participation underscores the PSCBC’s ongoing commitment to strengthening labour relations, promoting fair and equitable collective bargaining, and contributing meaningfully to the development of progressive labour law discourse within the public service sector.

Conclusion

The 2025/26 financial year reflects a strong and impactful performance by the Communications and Information and Communication Technology (ICT) units in advancing the Council's strategic objectives. The Communications Section demonstrated notable success in strengthening stakeholder engagement, enhancing internal communication, and significantly expanding the Council's digital footprint. The achievement of all planned events, supported by a balanced representation of internal, labour, and employer stakeholders, underscores effective coordination and meaningful stakeholder participation.

The digital communication strategy delivered exceptional results, with social media growth substantially exceeding the initial target. This performance highlights the effectiveness of a responsive, data-driven content approach and the increasing relevance of digital platforms in stakeholder engagement. The expansion to additional platforms, including TikTok, further enhanced brand visibility, audience reach, and engagement across diverse stakeholder groups.

Stakeholder partnerships continued to be strengthened through ongoing engagements, training initiatives, and collaborative platforms, reinforcing the Council's role within the broader public service sector. Furthermore, all governance and policy development targets were successfully achieved, providing a robust institutional framework to guide communication practices and ensure brand consistency.

The ICT function maintained a stable, secure, and reliable technological environment throughout the reporting period. Key achievements included continuous server monitoring, effective data backup management, and the development of critical governance instruments such as the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan, as well as IT and AI policies. While email filtering systems performed at a high level, minor vulnerabilities remain, necessitating ongoing system enhancements and user awareness initiatives to mitigate emerging cyber risks.

Overall, the integrated efforts of the Communications and ICT units have positioned the Council as a responsive, visible, and technologically advanced institution. The year under review provides a solid foundation for sustained growth, innovation, and enhanced stakeholder value in future reporting periods, with a continued focus on digital transformation, strengthened governance, and proactive stakeholder engagement.

Way Forward (2026/27)

Building on the strong performance achieved during the 2025/26 financial year, the Communications and ICT units will continue to strengthen their contribution towards the Council's strategic objectives through innovation, enhanced stakeholder engagement, and improved service delivery.

The Communications Section will focus on further expanding its digital footprint by enhancing content strategies, increasing audience engagement, and leveraging data analytics to inform decision-making. Greater emphasis will be placed on the optimisation of social media platforms, website functionality, and the integration of emerging communication technologies to ensure wider reach and improved accessibility of information. In addition, the Section will seek to deepen stakeholder engagement through targeted campaigns, strategic partnerships, and inclusive communication initiatives that reflect the diverse needs of stakeholders.

Internal communication will remain a priority, with efforts directed towards improving the consistency, timeliness, and relevance of information shared across the organisation. The Section will also continue to strengthen its events management capability, ensuring the delivery of impactful, well-coordinated events that support organisational objectives and stakeholder collaboration.

From a governance perspective, ongoing review and enhancement of communication policies and frameworks will be undertaken to ensure alignment with best practices and evolving digital communication trends. This will further support brand consistency, compliance, and institutional credibility.

The ICT unit will prioritise the continuous improvement of technological infrastructure to ensure system reliability, security, and efficiency. Key focus areas will include strengthening cybersecurity measures, enhancing email filtering systems, and advancing user awareness programmes to mitigate emerging risks. In addition, the implementation and operationalisation of the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan will be prioritised to ensure organisational resilience.

Furthermore, the ICT function will explore opportunities to leverage emerging technologies, including artificial intelligence and automation, to improve operational efficiency and service delivery. Continuous monitoring, evaluation, and upgrading of ICT systems will remain essential to support the Council's digital transformation agenda.

Overall, the 2026/27 financial year will focus on consolidating gains, driving innovation, and enhancing stakeholder value through integrated communication and technology-driven solutions, thereby positioning the Council for sustained growth and improved organisational performance.

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